

Book Of Job

The whole booke of Job paraphrased or, made easie for any to understand. By George Abbott.
(1604-1649.)

CHAP. I.

- 1 **T** Here was a man whose* Story the Lord would have recorded for ex|ample, and believed for a truth; and therefore for further confirmation, know, that for the Country where he lived, it was the land of Uz, lying upon the borders of the Caldeans, Sabeans and Cana|nites; and for his name, it was *Job*, who was of the Posterity of *Abraham* by *Ke|turah*. This man was faithful, belie|ving in the promised Messiah, and sin|cere in heart, devoting himselfe to serve & please the Lord always, in all things, and hee walked accordingly in his life and conversation, for fearing to offend him, he was therefore diligent, with care and circumspection to avoid all sin, and the occasions thereof in the time & place when and where he lived.
2. Upon which holy Man, God be|stowed* a liberal portion of tempo|rall blessings; and the better to illu|strate the exemplariness of his ver|tue and patience, (when by the hand of God hee was quite strip'd naked of them all) know more particularly what they were. And first, he was the father of many godly children, in num|ber seven sonnes and three daughters.
3. Secondly, he abounded in wealth,* having no lesse than seven thousand Sheepe, three thousand Camells, five hundred yoke of Oxen, five hundred she-Asses, and answerably enriched with servants, and all other accommo|dations; So that indeed there was none in all those Easterne parts where hee lived that went beyond him, or that was equal to him in temporal felicity.
4. And further, to adde to his hap|pinesse,* and to sweeten these blessings to him the more, hee saw the happy fruit of his virtuous care in educating his children by their mutual love, so unanimously expressed in their or|derly intercourse of friendly feasting and welcoming each one all the rest of his brethren at his owne house,

be|ing also ever mindful to invite their three sisters, that so their number and amity might be complete.

5. And though this thing pleased *Job*, yet such was his religious care, that when their turnes of feasting were expired, he summoned them all joynt|ly, and made them solemnly to exa|mine and prepare themselves, and then rising up early in the morning, hee be|ing Father, and chiefe of the family, offered for every one of his children a burnt offering for (fearing God, and knowing the corruption of nature, and the temptation of such occasions) hee thought with himself; It may be, that my children in these their feastings, have fallen into some sinnes incident to such actions, and through overmuch sensual liberty, may, perhaps, have forgotten their duty, and overseen themselves towards God, not bearing him that awfulness, nor rendering him the thankfulness due unto him. And this was *Jobs* constant custom, which hee never failed to perform so oft as their course of feasting gave him oc|casion.

6. Now, to come to the Story it* selfe, I must lead you into it by a bor|rowed allusion from the Kings and Princes of this world, for the helpe of our humane understandings. There was a time when God summoned his ministring Spirits, the holy Angells to appeare before him, who with a filial readinesse presenting themselves to give their account, and to receive his cōmands for the service of his Church, Satan by the will of God came also among them to render his account, and to receive his charge, as also of his own will to espie advantages.

7. And yet further, to speake after* the manner of men, for the better in|structing us according to our capaci|ties; God seeing Satan there among them, enters into speech with him, thereby to administer an occasion to manifest *Jobs* uprightnes, and to bring to passe his purpose concerning him. And in the first place hee askes him whence hee came, and from what do|ing, to give us to understand the Di|vells solicitousnesse from his owne re|ply; who answered, I come from off the earth, from my continuall imploiment of soliciting my cause and kingdome up and down every where among men by watching and taking the fittest op|portunities to tempt and intrap them.

8. Why then, saies God, sure thou* canst not choose but have taken speci|all notice of *Job* the Uzzite, to be my servant in an extraordinary manner, so as there is not the like to him upon the whole earth for a faithfull and upright-hearted man, that truely re|verenceth and feares mee, and is ca|refull to doe nothing that shall offend mee.

9. 'Tis true, saies Satan, I know him* well, and that he makes a faire shew of honouring and serving thee, and no wonder, seeing he hath thriven so well by thee; but thou art mistaken in his uprightnesse: for it is not with a filiall but a mercenary feare that he regards thee, the better to compasse his owne ends.

10. For thou knowst, and so doth* he too, full well, how thou hast hi|therto incompassed him and all that is his, with thy protection, so that nei|ther I, nor any could doe him any hurt whereby to try him, and thus thou continuest to doe still,

neither is hee ignorant how it is thou that prospe|rest him, and makest him thrive in every thing he doth, and hast so won|derously enriched him above all that are neere him, and therefore no mar|vell if for such extraordinary favours hee (in this time of his prosperity and and plenty) seeme to doe thee extraor|dinary service, and to beare thee great good will.

11. But as hitherto thou hast im|ployed* thy power to preserve him and to blesse him with such abundance, so now, doe but shew it in taking away that which thou hast given him, and then hee will quickly appeare another manner of man than thou takest him to be; for, in stead of honouring and reverencing thee in feare, thou shalt finde, that hee'll cast off all respect, and not sticke to blaspheme thee to thy face.

12 Well (saies God) that thou maist* see that I am the searcher of hearts, and have said nothing of my servant *Job*, but what I know to be true, take thy course, try him as thou hast desired, thou hast free leave to doe whatsoe|ver thou wilt with all that is his, onely I will restraîne thee from harming his owne person. Whereupon Satan ha|sted to put in execution what God permitted him with the first opportu|nity.

13. And therefore watched his time* when as *Iobs* children, according to their foresaid custome of love-feasts, were met together in their eldest bro|thers house, upon which opportunity he purposed to plant his maine battery for the gaining of his conquest, and therefore reserved it untill the last, ma|king way thereto, by a methodicall discharge of lesser ordinance.

14. The first whereof is a messen|ger* in all haste, bringing *Job* the sad newes of the losse of all his five hun|dred yoke of Oxen at once, with the hopes of all the next yeeres profits of their labours, and also of all his Asses.

15. By a violent surprisall of the* Sabeans, who came and carried them quite away; and to make the matter worse to pitifull-hearted *Job*, he tells him they had also slaine all his ser|vants that were at worke with them, save himselfe, and his escape was or|dained, doubtlesse, only to the end he might bring him those heavie tidings of discomfort.

16. Secondly, to set home the sor|row* of this message upon *Iobs* heart, so soone as ever hee had heard it, be|fore he could bethinke himselfe, ano|ther in like hast bespeakes him with worse newes, and said, There fell fire from heaven, no doubt, by the im|mediate hand of God, and hath most strangely and suddenly burnd up and utterly consumed all thy seven thou|sand sheepe at once, and hath devou|red also thy very servants that tended them: Onely I am escaped to the end, it seemes, that I should bring thee this evill newes.

17. Lest hee should have any thing* left to sustaine him in hope, and to ease his grieve; Satan dispatcheth a third messenger, contriving him to a|rive in the very nicke of opportunity for the enforcing of *Iobs* misery, and provoking him thereby to impatien|cy against God, by telling him all in haste; by that time hee had well heard

out the other. How that the Cal|deans came with no lesse than three bands of men, and fell furiously upon the Camells, and the men that kept them; so that they have driven away the Camells, and killed all the ser|vants to boote, saving my selfe, who, it seemes, had my life given me by a spe|ciall providence, to bring thee the newes.

18. And just as hee had finished his* tale, comes there yet another messen|ger, by whom Satan was confident, (having thus contrived and managed his foregoing temptations) to worke his will upon *Iob*. And hee tells him, That his sonnes and his daughters fea|ring nothing, were feasting & making merry, in their eldest brothers house.

19. And unexpectedly, npon a sud|den,* there blew a mighty wind from|ward the wilderness, and in a mo|ment overthrew all the house upon the yong men thy sons, and they are every one slain, only I have escaped, I know not how, but it seemes miraculously, to bring thee these wofull tydings.

20. Whereat *Iob*, who had abid and* sate out all the rest, now arose, and in the griefe, but not impatency of his heart, he rent his garment, and in to|ken of sorrow, after the custome of those countries hee shaved his head, and after that he prostrated himselfe upon the ground in reverence to the Majesty of God, and in stead of repi|ning, humbly worshipped the Lord,

21. Saying, I brought none of all* these I have lost, into the world with me, but came as naked into it, as other men, and so whensoever my time had come must have gone out of it: It is onely the Lord, that of his free good|nesse and bounty, hath both given and hitherto sustained all these to me, and so it is the same Lord, that according to his good pleasure, hath taken them from mee, for they were his; so farre be it from me therfore to repine there|at as that I adore and magnifie his name therefore, acknowledging him to be both just and good in all his waies.

22. Now therefore, in all that pas|sed* hitherto, in despite of Satan, *Iob* sinned not, nor for all these sufferings and temptations could Satan prevaile with him so farre to forget himselfe to|ward God, as to utter a misbelieving word against him.

CHAP. II.

1. Againe, in like manner, as a|foresaid,* there was another time, wen as God summoned his ministring Spirits the Angells be|fore him, who, (as at the first time) presented themselves to the Lord, and so did Satan also.

2. Of whom the Lord asked the* same question; Whence he came, &c. thereby to give a further occasion, more fully to convince Satan of *Iob*s integrity, and to perfect his owne pur|pose concerning him. To whom Sa|tan returned the same answer; That hee came from going to and fro upon the earth, to find advantages to tempt men.

3. Why then saies the Lord, thou* canst not but have taken speciall no|tice of my servant *Job*, what manner of man he is, who besides all that I told thee of him touching his faith and honesty, which in despite of thee hee hath made good to the utmost, thou seest still to continue in his upright|heartednesse and humble obedience towards me, although thou prevailed with me, thus seemingly to declare my selfe against him (and that in such a manner, as none but such an one as I have told thee hee is, could possibly have borne it as he hath done) by lay|ing such heavie afflictions upon him, and that without any provocation, or cause on his part procuring it.

4. 'Tis true, saies Satan, I cannot de|ny* it but he hath held out well, and I have got no ground of him hitherto, but yet for all that, the reason is not as thou saiest, from his uprightness, but from the nature of his sufferings, and his owne selfe-respect; for hitherto thou hast only tried him with forraine afflictions, and hast made him to suffer only in the suffrings of others, but hast not touched him at all in his owne per|son, and thou knowest it is naturall to every man nothing so much to lay to heart, or be moved with relative, as with personall afflictions, as is seene by common experience; for who will not, if he may be his owne chooser, ra|ther suffer in any other, though never so neere unto him than in himselfe, and thinke it a good bargaine to lose all he has to save his life?

5 And that thou maist see that this* is true, let mee prevaile with thee once more, to try him a little further with this kind of triall which I have spoken of, lay but thine afflicting hand upon his owne person, by some bodily pres|sure, and then tell me whether hee re|taine his uprightness, nay, then see if my words prove not true, that hee will cast off all respect of thee, and blaspheme thee to thy face.

6. Well saies God, seeing thou art* not yet convinced, goe on, I grant thee thy desire, doe thy worst to his person also: but as before I restrained thee from harming his body, so doe I now forbid thee to take away his life.

7. Satan glad hee had sped so well,* quickly left cōmuning with God, and went straightway while the anguish of *Iobs* other afflictions were fresh upon him, to put his commission in execu|tion, for the trying of him by bodily pressures, which hee fulfilled to the ut|termost, by over-running him in every part from head to foot with a painfull disease, strangely breaking out all o|ver his body in grievous and noysome boyles.

8. In so much that every one lothed* him, nor would any endure to lend him their helping hand, wherefore being destitute of all other meanes, hee him|selfe was forced, (being driven to that poverty, and enduring that misery) to take for want of better, a piece of a broken pot, from off the dunghill, and there (as unfit for any other place) to sit downe, and scrape the abundant filth from off his body.

9. Satan seeing all these temptati|ons* would not make *Job* blaspheme, puts him at last directly upon the very point it selfe, by the desperat counsell and provoking

suggestion of his bo|some-friend, his wife, who in stead of administring conjugall helpe to him, by the Divells instigation, she takes the opportunity of this his deep dejection to spur him on to a further evill, under the plausible pretence of remedy, by tempting him no longer to feare and adhere to such a God in dependance and reverence, nor any longer to beare his afflicting hand with patience, that had thus unmercifully and without cause tormented him, but being that he sped no better by his integrity, ra|ther to spite God, as God had spited him, by easting off his fruitlesse faith and patience, and turning it into blas|phemy; for so should he get more from God by provoking him therewith to destroy him out and out, than hee had done by blessing him, which all this while had gained him no good, but procured God to sustaine him alive under insupportable miseries, and so was like to doe still.

10. But herein also Satan came short* of his hopes, as we see by *Jobss* smart re|prooffe, together with his faithfull and humble answer: For, saies hee to his wife, How darest thou utter these words, that hast beene brought up in the knowledge of God; it were a speech fitter to have come out of the mouth of one of those ignorant hea|thenish women that have no know|ledge of the true God, than from thee, who hast beene otherwaies instructed, and oughtest to know, that all the good that wee, or any enjoy, is of his free gift, without our procuring, or de|serving; and how comes it to passe then, that thou art so farre devoid of godlinesse and reason, as not to know it is but equity in God, when his good pleasure is, to take that from us, which of his onely good pleasure hee freely gave unto us; In all which triall of *Job*, though in spirit he was sore trou|bled, yet could not Satan get one mis|beseeming word from him against God.

11 Now when *Eliphas* the Temanite,* and *Bildad* the Shuhite, and *Zophar* the Naamathite, which were all godly men, and the three speciall friends of *Job*, had heard of all *Iobs* miseries, they came all of them together, by joynt appointment from the places where they lived, with intent to testifie them|selves his true and faithfull friends in a voluntary sympathising his afflictions, and so to mitigate his sorrowes by their friendly condolings, and to sup|port his spirit by their godly advise.

12. But as they drew towards the* end of their journey, they cast their eyes toward *Iobs* house, and of a sud|den seeing him in his owne person in that manner and estate to sit upon the dunghill, and his distresse to goe so far beyond report and their owne imagi|nations of him, they through amaze|ment could not believe their own eyes for a while that it was hee, whom be|fore they had never seene but in a splendidous fashion, but by beholding him, being at length assured that piti|full spectacle wa their very friend *Job*, they could not but through amaze|ment and affectionate sympathy, break out into a transported manifestation of their abundant sorrow both in words and tears, and deforming them|selves with rending their mouths, and sprinkling dust upon their heads in token of their humbling themselves before God at the sight of his judge|ments.

13. Thus all of them having at the* first sight of him their hearts stricken with the awfull feare of God, as also in pity of him whom they beheld in such misery, when they came to him, sate them downe by him in that very place, upon the ground, eying and considering him with such astonish|ment, as that they spent the most part of seven daies and seven nights in that very place with him, without giving almost any regard to their ordina|ry rest and sustenance. And all that while they kept silence, because they thought him incapable of discourse, by reason of his extreme paine and grieve.

CHAP. III.

1. After this long time spent in* silence wherein *Job* had ho|ped to have heard a word of comfort from his companions, but perceiving none, and therefore seeing every thing helping on his misery and empty of relief, he himself at last, to give his heart some ease, gave liberty to his lips to vent his grief, but still re|taining the feare of God, he brake not out in an enraged manner, immediately against the Lord himself, as Satan ho|ped, but discharged his passions upon his owne originall, and through the weakness of the flesh to stand it out any longer, his infirmities so farre pre|vailed, as that hee fell foule upon the day of his birth and cursed it.

2. In this manner:*

3. O that I might have my will up|on* my birth-day, and the night be|longing to it, which gave originall to all these miseries, that they might henceforth be utterly rejected of God and unserviceable to man, so that not a minute thereof may ever be usefull or comfortable any more.

4. O that it may be branded with* unpleasing darknesse, and may never be favoured of God with vouchsafing the dew of heaven and such like bles|sings on it as on other daies, yea, let the Sunne breake off his course, and make a stand at that day, not daining to af|ford it the honour of his light.

5. But in stead thereof let its beauty* be turned into a black darknesse, even such an one as may resemble the very grave it selfe, and let there be no in|termission, but let a thicke and gloomy cloud uncomfortably over-shadow it from end to end; let it be so eclips|sed with darknesse, as may represent such a dismall blacknesse that may not onely beget discomfort, but the very terrour of a finall and immediate dis|solution of all things.

6. As for the night belonging to* this day, which nature it selfe hath ap|pointed to be darke, let darknesse her selfe henceforth, make it her habitati|on; yea, let nature quite disclaime it and utterly abandon it for having any place in the computation of time, ei|ther by Sunne or Moone.

7. Yet further, let that night bring* forth nothing but mourning and dis|consolation, let there be no pleasing stilnesse therein as in other nights to invite the melodie of musicke.

8. Let those mourning women,* which for hire are wont at funeralls with dolefull execrations, to lament the day of their benefactors death, al|waies remember this for one, yea, with their joint forces and bitterest excla|mations let them curse it.

9. Let it not be blessed with the* common blessings of other nights, let it neither (according to the course of nature) partake of the light of the stars in the beginning, but in stead thereof be overtaken with an unwonted and unexpected darkenesse, neither let it be so happy, as to give occasion (which else of course it should do) to the next daies dawning.

10. These curses I lay upon that* day and night wherein first I came into the world, and not without cause, for that was the time which made me ca|pable of all these calamities, and gave beginning to this my miserable being, which it might have prevented by hin|dering me to have beene borne.

11. O therefore that I had beene* borne dead, or else that I had re|ceived my ending together with my beginning, and had left the world by death, so soone as I came into it with life.

12. Or that the Midwife had not* beene so carefull of me, but had expo|sed me to my fatall helplesnesse in the moment of my birth, or that my Nurse had after let me famish.

13. Then should I not now need to* have complained thus, but in stead thereof have lien unmolested in the grave, and beene quiet from these troubles; I should then have slept without sense of any these paines, and beene at rest from them.

14. And (in stead of this miserable* state) then had I beene equall in con|dition with the most renowned of the world for power and policie, who am|bitiously people and edifie the waste and uninhabited countries of the world, for the inlargement of their dominions, and spreading of their fame.

15. Or be they otherwaies famous for* riches, though they abounded in ne|ver so great wealth, yet then had nei|ther these nor those gone beyond me.

16. Or (which is all one to mee, so* I had never knowne these calamities) I should have been as those that never were knowne to be, nor never knew themselves to have a being.

17. Then had I beene in an estate* capable of no earthly molestation; for there the wicked neither by power nor policie can doe any harme, and those that either by their travells or troubles are weary of this life, doe there enjoy a perpetuall freedome and rest from both.

18. There the poore slaves enjoy* their freedome, and are from under the command of their mercilesse task|masters.

19. There cannot be but freedome,* because there is an equall parity. The great is as the small, and the servant is as his Master, no better and worse.

20. Seeing then that death affords* remedy for all miseries, why is it de|nied to mee, and why in stead thereof doe mine eyes still enjoy the light of the Sunne, or why is my life any lon|ger continued, seeing, that though these are desireable and commodious to others, yet because of my misery, I account not of them but as burthen|some evils?

21. I take no felicity in them, but* doe infinitely preferre death before them; It is strange then I cannot have my desire to exchange light for darke|nesse, and life for death, which how ever ▪ it be a thing odious to other men, yet doe I desire and prize it above all the riches that the bowells of the whole earth can afford.

22. Wherefore then is it denied* me that am so far from fearing or re|fusing it, that I should exceedingly re|joyce, and be glad at my very heart (and no doubt, so would all men in my case) if my houre were now to die?

23. Why doth God continue to be|stow* light and life on me, whom he re|gards not, and whom hee hath made unavoidably miserable?

24. For alas, my extremity is such,* that I cannot enjoy one moment of ease, in so much as that my spirits are so exhausted with continuall griefe, that I can relish no meat, nor have any strength to digest it: And as is my griefe, such are my complaints, vehe|ment and incessant, which things must needs end me.

25. And blame mee not for thus* complaining: For though I have ever greatly feared to provoke the Lords displeasure, and have therefore care|fully eschewed all manner of evill that might procure it, yet for all that you see in hath befallen me.

26. Yea, though all my life long* when I was at my best, I reposed no great confidence, nor put no extra|ordinary content in my prosperity, so as to cause me any whit to abate my feare of God, yet I speed never the better for this my moderation of mind and care to please him, but see not|withstanding what misery comes up|on mee.

CHAP. IV.

1. IObs three friends that came to* comfort him, having all this while diligently attended to his passionate discourse; *Eliphaz* the Te|manite, having his spirit stirred there|with, at length attempts to addresse himselfe to *Job*, seeing that hee him|selfe had broken the silence, and had administred such an unexpected oc|casion of reproofe: And said,

2. We have purposely forborne all* this while, therefore, now at last, let it not grieve thee to heare us speake. But how ever thou takest it at our hands, there are none of

us that heares thee, that either can or may with a good conscience forbear to reply to this thy sinful unbecoming discourse.

3. Therefore consider with thy selfe* how unworthy of thee is this thy passionate exclamation (now that it pleaseth God to lay his afflicting hand upon thee) and how devoid of all religious integrity: For that alwaies heretofore thou hast beene a forward in structure of others how to beare afflictions, and by thy counsell thou hast strengthened them to a patient enduring their distresses.

4. In so much that by thy comfortable* speeches, very many feeble ones have beene encouraged and upheld from fainting, and with faith and patience have beene enabled to goe through-stitch with their calamities.

5. But now that the same lot is false* to thee, and that thou shouldst make good thy words with thy actions, thou now contrary to all mens expectations, and to the scandall of thy profession, in stead of honouring religion by manifesting thy faith and patience under the hand of God, most shamefully degenerates into a faithlesse pusillanimity, and unbecoming impatency, contradicting by thine owne practice (in expressing such extreme trouble at the first touch of these calamities) all that ever thou hast heretofore advised to others.

6. But see now I pray thee by this,* that which (it appeares) hath hitherto beene hid from thine eyes, I meane, the deceit of thine owne heart touching those graces which till now thou thoughtest to have beene sincerely in thee, and eftsoones made thy brags of, Thou maist now plainly see by this alteration which affliction hath wrought in thee, what was thy feare, thy faith, thy uprightnesse and thy hope heretofore in the time of thy prosperity; for had thy graces beene any other than counterfeit pretences, and thy waies beene any other than sinister practices, not aiming  and directly at God, but indirectly at thy selfe and thine owne advantage they would never have suffered thee thus to have forgot thy selfe, and broken out into their contrary vices against God, neither certainly  God have laid this great punishment upon thee.

7. For, where ever canst thou call* to minde so much as any one that being truly such as thou salsely mistakest thy selfe to be, was ever plagued with the destroying hand of God as thou art; or in the whole world, where canst thou reckon one that ever thou knewst sincerely righteous, that ever God shewed such formidable wrath upon?

8. But on the contrary, I have continually* observed in sundry examples, how that it hath ever beene Gods way of proceeding, only to bring evill sufferings upon such as either do or purpose evill, which wee have reason the rather to believe to be true, because this is so agreeable to justice, for men to reape as they sow, that is, for God to bring the evill they purposed to others, upon their owne heads, which otherwaies it were not.

9. And such men indeed, I have* commonly seen (with the manifestati|on of a most evident wrath from God) to be like thee, all of a sudden strange|ly ruined, and quite brought to nought in a moment.

10. For be men never so potent and* able to doe mischiefe, or be they ne|ver so well furnished with will and power thereunto; yet God, who sees mens hearts a far off, can, and does or|dinarily, in the midst of their carreere, disable and intercept them, which no doubt, but God fore-saw in thee and thy children, though thou seest it not in thy selfe.

11. And therefore to shew his ex|ceeding* great power, in preventing the great evill which he fore-saw, was towards, by the power which thou hadst got into thine hand to worke it, and withall, to intimate a reason of his action, hath he thus wonderfully dis|appointed thee by an utter disable|ment both in thy selfe and thy poste|rity, bringing upon thee the same evill which doubtlesse, else thou wouldst have brought upon another.

12. And that thou maist be the bet|ter* perswaded, of the truth of that which I have said concerning thee; Know that for certaine (after the man|ner of revealing heavenly messages to our humane capacities, which under|stand them but in part) I lately had a revelation thence to this very purpose, which I have spoken of to thee, and that upon this very occasion of thy af|fliction.

13. For when that I had heard what* had befallne thee, and the manner of it; One night seriously thinking of thee, and pondering thy case, as I lay awake in the dead time of the night, when other men were asleepe, and dis|puting within my selfe, how the inno|cency of thy life, and these punish|ments could in justice stand together;

14. Of a sudden an extreme feare* seized upon mee, in so much that it made me exceedingly to tremble, and my very bones to lose their strength, and to shake as if they had beene all over me out of joynt, and while I mar|velled what should be the reason of it, I streight way perceived it was to pre|pare my minde with reverence, and better discerning to entertaine the vi|sion that immediately ensued.

15. For presently there appeared* a spirit before mee, the sight where|of made my very haire to stand an end.

16. And though it stood still before* my face, yet could I not distinctly com|prehend in my mind the forme there|of, only this I can say for certaine, that I saw an image before mine eyes; And whilst I was in this amazement, silent|ly waiting the issue, at last it spake to me, and said these very words concer|ning thee, of whom I was even then thinking.

17. Why dost thou thus wonder at* Gods proceedings towards *Job*, and secretly in thine heart question his Ju|stice, because of *Jobs* innocent life? canst thou with any reason or equity conceive mortall man to be righteous; and the eternall God to be

unrighteous, or the creature to be pure and innocent, and yet his Creator to be culpable and blame worthy in what hee shall doe?

18. Alas, how art thou deceived,* as thou maiest easily see, if thou doest but consider, that those glorious Angels, which are now his speciall domestick servants in heaven, stand not in that estate by their owne power and worth, but by the mere support and firme decree of God, which in grace hee passed upon them, knowing that else they would have fallen as well as other their fellows did, who though they were Angels, and so the best of all his creatures farre surpassing man, yet hee found fault enough in them to condemne them everlastingly.

19. If this be so of the Angels which* are in their natures such excellent spirituall and immortall creatures, so far exceeding man, and which were so neere to God in heavenly mansions; How much more then is man, what ever he thinke of himselfe, sinfull before God, and unfit to be justified against God, being nothing else but infirmity and sinne, and justly liable to confusion, who comes so farre short of Angelicall perfection: For his soule whereby hee comes the neerest them, that dwells farre from God, officiating here below on earth in a body composed of nothing but corruptible clay, and then in respect of his nature, he has no better a foundation to trust to than the dust whereof he is made, and who by reason of sinne is so subjected to mortality, as that through inward diseases and outward casualties hee is become as fraile and transitory as the weakest creature living.

20. His whole life is nothing but a* lingring death, the one shortening, the other hastening every moment, and his departure hence, though it be everlasting, and never to returne againe, yet it is so ordinary, that therefore it is made no matter of, but accounted as a thing of course even among men themselves.

21. And what are they when they* are dead? Why they turne to clay from whence they were taken; for then their soule quite leaves them wherein all their excellency consisted, and they die even as brute creatures without any power or skill to helpe themselves and hinder it.

CHAP. V.

1. SO that as I said before, bring* forth the man if thou canst that ever did or could say of himselfe, that God punished him being righteous, see if among all the holily worthies of former times, there was ever any such president, that God plagued the innocent?

2. Nay, from the difference of thy* carriage to them that are godly righteous, it is evident that thou hast but flattered thy selfe all this while, and what ever thou hast thought of thy selfe, thou art but a wicked man, and hast not the knowledge of God in

thee as appeares plainly, now it comes to triall: For diddest thou know him aright, thou wouldst never have suf|fered thy pettish frowardnesse so to have transported thee against God to the aggravating thine owne ruine, nor thine envious quarrellings (through thy conceited righteousness above o|thers, and the opinion therefore of thine undue sufferings) so to have in|creased thy torment, and robbed thee of that comfort and content thou mightest have taken in God, in the midst of all thy misery through an humble patience.

3. No, but as I know thou canst not* instance any that ever were punished but for sinne, or that perished being in|nocent: So on the contrary, I can as|sure thee, that I have observed di|vers who like thee have made a faire shew, and withall have exceeding|ly prospered in all outward felicity, but I have withall quickly seene an end of it; for God hath made them manifest and with evident judgements most remarkeably accursed them and theirs.

4. For he has brought unavoidable* ruine upon their posterity, and that in such an exemplary manner, as that he has exposed them openly to the con|demning censure of all men without pitie or part-taking of any.

5. And just as he hath done to thee,* so hath hee raised up against them a rout of needy wretches, that have di|spoiled them of the very bread where|with they should subsist, violently ta|king away the very uttermost eare of corne, and has brought it so to passe upon them; that thieves have even swept away al that ever they have had.

6. It is not the creature, nor na|turall* causes here below, that of them|selves bring forth these afflictions, which men suffer.

7. And yet there is no propertie* more naturall to his subject, than trouble is to men. The very sparks of fire ascend not more ordinarily than men suffer afflictions; which then must needs be inflicted from above by the divine hand of supreme and infinite justice because of sinne.

8. Therefore were thy cause mine,* I would not in the vaine opinion of mine owne innocency afflict my selfe by exclaiming on my birth-day, or complaining on the creature as the cause of my calamities; but I would humble my selfe, and confesse my sins, and goe directly to God, seeing him the author, and seeking to him for re|dresse of these punishments, commit|ting my selfe wholly and onely to his mercy.

9. And the rather because thy suf|ferings* are extraordinary, and thou canst not finde the reason of them, be perswaded to thinke them to be of God, and therefore humble thy selfe, and seeke unto him; And then thinke not thy case remediesse, or that it is beyond the power of God to relieve thee: for who knowes, but God may have brought thee into this estate of purpose, upon thy humiliation to glo|rifie his power and goodnesse in thy restauration? For it is ordinary with God to doe extraordinary things, and such as are beyond our imagination.

10. Have we not daily experience* of it in this very kinde, as when the earth wanteth raine, and the fields are scorched with drought, how does hee in such a strait, and forlorne hope, send seasonable showers and plenty of them?

11 To supply those that in their* want and necessity humbly depend on him, and to cheare up those which mourne under the sense of Gods just displeasure, with an assured hope of plenty.

12. Whereas also on the contrary,* how doe wee see him defeate by his powerfull wisdom, the subtile devi|ces of those that in their owne con|ceite are able to support themselves; so that what they enterprize, they faile to effect.

13. And every foot he intraps the* wise of this world in their owne gins, and the proud politicians hee brings to ruine by their owne counsells.

14. In the midst of all their hopes* he frustrates their designs, and makes their wisdom faile them, sending them events crosse to what they con|fidently promised themselves, leaving them utterly to seeke of their expecta|tion.

15 But he that humbleth himselfe,* and seeks to the Lord, he as powerful|ly preserves him, as he defeates them, both from the bloody sword, mali|cious mouth, and destroying hand of the wicked, be they never so mighty.

16. So that then it is certaine, that* the humble man, and he that seekes to the Lord with repentance and selfe|abasing, be his case never so desperate, may aske and waite in hope, but the proud presumptuous-spoken man dis|ables himselfe for getting any good from God.

17. Behold then, how ever thou* thinkest, and notwithstanding thy im|patient outrage, yet for certaine it is a happinesse to a man (that takes this way) to be corrected of the Lord, ther|fore let not thy pride make thee swell against God, nor beare not thy selfe so high in thine owne imaginary justifica|tion, but rather improve this good|nesse of the Lord to thee by making it a meanes to bring thee to repentance, and to humble thee before him in the acknowledgement of thy faults.

18. Who in so doing as hee hath* plagued thee for thy pride, so will he upon thy humiliation take away thy smart, and turne all thy wo into weale.

19. Be thy troubles multiplyed to* never so great a number, if thou hum|blest thy selfe under his hand, he shall deliver thee from them all, and thou shalt be sure of a happy issue, though for present they increase upon thee.

20. For take but this course, and then* in the greatest mortality of famine, though thou wert at deaths doore, yet shall he deliver thee, and in all devou|ring war where thousands presuming of their owne strength and courage are slaine, yet by an humble dependance upon God shalt thou be preserved.

21. Yea, it shall shield thee from* every evill, even from the very re|ports of slanderous and back-biting tongues, to which all men are obnoxio|ous: neither shalt thou feare at the reproach of the greatest destruction, when every man else shall tremble.

22. But in stead thereof through* tranquillity of minde, and security in God, thou shalt set at naught the things which are most terrible to other men, to wit, the sword and famine, neither shalt thou feare the power of any crea|ture under heaven to doe thee harme.

23. For hereby thou art reconci|led* to God, and art at one with him, and if so, who dare be against thee, or what can hurt thee? Nay, the most senselesse and unreasonable creatures, whose benefit and obedience sin hath lost our right to, and turned into re|bellion, shall then be so farre from working thee evill, as that they shall become Gods instruments, and joyne together for thy use and service.

24. And moreover, hereby thou* shalt finde a wonderfull change; for by taking this course, thou shalt assu|redly have peace, and be wholly re|stored to thy former condition, thine owne eyes shall see it; and further, thou shalt have this benefit which a|bove all is most to be set by, thou shalt then cease to sin, and no more forget thy selfe towards God as before.

25. And withall, thou shalt live to* see thy children which now God hath taken from thee, restored to thee in a farre greater number.

26. And also in so doing thou shalt* prevent the Lord, and not provoke him thus to cut thee off in anger; but for all this shalt live to be crowned with a hoary head, and shalt go downe into thy grave in a compleate age, like as a shock of corne is inned into the barne in its due ripenesse.

27. Be sure that this is the onely* way; for it hath ever beene found so by all, and can be denied of none, give heed to it therefore, and make use of it for thy good, to order and steere thy course by, if ever thou wouldest land safe out of the troublesome sea of these thy miseries.

CHAP. VI.

1. Eliphaz having thus ended his* speech to *Job*, partly consist|ing of reproofe, and partly of advice; *Job* replies as followeth:

2. Thou blamest me for bewailing* my selfe, when as wo is me, my griefes are an insupportable burthen, as thou wouldest soone perceive, didst thou but feele the weight of them all toge|ther as I doe.

3. Being for number and weight* like the very sand of the sea, dost thou blame mee then for bewailing, seeing my affliction is so exceeding great that I want words to complaine enough?
4. For the grievous paines which I* endure are as so many poisoned arrowes shot into me, and that by the Almighty hand of God himselfe, which have diffused their venom into all the parts of my body and soule, and have even spent and wasted my spirits and strength with their intolerable griefe; for all the terrible afflictions and affrightments of God, have joyntly in flesh and spirit combined and set themselves in battle array against mee.
- 5.. Is it not naturall for every thing wilde or tame to lament it selfe in case of necessity and why then will not you* allow me that liberty, but condemne mee for that which is naturally common to all creatures, especially in this my extreme misery?
6. And doth not sense and experience teach you your selves, that no unsavory thing can be relished without* some seasoning, neither can a man force his appetite to thinke that to be tastefull which is not so.
7. And is not this my case? for those very things, which heretofore my soule durst not so much as thinke upon;* is it not now forced (with what sorrow and griefe you may imagine) continually to feed upon them? And will you then be so unnaturall and unreasonable as to force me unsensibly to swallow downe these afflictions which are so painfull, and not give me the liberty to season my unsavory torments with a little needfull lamentation?
8. But seeing you will not grant me liberty, I must be forced to take it; for seeing I can have no other reliefe, I* must speake my minde. O therefore that I might have my request, and that the Lord would grant mee the thing that I long for.
9. Even this, That it would please* him to destroy mee at once, that hee would no longer restraine his hand from making an end of mee, but that he would graciously dispatch me out of these torments.
10. If I could but gaine this at his* hands, to hope to be dispatched by these tortures, that I might come to be judged of God, and not of men, then would I even joy in them, and be so farre from being discouraged, as that they should animate mee in hope of mine end by them; neither would I intreat the Lord to spare mee, but would thinke them, the worse the better; for I feare not to appeare before God, because I know my conscience acquits me as having been faithfull in the sincere delivery of his truth to all that I have spoken to, how ever you may judge of it.
11. Doe you blame me for desiring* to be dissolved, when as alas, what is my strength, compared with these insupportable miseries, that I should thinke my selfe able to hold out under them, or hope for long life? and what evill can there be in mine end, that I should desire to prolong my life?

12. Sure you take mee not to be* made of flesh, or if so, yet not to be sensible that thinke me able to beare these burthens without bemoaning my selfe.
13. Me thinkes you should thinke* mee best able to judge of mine owne estate, and best to know my remedy, except you thinke mee deprived of mine understanding.
14. It is the Lords will and com|mandement;* that to him that is affli|cted, pity should be shewed from his friend; but thou, whom I have alwaies taken for my friend, hast forsaken the feare of the Lord, and hast falsified thy duty to me herein, whilest that thus in stead of comforting me, thou condem|nest mee.
15. You whom I esteemed as my* brethren, have approved your selves but hollow in friendship to mee; for because I have alwaies taken you for my friends, and have found you here|tofore in my prosperity to stand me in stead, I was in hope to have had sup|ply of comfort from you in this my need; and now you faile me, even like so many land-floods, which when a man hath use of water afford none.
16. For though in the winter sea|son,* when waters abound, they make shew to befriend us, and by their yce seeme to be our storehouses of pre|serving snow and water against the scorching time of sommer.
17. Yet when sommer comes, they* themselves grow sensible of the heat, and in stead of yeelding the refreshing they promised, as the heat of the Sunne increaseth, so they waste away by degrees, till at last, then, when there is most need they vanish quite away as if they had never beene.
18. They either finde new waies to* bestow themselves, not keeping their wonted course, but are drunke up of the earth, or else are utterly exhausted and dried up of the Sunne.
19. This the Caravan or company* of Merchants that trade unto Tema, and also those which traffique unto Sheba, have experience of, as they tra|vell through the hot desart countries of Arabia; for whereas in the winter time they have seene and travelled over frozen waters, they conceived hope to finde refreshing from them as they come that way in Sommer.
20. But when as in Sommer they* had travelled farre in confidence of them, and approching thither, where they hope to have them, they finde themselves miserably disappointed, and in so much the worse case, because they trusted in them, and then they are angry and ashamed at themselves for their owne credulity and improvi|dence to relie upon them.
21. Such like are you to mee; for* whereas I put my confidence in you, because of your former seemingnesse, now that I have use of you, you stand me in no stead, but have utterly decei|ved my hopes of kindnesse and conso|lation from you, and because you per|ceive the Sunne of affliction to be risen upon me, and feare, if you should shew

your selves the same to mee as hereto|fore, I might prove a burthen to you; therefore you turne strangers to me.

22. Me thinkes you might afford* me a few comfortable words, seeing that I neither am, nor desire to be any otherwaies beholden to you; I am sure I have given you no such cause to feare me, as should move you to as|sume this distance; for though indeed I be in want, yet I have begged no|thing of you to cause you to be thus weary of me.

23. Neither have I beene trouble|some* or chargeable to you in all my sufferings, either for rescue or ran|some of me, or any thing that is mine out of the enemies or oppressors hands.

24. I wonder wherein I should de|serve* so ill of you, I would be loth to excuse my selfe in any thing wherein I justly deserve to be blamed; there|fore if you will undertake to shew me my error, I will be willing to learne, and ready to heare, so that you can justly demonstrate to me wherein I am faulty.

25. For grave, modest, and just re|prooffe* carries authority with it, and shall ever prevaile with me; but how unconsonant to a right reprehension hath your discourse beene, being com|posed of nothing but untrue argu|ments, issuing from inconsiderate mis|prision?

26. And doe you imagine that that* which I have said, either concerning my selfe or my misery, is but so many idle and hasty words, and doe you re|prove mee thereafter, or thinke you they are meerely the fruits of a braine|sicke head, begotten by my desperate fortune, and so value them as wind?

27. Truly in so doing you are both* most uncharitable, and not unlike them that oppresse the fatherlesse by adding misery to misery in your unjust condemning me for my speeches and necessary complaints, and most un|righteous, even as they that betray the trust of a friend to his utter undoing, in going about to overthrow my only support by disputing against my up|rightnesse.

28. Now therefore be better advi|sed,* and be no more so rash to con|demne me, but consider me well, both what I am, and what I have said, and you will easily be satisfied, that I speak the truth in sobriety and knowledge of my selfe.

29. Bethinke your selves I pray you* of the cruell wrong you have offered me, I wish it for your own good, lest it prove your sinne, and procure your punishment; yea, I advise you againe to charge me no more so unjustly, but consider that you lay my very righte|ousnesse at stake (which is my onely prop in this my misery) than which you cannot doe me a greater injury.

30. When thus you charge mee* with sinfull speeches, as if I had no conscience nor feare of God to awe me from uttering perverse, unjustifi|able things in my owne behalfe.

CHAP. VII.

1. FOr I doe but aske you this* question; Is not death ap|pointed by God to every man, and whilst hee lives here, does not he spinne out his life in toile and trouble like a hireling?
2. Now then, as it is naturall for a* servant (nor can you blame him for it) being toiled out with the labour and heat of the day to desire earnestly the approach of the night to give him ease and refreshing, and as it is common with every poore labouring man to long for the end of his worke, that he may receive his reward and freedome from his toile.
3. Even so is the case with me, and* worse; for whereas their toile is mea|sured by the day, my misery is inces|sant, measured by whole moneths, and that without so much as the intermis|sion of nights.
4. For night and day are alike toil|some* to me, in so much that I can take no rest, nor finde no ease, but so soone as ever I dispose my selfe to sleepe, my easelesse mind presently growes wea|ry and restlesse, longing for day that the night were over, which is full of nothing but disquiet and continuall tossings to and fro quite throughout.
5. And you your selves cannot but* see in what miserable estate I am, be|yond all compare; for it is apparant how that my body, even now, whilst I am alive, is overrunne with wormes, and as with a garment am I covered over with scabbie clods of dirt and dust congealed in ulcerous matter which issueth from my sores, which together with my skin is chopped and broken (as the earth in drought) in most lothsome and formidable man|ner.
6. Why then should not I desire an* end, seeing my miseries crave it, and every thing tendeth toward it; for you see evidently how all my former daies of prosperity are in a moment quite dispatched, and those that remaine, you see them also waste without all hope of ever being better.
7. Consider therefore these two* things: to wit, The extraordinary end that my former daies have received, how like a puffe of wind they are sud|denly blowne over, and that withall I am never like to see more good in this life.
8. Hee that hath seene mee in my* prosperity, shall never see mee so a|gaine, thou thy selfe seest how irropa|ble my state is; so that I have rea|son to expect and looke for no other than an absolute conclusion.

9. For as the cloud is consumed by* degrees till it vanish quite away, so he that is going by degrees toward his grave, as I am, must needs looke for no recovery but necessarily expect a finall determination.

10. Which shall certainly conclude* him never to enjoy any part of his for|mer condition againe.

11. Seeing therefore that death by* Gods appointment must certainly be the end of these, I will not spare to presse him to hasten it, but will lay my misery open to the uttermost, and by all the arguments I can use, will seeke to obtaine it speedily.

12. Am I of so robustuous and un|tamable* a disposition, that thou must needs hold me in with such sharpe and mighty afflictions?

13. In so much that when I dispose* my selfe to sleepe in hope to find some ease, and to gaine some small intermis|sion of my torment:

14. Even then thou disappointst my* hope, interrupting my sleepe with frightfull dreames and visions, letting me take no rest.

15. So that if I might be mine own* carver, I would choose the very worst of deaths, so that I might but be sure to die rather than to live any longer in these intollerable pressures.

16. Which makes life (how plea|sing* soever to others) to be most irke|some to mee, in so much as though o|ther men could be content to live al|waies, yet am I of a quite differing mind, wishing rather not to live at all: and therefore I pray thee, O Lord, pro|long not my life, but give way to my miseries to make an end of mee, see|ing that all the remainder of my life must needes be empty of content and full of vexation.

17. Lord what is man? is he any* better than a thing of naught, which thou thus seemest to esteeme and make such account of?

18. Exercising a continuall provi|dence* over him for his daily preserva|tion, not suffering him rather to turne to dust, as else hee would, and exerci|sing him under long and lingring af|flictions, not dispatching him at once, as if thou wouldst, thou couldst?

19. How long wilt thou hold on* this extremity, affording me no release, not so much as a breathing while, or whilst I might swallow my spittle?

20. Wouldst thou by these tortures* racke the confession of my sinnes out of me? I confesse Lord, I am a sinner, but alas, what recompence can I make thy justice by my suffering? it is not in me to expiate my owne sinne; it is thy mercy onely must save and acquit me, for thou art the one Saviour, why then doest thou, as it were, try thy skill and power upon mee in my exquisite tor|ments, so that I am become a very bur|then to my selfe.

21. And dost not rather according* to thy gracious nature give some com|fortable and refreshing testimonies of the pardon of my transgressions, and the doing away of

mine iniquities, that so I may praise thee before the Sunne of my life be quite set, and I lie downe in the grave; for now I shall die, and then when thou lookest to receive thy morning sacrifice of praise, as afore|time, I shall not be found to give it thee.

CHAP. VIII.

1. *Bildad* the Shuhite another of *Jobs* friends, having all this while given eare to the reply which he made to *Eliphaz*, at last inter|posed himselfe, and said:
2. How long wilt thou persevere* to take such liberty of language to|ward God, and by thy violent passions, and storming speeches bring upon thy selfe fierce destruction.
3. Wilt thou make God to be un|righteous* in judgement, and the Al|mighty to goe against the rules of ju|stice, by conceiving him to inflict pu|nishment and not for sinne?
4. Take heed what thou doest, and* be not stubborne; but confesse the Lord to be just, although (thy children having sinned against him) hee hath suddenly and in his fierce displeasure, even utterly thus cut them off for their transgression.
5. And make timely use of it for* thy selfe; let it move thee before it be too late, whilst God in mercy gives thee time, to lay aside thy stubborn|nesse, and to repaire unto him in hum|ble confession, and with supplication of his pardon for thy owne sinne.
6. And doubt not, but if thou dost* now turne unto the Lord in sincerity by repentance, not justifying thy selfe, but confessing thy sinnes unfeigned|ly, without hypocrisie, which hath brought this punishment upon thee from the Lord, hee would not any lon|ger thus forget thee, but would cer|tainly remember thee in mercy, and make thee and all that belongs unto thee prosperous and blessed.
7. And though thou art now but* poore and miserable, yet then shouldst thou see the power of the Lord bring|ing to passe a wonderfull alteration in thy behalfe, by making thee both rich and happy.
8. And that thou maist be the bet|ter* perswaded to believe mee, and to take this course: consider and call to minde all the former ages of our long|lived forefathers from the beginning of the world.
9. For wee desire not to oversway* thy faith by our owne testimony, who in comparison of our fathers are of no experience nor knowledge by reason of the shortnesse of our lives now, to what theirs was then.
10. And therefore I gladly put thee o|ver* to the testimonies of former times, wherat thou canst not, except for par|tiality, and they will all teach and tell thee, and *bona fide* confirme unto thee, the very same which I have said, How that God never punished any but for their sin, nor rejected a penitent person

11. And look how ordinary a thing* it is for a mis-rooted rush that quickly springs up out of a little moisture, but not much mire, or the flag that growes without the river in some little quan|tity of water.

12. Even then, when it flourisheth* most and promiseth best unexpected|ly to wither and die (the moisture which should feed it, being exhaled and dried up) without any hand cut|ting it downe before other herbes of lesse shew but better rooting.

13. So usuall a thing it is with God* to overthrow the prosperous estate of all such as walke not humbly, nor thankfully before him, & to cause the ungrounded hopes of the hypocrite strangely by his immediate hand to pe|rish, because he was not rooted on God.

14. The foundation which he hath* laid to himselfe to hope and trust in, being rotten and unsound, shall faile him, God shall violently destroy it, and suddenly sweepe it quite away by his just iudgement.

15. He shall repose great confidence* in the felicity of himselfe, and his po|sterity, but it shall vanish, he shall pro|mise himselfe a perpetuity of it, but it shall quickly have an end.

16. Like a tree in sommer he makes* a faire shew whilst the sun of prospe|rity shines upon him; and growes luxu|riantly eminent in the place where he lives, whilst hee remaines rooted in prosperity and pleasure.

17. Possessing himselfe amply and* securely of all earthly happines, leng|thening his teather to the very utter|most bounds thereof; like a flourish|ing tree, whose roots are deeply in|trenched, and strongly incorporated into the ground, and which spread themselves so farre as ever there is any earth to receive and nourish them.

18. But for all that, when the time* comes that God will destroy and roote him out, the very place where he thus grew shall spew him out, and by any remaining symptome shall not so much as be acknown that ever he was there.

19. This is the upshot of an hypo|crites* happinesse, and this is his porti|on at last, that both he and all that was his shall come to ruine, whereas others by the blessing of God shall grow great out of a little.

20. For the case is otherwaies with* the humble and upright man. God will not rejected him, nor leave him succourlesse, no more then hee will have pity upon the proud presumptu|ous hypocrite.

21. But will be sure to remedy thy* afflictions, and not to leave thee till he have advanced thee from this lowest step of misery, to the highest step of consolation, if thou wilt but take this way of humbling thy selfe in confes|sion and supplication before him.

22. Then shall all thine enemies (who* now are risen by thy downfall) be as thou art, stript naked of all their glo|ry; and thou thy selfe restored, and this thy becomming

righteous shall make the Lord punish their wicked|nesse committed against thee with the same desolation that now hee hath brought upon thee, even with the ruine of them and theirs.

CHAP. IX.

1. THen *Job* answered *Bildad* al|so,* and said;
2. You have misunderstood* mee, if you have thought me proudly to contend with God, or that I had meant to justifie my selfe before him, by what I have said, as if I tooke my selfe to be without sinne in his sight, whereby to have deserved these plagues; for I both know and yeeld it to be true which you say, that Gods afflictions imports us to be sinners, but would you not have a man know him|selfe to be righteous, except hee know himselfe to be without sin? this were utterly to overthrow the consolation of the godly; for how is it possible for any man in such a way to appeare just before God?
3. Who, if any should be so foolish* as to thinke so of himselfe, is able quickly to stop his mouth, by objecting infinite sinnes and failings against him, one whereof hee is not able to answer.
4. And as he is thus transcendently* holy and righteous, so hee is able to judge otherwaies of us, and of our acti|ons than we can: and besides all this, his greatnesse and might also, as well as his wisdom and holinesse is infinit|ly beyond us; All this I know, and therefore I am not ignorant, how that no man can put himselfe into the lists to justifie himselfe, and contest against God, but hee shall come off with sinne and shame.
5. Seeing how farre the Lord in* his hidden wisdom, and secret waies of proceeding transcends us, oft-times manifesting his anger, even upon un|sensible things; as in over-throwing the mountaines without rendering a reason.
6. And by mighty earth-quakes, dis|locating* the globe of the whole earth, staggering the very centre it selfe, whereon it is established.
7. Commanding also the Sun con|trary* to his course to stand still, and it obeys, and dares not doe its office to the day, neither the stars to the night when he forbids.
8. Nor am I ignorant of the mani|festation* of his mighty power in his glorious workes, in that hee alone spreads forth the spacious Canopie of the heavens, and commands the furi|ous Seas.
9. And framed the glorious con|stellations* in the heavens to their ends and purposes, appointing the more re|markeable ones, to order and distin|guish the foure grand seasons of the yeere by their appearance; as *Arctu|rus* the Autumne, *Orion* the Winter,

Pleiades (or the seven stars) the Spring, and those more remote Southern stars, Midsommer; for so they take their turnes.

10. And is infinite in works, and* wonders beyond any mans capaci|ty.

11. And therefore I know my selfe* and my reason and understanding to be as unable to judge of his works and waies, though they be both reason|able and just, as my bodily eyes are to see him which is invisible, though neer unto me, and conversant about me.

12. And also I know that there can* be no man, either so powerfull to with-hold what he is minded to take from him, nor yet so righteous to que|stion him for it, seeme it never so strange.

13. And I know too, that hee pur|posely* continueth his anger upon proud contenders and disputers, till hee have convinced them, of their in|sufficiency, and compelled them to stoope to him.

14. And seeing I both know, and ac|knowledge* all this, to wit, Gods righ|teousnesse, wisdom and power to be thus transcendent to mans, I would have you know, that I am farre from contending against God, or justifying my selfe before him.

15. Whom, I know so well, that* there is not that thing, be it never so righteous in my conceit, wherein I would dare to justifie my selfe be|fore him: but in stead thereof, I would humble my selfe, and suppli|cate his grace, knowing God to be my Judge, whose eyes are so farre brighter and purer than mine.

16. And though I should have bin* so foole-hardy, to have challenged God to discusse my righteousness, and hee had done it; yet have I small cause to believe hee found me righ|teous.

17. For his hand is as heavie upon* me now, as ever, continuing the same tempestuous stormes against mee still, without any mitigation, or so much as she wing me a reason why he thus mul|tiplies miseries upon my head, and is so extreme against mee.

18. Not giving mee so much as any* the least respite or intermission, but in|cessantly pursuing me with calamities.

19. So that I have little reason to contest against his power, that know*it better than my body, or to answer the sute against him whom I know so well to exceede in justice and judge|ment; for the making good whereof, I am sure there is none will be my surety.

20. If I should undertake to justi|fie* my selfe, God in interrogating me upon particulars would make mine owne mouth condemne and witnesse against mee, and for him; if I should stand upon my perfection with him, he would shew such cause to the contra|ry, that he would make me with mine owne lips, pronounce my selfe faulty, and a foole for mine undertaking.

21. Yea, if I were so blind as to see* nothing blame-worthy by my selfe, yet knowing God as I doe, I would not believe mine owne heart, nor know mine owne soule upon termes of inno|cencie, but would attribute it to mine ignorance, and in the matter of justifi|cation would utterly disclaime the in|nocencie of my life and conversa|tion.*

22. But notwithstanding, yet is the point true which I have maintained, to wit, That God in his outward pro|ceedings & dispensations, maketh no difference many times, but scourgeth and takes away both the upright and the wicked alike: and therefore doe I still affirme, that because of mine af|flictions, you have no just cause to judge and condemne me for an hypo|crite, or wicked person.*

23. In regard that daily experience contradicts your rule (wherewith you ignorantly limit and measure Gods proceedings) palpably evidencing, That God exempts not the upright from afflictions, no, not from his sud|denest and most remarkable judge|ments, but that in these outward things all comes alike to all: God scorning the allegation of innocency, or the ju|stification and plea of the most up|right man breathing, in the way of ex|emption or prevention of these his just and wise dispensations when he plea|seth to inflict them.

24. As also it is not apparant how* the honour and pleasure of the world is transferred upon the worser sort of men, that are wicked, and abuse it, when in the meane time, those that to us seeme deservedly to be respected and honoured for their wisdom and uprightness are despised and disgra|ced, and pray you, how, or by whom comes it to passe, but by Gods all-dis|posing hand? so that you must either grant what I say, or deny common ex|perience and Gods providence.

25. 26. And may not I my selfe passe* as a lively paterne of Gods proceeding in this kind; For what availeth my up|rightnesse in this day of my visitation?* hath not God (who in all the former part of my life, made me honourable among men, notwithstanding it) now laid all mine honour in the dust, even in a moment, and given the wicked leave to trample on me?*

27. And hath hee not so bitterly afflicted mee, that if I goe but about to seeke a little ease or comfort.

28. The sense and weight of mine* accumulated sorrowes, straight-way affright me, and tell mee it is in vaine, assuring me, that the Lord, according to his high and just prerogative, hath chosen mee out to be the example of this age to shew forth his transcendent righteousness upon, notwithstanding my uprightnesse.

29. And truely, Lord, if thou beest* pleased to goe this way to worke with mee, to set thy selfe in the rigour of thy Justice to finde out my sinnes, and so to judge me according to my wic|kednesse: In vaine then I confesse, Lord, doe I seeke to comfort my selfe; for in thy sight no flesh can be justified and acquit.

30. For though I could prove mine* innocency never so, and that I were in mine owne account and the worlds blamelesse;

31. Yet art thou able so to lay mee* open, if in thy righteous severity thou wilt judge mee, as that I shall appeare monstrously filthy to my selfe and all the world, yea, mine owne very righ|teousnesse wherein I cloath my selfe, shall renounce and abhorre both it selfe and me.*

32. For alas, he being God, judgeth mee with another manner of judge|ment than I can judge my selfe, or then one man can judge another, he seeth further, and knoweth more by mee, than I am able to doe by my selfe be|ing but man, and therefore it were a very vaine thing in me to offer to wage Law with God in mine owne justifi|cation.

33. Neither if I had such a minde,* could I be ever the better; for where is there any fit to be umpire betweene us, his way of judging and accusing farre transcending both Angells and men?

34. But if the Lord would deale so* graciously with me, as not to proceed against me in the rigour and perfecti|on of his judgement and justice where|at I tremble, and against which I am able to plead nothing for my selfe; and dispute mine uprightnesses with me in your stead as man:

35. Then I durst plead for my selfe,* and could soone make it appeare, that I am innocent, and no hypocrite, as you would force upon me; but since the Lord is pleased not to go that way to worke, but that he is determined to set himselfe as God against mee, my mouth must needs be stopped.

CHAP. X.

1. MY anguish drives me to those* extremities, that it makes me weary of my life. And see|ing that hitherto I have acknow|ledged my guiltinesse in hope to have found ease thereby, and yet notwith|standing my grieve remaines unasswa|ged: Now therefore I am determined to accuse my selfe no longer before Gods secret Justice, but to seeke mine owne ease by giving vent to mine af|fection.

2. And therefore I will take the* boldnesse to enter more familiar par|ley with God, and to intreat of him, That hee will either cease to proceed against mee as a guilty person, being innocent, or else that he will shew me the cause of this his quarrell with me.

3. As first whether he dealeth thus* with mee, because it is either profit or pleasure to him to oppresse mee, which I cannot thinke it is, for it can|not be that God should be a gainer, or should take delight to oppresse, or to reject and despise his owne workman|ship, as I am, especially when as there|by hee shall fulfill the desires, and confirme the unjust surmises of the wicked.

4. Or secondly, Whether is it that* hee needeth to doe by mee as earthly judges do by malefactours, that is, tor|ture me, to discover the truth, whe|ther I be sincere or no; neither is this likely; for hee hath all-seeing eyes, and therefore need not helps to make discoveries.

5. 6. Neither thirdly is it because he* is mortall and short-lived like man, That hee thus heapeth these punish|ments* upon me in this sudden and se|vere manner, as if else hee should not have time enough to try me, and to re|venge himselfe upon mee, for the ini|quity and sin which thereby he should discover, for he is everlasting.

7. It is not because thou knowst me* not, and therefore wouldst find me out, that thou thus handlest me; for I know thou knowest mee well enough, that I am upright. Neither is it for want of power to make me forth-coming; but of thine owne just prerogative: for were I not approved in thy sight, yet thou hast no need to hold me thus fast in fetters; for thou knowest it is impossible for mee by any meanes to escape thy hands, either by flight or rescue.

8. For I am no stranger to thee, but* thine own very workmanship, even e|very part and portion of me from top to toe is both created and framed by thee, and none but thee. And yet (strange to consider) for all these rea|sons to the contrary, thou thus de|stroyest mee.

9. But I beseech thee remember* that as I am the worke of thine hands; so againe, of what matter thou hast made mee; how that originally I am but clay, and what honour and event canst thou expect to follow upon thy fighting against such a worme with these thy omnipotent weapons, but to turne dust into dust?

10. And as in *Adam* I am but clay,* so alas, thou knowest, how in my selfe I am framed by thee, of a weake and imperfect substance, to wit, the liquid seed of mine immediate parents.

11. From whence, indeed, by thy* wisdom and power thou hast made to proceed skin and flesh as clothing to every part of my body, and an orderly juncture of bones and sinewes.

12. In which fabricke of my body* thus composed in the wombe, thou hast further magnified thy selfe by adding a reasonable soule thereunto, with all requisit & favourable accom|modations for my life and well-being, which very life and soule, as thou only gavest it, so also hast thou alone hither|to preserved it by thy providence and good grace; for it long ere this had been inanimated, hadst not thou kept it alive, by thy carefull preservation, sweet influences, and often visitations of my spirit which thou hast made me sensible of.

13. And therefore I know, that how|ever* thou seemest outwardly to deale with me, yet thou art secretly mind|full of this fabricke, which thou hast thus built, and that this my spirit is especially pretious with thee.

14. Or in the fourth place, is it as* they affirme? am I hypocritically sin|full, and therefore doest thou punish me? Indeed if I be such an one, then I know it is true, thou wilt be sure to marke mee and not to let mee escape unpunished.
15. If thou shouldest know this* wickednesse by me, then wo unto me; and though in this sense I know my selfe to be righteous, yet will I not justifie my selfe before thee, because I know my sinnes otherwaies to have deserved thine indignation. And now that I have thus vented my selfe by ex|postulating with thee, I am but the further plunged into confusion, not being able to satisfie my selfe, or to give my minde any ease; so that I see this is not the way neither, but when all is done, I must petition thy supre|macy, and intreat thee with pity to be|hold my misery.
16. For it growes insupportable,* thy pursute of mee being so Lion-like extremely fierce and violent: and as if no one torment could be sufficient for thee to plague mee with, thou as|saultst me againe and againe, in a mar|vellous manner to expresse thy wrath upon mee.
17. Thou shewest wonderous en|mity* against me, by charging so thicke upon mee with such succession of af|flictions; and store of troubles by thine appointment execute thy severe indignation upon mee: yea, even all variety of evils both severally in their turnes, and joyntly in one set-battle, doe make warre against me.
18. If thou hast conceived such dis|pleasure* against mee, why didst thou not rather in thy fore-knowledge, de|cree it, that I should never have beene borne to cause thine anger, or else have died so soone as I had bin born? O that I had beene so happy never to have knowne, or beene knowne of any!
19. The very imagination where|of* delights me in this mine extremity, to thinke what happinesse it would have beene to me, either not to have beene at all, or to have beene in such a way, as that my being had been equi|valent to no being, considering that as the wombe delivered me, so the grave should have received me.
20. But seeing thou hast ordered it* otherwaies, and that thou hast or|dained mee to live, yet consider that my life is but short, in which time slacke thy hand, and allow mee some little ease and comfort.
21. 22. And cause mee not to die* whilst I live, nor to be in darkenesse whilst I enjoy light, seeing ere long I shall sustaine thine indignation in the grave (by the concluding punish|ment* of death) certainly never to re|turne againe to life, nor to enjoy this light; where I expect no better than confusion, and an absolute de|privation of the comforts both of life and light; for there I am sure is no vicissitude or order of time be|twene night and day, but all the comfortable daies of life and pros|peritie shall certainly be turned into uncomfortable lasting darknesse, then which it can afford no other.

CHAP. XI.

1. Then *Zophar* the Naamathite,* another of *Jobs* friends, ha|ving been attentive to all that hee had said, in reply to his two former companions, rejoines upon him with another like vexing dis|course, thus:
2. Should we suffer him thus to pro|ceed,* and not answer him, but let him thinke to carry the cause of his owne justification by his much speaking, and in the meane time, wee through silence become guilty of his sinne by a tacit consent?
3. Should we swallow such an un|sufferable* untruth and not reply, and wouldst thou thus carry it against God and man, and not be made to see thine errour?
4. In maintaining such a blasphe|mous* opinion for true doctrine; That God destroyeth the righteous, and that thou whom God hath so branded for a wicked person, yet dares to af|firme thy selfe not to be wicked?
5. But I could wish that God would* vouchsafe to answer thee in stead of us by his way of conviction, that so thou mightest be made to believe by sense, what now thou wilt not by reason.*
6. And that hee would but make thee to know what he in his wisdom knowes by thee, then shouldest thou soone be confuted and put to shame, and the vaine imaginations of thine own righteousness would quite vanish, because then thy conscience would shew thee how that thy sins are infinit more then thou imaginest, so that though now thou complainest of hard dealing, thou wouldest then see that God in justice might deservedly for thy sinnes inflict double upon thee to that thou now sufferest.*
7. Thou hast beene foole-hardy to speake thy minde over-freely concer|ning Gods dealing with thee, and by presumptuous reasonings thou hast thought to plum his depth, and either thou wilt see such cause as thou in thy weake capacity shalt thinke rea|sonable for his thus afflicting thee, or else thou wilt dare to quarrell him; but now vaine man, what art thou the better? hast thou so little reason as to thinke that thou art able to see so into thy selfe as God, and so equall him in wisdom, and fathome his per|fection?
8. 9. Wilt thou offer to give bounds* to, and comprehend within thy weake reason the unsearchable wisdom of Gods incomprehensible Judgement* and Justice which is of as large and larger extent than heaven and hell, sea and land?
10. If he change his course or way* of proceedings toward men, either to deliver them into the hands of ene|mies, or if hee will protect and save them, who can controll or hinder him; for hee doth invincibly whatsoever he will.
11. For hee hath both reason and* justice on his side for what he doth to man, who although by searching hee cannot attaine to know the perfection of the wisdom and righteousness of God; yet does God easily know him what ever he thinks of himselfe; how that his best perfection is but vanity: neither (if wee were able to judge a|right)

have we reason to think that he punisheth or afflicteth causlessly; for though our selfe-flattery mis-take, yet hee sees wickednesse to deserve it. And thinke wee then that hee should doe well to let us goe on in our error, and should not rather take notice of it to punish us for it, and to rectifie our judgement in it?

12. For man would have some un|derstanding,* pragmatically to discerne and expostulate the waies of God by his weake and shallow reason, though hee be as farre short of conceiving and comprehending them, as the brutishest creature living is to conceive and ap|prehend rationall matters.

13. 14. Therefore be perswaded to* lay downe the wasters, to give over reasoning the matter, and to beginne now at last to change thy course, and* in sincerity and humility of heart to submit thy selfe, confessing thy sinnes, and putting them away by repen|tance.

15. For then maist thou with good* hope and confidence draw neere to God without any check of conscience, and be established in safe condition, and shalt neede to feare neither the continuance nor the returne of these thy troubles upon thee.

16. For in so doing thou shalt be* restored, and made to remember thy griefes as past, and no longer to feelee them as present.

17. And so shall the rest of thy life* which thou givest for lost, be the very prime part of thy time for glory, and thou shalt shine againe in reputation and honour, and shalt appeare in the eyes of all men as the Sunne rising af|ter the departure of a cloudy and dark night.

18. And though heretofore for all* thy potencie thou hast beene despoi|led of all, yet (hereby) for hereafter thou shalt enjoy both thee and thine in security; for because then thou shalt have God for thy God to rest thy hope upon, who shall so encompass thee with his safe protection, as if thou dost but digge a place to pitch thy tent in, thou shalt enjoy thy selfe safelier ther|in (than otherwaies thou wouldest doe in a walled City.)

19. Nor shalt thou need to secure* thy selfe by watch and ward, because then thou shalt have no cause to feare, for thy very enemies shall make suit for thy favour and protection.

20. But if thou perseverest in thy* wicked way, long maist thou looke for better before thou finde it; for God will never ease thee, till he have hum|bled thee: And therefore, if thou thus continuest, thy hope shall be utterly forlorne, and at an end for any good ever to befall thee.

CHAP. XII.

1. ANd *Job* answered and said;*

2. In the blind confidence* of your owne wisdom you take upon you to condemne me as ignorant, and to censure that which I have said, to be but as the babbling of a foole, as if none were wise besides your selves.
3. But notwithstanding that you* thus sleight me, yet am I sure that God hath given me grace to know and understand the truth better than you that are so overweening, and, that you have said nothing hitherto, but what are common things, and which I know as well as you.
4. But it is befalling mee as it is common* in the world: That hee that is poore and in misery, in stead of being comforted, is contemned of his nearest friends, so that the things which I speake are set light by and scorned, and which is worst of all, because of Gods indulgencie to your particulars for present, you are puffed up in your owne opinions, and sticke not also to trample upon, and scoffe at my very innocencie.
5. In so much as now, because I am* falling into misery, and am neere unto mine end, I must be rejected, as if I were a thing offensive and uselesse, like a candle which is almost consumed to the snuffe, though formerly shining and giving light to others, having now all the light of my former understanding quite extinguished, and mine innocency condemned for hypocrisie, and I scorned as refuse, and judged as a cast-away in the opinion of these men, and that for no other reason, but because they are in prosperity, and I in adversity.
6. Whereas, alas, their maxime is* utterly false; for prosperity is no signe of honesty (and consequently adversity no signe of hypocrisie) as wee may see by daily experience; for who abound more in externall felicity than those whom wee see to be notoriously wicked?
7. 8. It is strange you should be ignorant* of this common truth, which all the creatures are able to demonstrate; for doe not you see the earth and all the things that are in it given* for the most part into the hands of the wicked, what large possessions and sumptuous fare they enjoy?
9. And who, I pray, under wilfull* ignorance, can be said, not to know that it is God who orders it thus?
10. For, is it not hee that disposeth* of every creature, both small and great, better and worse, man or beast?
11. Oh that then you would not be* so rash to speake, but would let your eares doe their office, and would ponder what I say! then you could not but conceive that I speake with understanding, and that this doctrine of Gods administration of things in this way which I have said, is an undoubted truth.
12. Especially, seeing you are men* of great yeeres, and therefore cannot but have attained to much understanding by observation and frequent experience, and therefore must needs know.

13. That God is often times won|derfully* transcendent in his wisdom and power wherewith hee orders and disposeth things; and how that hee brings to passe his ends and purposes in an unknown and incomprehensible way.

14. As may appeare by these fol|lowing* instances (whereby you shall see that I both know, & acknowledge the unsearchable wisdom and won|derfull waies of God as well as you, in all which he is righteous, (though we know not the reason of them:) For behold, he brings some men, and some things to their utter destruction: for, as that all the wit and power of man cannot repaire them, oft-times so dis|abling a man, that all the helps in the world cannot relieve him.

15. Againe, wee see how various* and wonderfull hee is in raine and drought, how by this hee often fa|misheth the earth, and by that he gluts and overwhelmeth it.

16. So that both I and all the world* must needes acknowledge, what hath beene said, not only of the wonderfull power, but also of the unsearchable wisdom of God, if we doe but consi|der these effects aforesaid: But much more if wee well weigh those which follow, which are more strange to rea|son than any thing that hath beene al|leged; and yet I know they are of God too; For it is of his Almighty and wise disposing, even that such a man is a deceiver, and such an one is de|ceived.

17. And that all the eminent and* wonderfull changes which wee see in the world doe come to passe: It is of him, that those men, who have beene advanced for their wisdom, and are the bull-warks of a state to keepe out forraigne enemies, are themselves oft|times made a prey; and also that those learned Judges, who by administring right, and maintaining peace, keep the Common-wealth from civill dissenti|on and ruine, doe themselves (when pleaseth him) become fooles, and lose their labour.

18. And that those mighty Mo|narchs,* whose regiment extendeth far and neere, and had much people in subjection, have those bonds loosed wherein they held others, and they themselves become tributary.

19. And so also nationall princes,* hee oft-times causeth them to be o|vercome and dethroned, thus doth he drive the mighty men of the earth into exigents and distresses by his dis|posing power, notwithstanding their confidence in their strength.

20. Or if they trust in their wise|dome* and abundance of Counsellors it is all one; for when he pleaseth, he removes faithfull Counsellors, sending flatterers in stead of friends, and infa|tuates the aged men that are men of experience on whom they build.

21. Nor can the Majesty of their* place secure them; for God when he <1 page duplicate> <1 page duplicate> <1 page duplicate> <1 page duplicate> is pleased to bring his purpose to passe, often makes them notwithstanding their dignities to be despised both at home and abroad. And thus he laieth all their confidences whatsoever in the dust.

22. Nor doe I thinke that hee doth* these things to exercise a tyrannicall power over his creatures, but that hee hath just reason for what hee doth, though we know it not, which some|times also hee is pleased to discover; for many times wee see what hellish secrets he brings to light, which when we know, we cannot but conclude his righteous judgements.

23. And as thus hee manifesteth* his righteous (though transcendent) power and wisdom upon Princes; so also upon people: for how have wee knowne him to increase nations, and anon to ruine them, and to enlarge their reputation and authority, and straightway to diminish it?

24. And lastly, who is it but he that* doth dispose the greatest part of the people of the world to have no right understanding, but to waste their lives in error?

25. Not vouchsafing to reveale to* them the light of truth, but suffering them to go from error to error.

CHAP. XIII.

1. SO that you may see I am not a* stranger to the power and wis|dome of God, in his wonderfull ordering and disposing of things, but have taken diligent notice of it in the whole course of my life.

2. And therefore am not to be con|demned* as one that is ignorant of God by you, that can say no more of him than what I both know and believe, nor to be thought to have spoken what I have said all this while touch|ing Gods dealing with mee, out of an ignorant presumption, but out of a faithfull knowledge both of God and my selfe.

3. In so much as I desire to conferre* with God in stead of you; for because I know him to be perfectly wise and able to judge aright of things, which I finde you are not.

4. For through your ignorance,* you create false maxims to judge me by, and so like unskillfull Physicians you administer mistaken physike.

5. O therefore that I could but in|treate* you to be your owne friends and mine, so farre as to keepe silence, wherein you should shew more wise|dome by farre, than in what you have said.

6. And have patience to heare what* I shall say for my selfe against your al|legations, and for your instruction.

7. Know therefore, that wheras you* judge me to sinne against God, in that which I speake for my selfe, the of|fence is on your part; so how thinke you? Is it not a sinne with unjust ar|guments to patronize Gods justice, and as if hee stood in need of your lies, to plead his cause with forged un|truths?

8. Thinke you to please God by* shewing him any unjust favour in the maintenance of his cause against mee, or, as if hee were too weake to doe it himselfe; therefore doe you thinke to doe him a pleasure in taking upon you to frame arguments for him?
9. Be well advised, Doe you thinke* that this kind of dealing will hold wa|ter with God, and will you venture him to finde out your colloquing, and by-respects? thinke you by flattery and part-taking to deceive and curry favour with God, as with man?
10. How ever you may thinke you* doe him acceptable service in these your unjust gratifications, yet assured|ly he will shew that he abhorreth such dealings, and that hee will be main|tained by his own righteousnesse with|out borrowing mens leasings: Nay, and though you doe it with never so plausible reasons in the eyes of men, yet you shall find that he that knoweth the heart, and hateth all accepting of persons, if hee spie unjust partiality there, though never so secret, hee will certainly punish you for it.
11. Shall not the majesty and ex|cellency* of God make you afraid to have such base thoughts of him? and his dreadfull greatnesse affright you out of such low conceits?
12. What? are such fraile creatures* as you able to advantage God? who shall your selves be utterly extinct and forgotten as a thing of naught, and whose bodies shall be turned to earth.
13. Pray, vouchsafe me the favour* to hold your peace, and let me speake my mind without interruption, and at my perill be it, take you no thought.
14. Seeing you have so grossely er|red* in what you have said, both con|cerning God and my selfe, and that for certaine it is Gods way to exercise the righteous under afflictions; wherefore then should I be so foolish thus to tor|ment my selfe, and cast away my con|fidence, for any thing that you say,* or that I suffer?
15. No, I will never doe it, in so much, as if God should proceed, not onely to lay upon me the extremity of affliction, but should also thereby bring me to deaths doore, yet I would continue to relie upon his mercy, and withall, I would defend mine honest sincerity before him to the last.
16. For I am sure, notwithstanding* my extreme affliction, the Lord both is, and will be my salvation, pardoning my sinne, and accepting my person; in confidence whereof, I dare put my selfe into the presence of God, which no hypocrite dare doe.
17. Therefore, doe not rashly cen|sure* me, but give good heed to that which I speake, and to the professi|on of my faith which I make.
18. For though you through igno|rance* and prejudice know not how to judge of mee, yet be sure I have exa|mined my selfe, and maturely conside|red mine own case, my faith and good conscience; and therefore whatsoever you think, I know upon good grounds, that for all mine affliction, God doth not punish mee for my sinnes, but that still hee accounts mee innocent and righteous.

19. Whereof I am so confident, as* that I dare encounter any upon this point; and indeed, you have so tormen|ted me by your reasonings, as that if I have not liberty granted me to justifie mine owne innocency, my heart will burst within me.
20. And if it shall please the Lord* himselfe to argue this case with me, I will but desire two conditions of him, and then I will not feare even to ap|peare before him.
21. One is, that he would take off* from mee this heavie hand of his pre|sent affliction which overwhelmeth me with the violence of it, till my mat|ter be heard: the other is, that hee would give mee courage to beare out this my humble contestation, so as I may not be confounded with the ter|rour of his dreadfull greatnesse so far surpassing mee.
22. Then oppose thou, and I will* answer, or let mee speake, and an|swer thou me.
23. Therefore I humbly aske of* thee, is it for any such greatnesse and multitude of iniquities and sinnes (as these men would beare mee in hand) that thou thus afflictest me? Then I beseech thee, make me to know that great transgression and sinne that hath so enraged thee against me; for I am not conscious to my selfe of any such, nor can I make it sinke into my mind, that thou thus afflictest me upon any such ground.
24. And if not, then wherefore dost* thou thus terribly frowne upon me, so as to give the world cause to thinke thou hatest me? Alas, am I fit to be esteemed an enemy worthy thy con|testing with?
25. Or dost thou thinke it will be* any glory to thee to try thy strength, and to fight hand to hand with mee, who am a weake and feeble creature, not able to stand against thee, no more than a leafe before the winde, or stubble before the fire?
26. For thou arrestest me with ma|nifold* & bitter plagues, and seemest as if thou couldest not be severe enough against mee, and makest mee oft-times to remember my former sinnes of old with fresh feare, as if they were unpar|doned, and as if thou didst lay the pu|nishment of them all on mee now at once.
27. For thou proceedest with all* severity against me, as against a grand malefactor, laying mee fast in afflicti|ons, as in stocks, so that I can move no way to finde ease, and hast set, as it were, a watch over me, surrounding me with plagues, lest any way I should get liberty, and followest mee with continuall pursuit as a prisoner that is dog'd at heeles by his keeper from place to place lest he should escape.
28. And now, alas, what glory will* all this be to thee at last, seeing I a man am not able to stand against thee, but rot and consume away under thy plagues, which wasteth me as a moth wasteth a garment?

CHAP. XIV.

1. THou knowst also, that if thou* didst not use extraordinary meanes against me, yet by my very nature and kind coming of mor|tall parents, I like other men, should in a short time, consume and die; and this life, as short as it is, is also of it selfe full of troubles.
2. We, thou knowest, bring morta|lity* and transitorinesse into the world with us, and that little temporall felicity which wee enjoy, is quickly at an end; for as the flowers, so we have no more than a spring and a fall; or as the shadow of a diall, our lives are continually hasting to their period, and never make stop.
3. And dost thou set thy selfe strictly* to view the imperfections of such a creature, and to question mee in the rigour of thy righteous judgement?
4. Why, thou knowest, if thou proceed* in that way, I must needs be cast, that am even borne a sinner, as every man else is; for must not a corrupt tree needs bring forth corrupt fruit?
5. But seeing that as we are sinners* by nature, so by sinne we are mortall, and that thou hast determined death as a condigne punishment unto man (and so to me) so that he must certainly* undergoe it at the time appointed by thee, nor is he able to lengthen his life a minute further than thy decree.
6. O then in mercy let that suffice* thee, and make not his whole life a death, but take thy heavie hand off him, that hee may be able to fulfill his appointed time in thy service here, which is but short.
7. 8. 9. For what will it avails thee* to destroy man, seeing it is not with him, as it is with other of thy creatures? for let a tree be felled and though the root thereof lie in the earth (as a dead man does in the grave,) yet there is a* great deale of difference; for there is hope to him that owneth it that it will spring againe, and be profitable to* him, by reason of some sap and moisture that it will draw out of the earth, whence it hath his vegetative life and being.
10. But it is quite otherwaies with* man; for, when hee dieth, the earth, nor nothing else, can contribute any thing to him to make him live againe, or in the least measure be serviceable to his owner here; but on the contrary, he consumeth to dust, and becom|meth utterly uselesse: for, when man once gives up the ghost, there is no further hope of him.
11. For, as the waters which after* some exundation of the Sea, or some great river are separated and left (up|on the reflux thereof) behind the rest upon the land, which cannot returne nor continue, but therefore utterly drieth up and evaporate:
12. So man, having once given up* the ghost, is quite separated from the source of life, never to be united, nor to live againe, till the day of the utter dissolution of all things.
13. O, that this were my lot, and* that thou wouldest grant me the grave for my portion, so to escape the horrors that are upon me, and that (so doing) thou

wouldest set downe even what time thou pleasest to raise me out againe, so that thou wouldest but be sure at last to remember me.

14. Then should I thinke my selfe* happy, because, if I be once dead, I know I shall no more returne to these miseries, upon which condition, I would be glad to waite with patience what time soever thou shouldest allot me to lie in the grave, in assurance of a happy change to follow.

15. For though thou afflictest mee* in this life, yet am I sure in the resur|rection to feele thy mercies; so as that when thou callest, I shall not need to feare (as the hypocrites will) to shew my face; for I know that thou thy selfe, for the love thou bearest mee of thy goodnesse, who am thy creature, and one whom thou hast shewne fa|vour, and reprinted thine Image: wilt long after the consummation of my happinesse.

16. And indeed, seeing such happi|nesse* would certainly ensue, who can blame me to desire my dissolution, to be rid of this wofull pressure that lies upon me? For now thou persecutest me with thy utmost severity, seeming to take most strict notice of every by|way that ever I have trod, and as if thou didst watch over my sinnes, that not one of them should escape unpu|nished.

17. Thou hast, as it were, sealed* up and made sure worke with all my sinnes that ever I committed, to have them now forth-comming for the in|crease of my punishment.

18. And now, Lord, if the strong* mountaines and hard rockes are not able to stand when thou thunderest with thy power upon them, but that they come to nought, and remove out of their place:

19. And if the very stones be worn,* and doe waste with the falling of wa|ters upon them, and that the things that are rooted in the earth cannot re|sist a deluge, but are washt away there|with, what hope then has weake man (such an one as I am) who is neither rocke nor mountaine, stone nor tree, to be able to stand under such an in|supportable power, and overwhel|ming inundation as this of mine?

20. No, it is impossible for him to* sustaine himselfe when thine hand is upon him to destroy him: thou canst not be prevented, but he shall certain|ly, fade away, he himselfe, and all that behold him shall see him consume by the change that thine afflicting hand worketh in his temperament and fea|ture, till at last hee waste away to no|thing.

21. Yea, by reason of his dolour,* even whilst hee yet lives thou canst make him to be as good as dead, so as that hee can regard no earthly thing how neerely soever it concerne him; as for instance, be his children advan|ced, or be they cast into adversity, shall neither joy nor sorrow in it.

22. But be altogether taken up* with the thoughts and sense of his owne misery, because of the outward paine, which thou laiest upon his bo|dy, and the inward trouble which thou inflicttest upon his minde at once.

CHAP. XV.

1. THEN *Eliphaz* the Themanite* being further confirmed in his ill conceit of *Job*, by his discourse, thus the second time replies upon him.
2. Is it the property of a wise man,* such an one as thou wouldest be thought to be, under a pretence of much knowledge thus to abound in vaine discourse, and satisfie himselfe with feeding upon, not onely unprofi|table and airy, but hurtfull reasonings; blasting thereby all hopes of better to himselfe?
3. Or if thou wert wise, as thou* saiest, why then hast thou pleaded for thy selfe all this while with so much empty and fruitlesse talke, no whit ser|ving to thine advantage, but contrari|ly making against thee, both in re|spect of thine uprightness which thou talkest of, and the ease which wee wish thee?
4. For thy discourse hath beene* most presumptuous and arrogant, sa|vouring of nothing but folly and hy|pocrisie, in all this time neither hum|bling thy selfe under the hand of God, nor calling upon him for grace and mercy, which is the only upright, wise, and safe way.
5. But in stead thereof hast made* thy mouth the trumpet of thine owne evill heart, rather choosing deceitful|ly to make good an evill cause, than to confesse thy sinne.
6. So that thou hast no cause to* thinke hardly of me and my fellowes, as if wee did unjustly condemne thee, for thine owne mouth is evidence e|nough against thee.
7. Art thou the onely man of ex|perience* or knowledge, beyond all that now is, or that ever was?
8. Hath God made thee of his pri|vie* councill, and told thee more than hee hath revealed to others, and dost thou thinke all the world fooles be|side thy selfe?
9. What knowest thou that wee* know not? What understandest thou more than wee?
10. Nay, me thinkes modesty and* reason should perswade thee, that wee are abler to instruct thee, than thou us, wee being more for number, and ha|ving the advantage of experience and observation (which maketh wise men) by reason of our yeeres, which are so farre beyond thine, that thy father was younger than some of us.
11. And wherein canst thou say* that wee have erred; for have we not shewed thee the true way to be happy and freed from these miseries? and dost thou set so light by our advise, which tendeth to so good an end as to reconcile thee with God? Dost thou know any better way to compasse thy happinesse than this which wee have told thee? If thou dost, it is such an one as neither wee nor our fathers ne|ver knew nor heard of.

12. If not, why dost thou give thine* heart such liberty to rove out of the right way, and perversly shut thine eyes against the truth, scornfully re|jecting it?

13. For thou in stead of humbling* thy selfe under the punishment of thy sinne, sufferest thy selfe with an in|censed minde to contest against God, and to speake such proud impenitent speeches, justifying thine owne righ|teousnesse, and maintaining (contrary to truth and equity) that these punish|ments are not laid upon thee for thy sinnes.

14. Whereas the perfectest man* living is uncleane before God, and justly liable to his wrath; for there neither is, nor ever was, or can be, any that can justly affirme that of himselfe which thou arrogatest, to wit, that he is righteous in the sight of God.

15. Why man, his excellentest crea|tures,* the glorified Angells, which in|deed are, and ever shall be, Saints in heaven, yet they stand not in that holy and happy estate, by their owne power and sufficiency, but by the meere de|cree of God, which in grace hee past upon them, knowing, that else they would have sinned, as other their fel|lowes did, which, though they were Angells, which of all his creatures are the best and perfectest, and dwelt in heaven, which of all places is the best and holiest; yet even in them, and there, his holy and pure eyes found uncleannesse.

16. How much more then must* man that dwells here on earth, needs be exceeding sinfull and uncleane in his sight, who does as familiarly sinne, as eate and drinke, and to whom it is naturally as pleasing as water is to one athirst.

17. Thou hast had leave to speake* thy minde, and now give mee the like liberty, and the like eare, and I will shew thee no fable, but a known truth; which both I have learned out of mine owne experience;

18. And which hath not been mine* observation onely, but hath received confirmation from wise men of former times, who have carefully taught it as a doctrinall truth from the tradition of their forefathers also; and have not concealed it from us their successours, as is well enough knowne.

19. I say, from their fathers, the first* heads of the world, who in those daies of prime antiquity were free from the injuries and molestations of forrainers and enemies (which we are too apt to make the sole or principall cause of our suffering) people being then few and rare in the earth, and knowne to one another.

20. Even this, the wicked mans por|tion* in this life, which is; That God is wont to lay upon him lasting paines, and (weary of his life) to make him waste his daies in discomfort, and that the oppressours gaine is to get the cutting short the thread of his owne life in judgement.

21. And a terrifying conscience* shall sill him with distracting feares; together with an unexpected ruine in the midst of all his wealth and worldly glory.

22. And then, when God has cast* him into affliction, to be without all hope of better, his heart telling him that God will never take his hand off againe, but that in stead of being deli|vered from this, a further evill, even utter destruction waits upon him.

23. When the Lord hath made him* taste adversity, and thereby ruined his comfortable subsistence in the crea|ture, then shall he through want of ac|quaintance with God and faith in him, in a wrong way impatiently, indirect|ly, and fruitlessly seeke to relieve and helpe himselfe; his affrighted con|science and distrustful heart (quite ba|nishing all hope of better) mis-doubt|ing every day to be his doomes-day.

24. He shall live in continuall feare* by reason of his inward and outward trouble and griefe, which he shall not be able to avoid nor resist, but shall be brought under their extreme pressure, because of the vehement fury and ir|resistable power wherewith on all hands they shall assault him.

25. And there is reason for it, why* God should thus proceed against him, because he behaves himself as a proud enemy toward God, not walking hum|bly before him; but disobediently and presumptuously through an over|weening opinion, sticketh not to cast away all feare, and arrogantly to make head against even the Almighty Lord of heaven and earth, forgetting him to be such an one, through the haughty and presumptuous imaginations of his heart.

26. Daring with a full forehead* and strange kinde of arrogancy to en|counter God, even upon the points of his justice and righteous judgements, wherein hee is the ablest to give us the shooke, and which is the dangerousest for us to oppose or question.

27. And the cause of this his swel|ling* pride against God, is his abound|ing in the creature, and his voluptuous usage of it.

28. Together with his large signio|ries* and ample possessions, made up out of the ruines of other mens liveli|hoods and habitations, which they have beene forced to relinquish and leave desolate through his oppres|sions.

29. Yet for all this confident prepa|ration,* he shall come short of his aime; for hee shall neither attaine that hight of riches which hee strives for, or the stability of an happy estate which hee promiseth himselfe by them, neither shall he perpetuate his name with that renowne and preheminance, that hee makes confident of to himselfe and his posterity thereby.

30. But in steed thereof, hee shall* be cast into calamitous poverty and re|proch under which he shall irrecove|rably lie, all his flourishing state shall wither, and his large posterity be ut|terly consumed through the indigna|tion of the Lord, and when hee hath lived to taste and see this, then at last God shall breath forth his finall dis|pleasure upon him, and so shall hee quite perish, who but ere-while pro|mised to himselfe certaine felicity.

31. Let not the man then that hath* already miscarried by his foolish pride, still take that way, and be vain|ly blinded by it, for hee shall still re|ceive the same reward, vanity and mi|sery shall be his recompence.
32. In his owne life hee shall see* his pride have a fall, his eyes shall be|hold his present happinesse and fu|ture confidence come to nought.*
33. He shall live to see the untimely death of his children, and the utter losse of his after expectation.
34. For it is certaine that God will* unnest & ruinate the hypocritestocke and family, and the fire of his wrath shall consume what they have built up by secret fraud and injustice.
35. So that in the end all their mis|chievous* devises prove vaine and in|effectuall, and all their painfull travell to compasse ambitious designes, is but lost labour, and shall end in selfedeceit.

CHAP. XVI.

1. *Job* having with much longsuffe|ring* heard out *Eliphaz*, at last thus maketh answer:
2. Since you began to speake, I have* heard much from you severally, but all to the same purpose, which stands me in no stead, and therefore I must conclude you all alike vaine reasoners and miserable comforters, not (as be|commeth friends) indeavouring to mi|tigate, but to increase my griefe.
3. Hast thou done thy idle talke,* which hath beene all this while to no purpose? and now, I pray thee, what moved thee to let fly the second time against mee this uncharitable and im|pudent reply? Knowst thou me to be the man thou speakest of?
4. I could suppose all these things* of you, as you doe of mee, and urge them against you, and sit as judge up|on you: if you were under affliction as I am, I could then shew you how good it is to indeavour the vexation of a grieved spirit, by multiplying uncha|ritable and discomfoting words a|gainst you, and could act your part up|on you with shewing the like jealous and surmising behaviour toward you, and how do you think it would please?
5. But I know my duty, and how I* ought to behave my selfe to those that are in my case better than so, and therefore my care and study should be to uphold and strengthen you in your pressures, with faithfull and con|solatory speeches, and all my talke should tend to administer ease, and not to adde to your afflicted minds.
6. It is wont to be the way for men* in misery, to finde reliefe in the com|pany of their friends, by complaining themselves, and laying open their griefes unto them, but it is not so with mee; but whether I speake or hold my peace, it is all one; I have them all

against me that should be for me, inventing matter to afflict me further, instead of endeavouring to comfort mee.

7. But now I see the hand of God,* as in the rest, so likewise in this estranging my friends from mee, thereby making mee on all hands miserable, and my life wearisome; so thou hast brought my whole family to ruine and desolation.

8. Yea, thou hast every way so filled* and affected my heart with sorrow, as that it wofully appeares upon my body by its macerated and wasted state, having no smooth part in it, but every where deformed with carefull wrinkles, which together with my extreme leanness (my flesh through my grievous anguish being false from my bones, which rise up in a ghostly manner) doe all of them witness thy minde against me.

9. Thou hast exposed mee to the* malice of mine enemy, so that he that hated me hath had liberty to execute and act his uttermost spite upon mee, and bitterly in a disdainfull and insulting manner to affront me.

10. They have every way that can* be thought or named, vilified and reproached me, yea, they have wrought me all the mischief, that with all their combined counsells and power they could contrive and bring to passe.

11. Thus it hath pleased the Lord* to deale with mee, even to expose mee unto the malice and injury of the ungodly Caldeans and Sabeans, and to resigne me up to be disposed of at the wills of those wicked men, giving them leave to execute their full power upon me, in my whole estate.

12. I was in a happy condition, but* he was pleased not to let me stay therein, but hath violently snatched me out of it, and hath parted me and it never to be pieced againe, yea, he hath left nothing undone, that may magnifie the greatness of his power and manifest the fierceness of his severity upon me; for by the one he hath utterly disjoynted all my happiness, never to be set together; and by the other, he hath openly in the eye of the world, set me as a mark to shoot all his deadly arrows at.

13. He hath made every one against* me, my wife and my friends, as well as mine enemies discharge upon me, and with such bodily smart doth he himselfe torment me, as if my backe were chining, and my very reins were cleaving in two; nor does he abate one jot of mine extremity, for all it is so great, but as if he could not be too cruell, against me, hee cuts my gall in pieces, such torture doe I sustaine within and without.

14. He maketh no spare of me any* way, but heapeth plague upon plague upon mee, laying me open every way to ruine and desolation, in his most mighty power and fury hee assaulteth mee.

15. I have deeply humbled my* selfe before him, having made sacke|cloth mine immediate clothing next my very skin, and in token of my selfe|abasing I have covered my head with dust and ashes, which but of late was exalted.

16. My face can testifie how I have* wept unto him, and my sorrow may be evidently seene upon mine eyes and eye-lids, which with extremity of griefe, and multitude of teares are now (as when I am dead they shall be) even wasted away, and sunke into my head.

17. Not that he hath thus plagued* me, or I thus humbled my selfe, for any allowed or dissembled unrighte|ousnesse toward men, knowne either to him or me; for mine actions have beene just and innocent; no, nor for any such like impiety toward him; for in the uprightness of mine heart have I worshipped and served him.

18. And therefore I desire not to* die as the brute beasts doe, for the earth to receive mee, never to depart with mee againe, as hypocrites desire to doe, through selfe-guiltinesse, but I long after my resurrection, that I may appeare before God, that so, though not here, yet there mine innocency may appeare, according to my hope and desire, which I hope shall not be frustrate:

19. For be it knowne to you, that I* am well assured, that God who is in heaven knowes my uprightness, and that there I am witnessed for, and not against.

20. Though here on earth I have* none to take my part; for even those which are my friends, and should know me to speake for mee, doe with scornfull rebukes censure mee for an hypocrite, but I know whom I have to appeale unto in this case; even to God who judgeth righteously, which ac|cordingly■ put in practice; for I poure out teares unto him, who I hope will right my wrong, and cleare mine in|nocency.

21. How happy were it for me, if* I might exchange my argumentation from man to God, and might expostu|late familiarly with him, touching mine innocency, who is able to judge a right, and at whose hands I should be sure of just and impartiall dealing.

22. But my hope and happinesse* is, that after I have borne these vexa|tions the while God hath appointed mee, I shall then be eternally freed from them, by death.

CHAP. XVII.

1. NOOr can I be farre from it; for* my breath which maintaines my life, beginneth to be mor|tally tainted with mine inward dis|eases, portending death at hand, and my daies to be at a period, I am every way ready and fit for the grave.

2. And yet for all this (would not* one thinke it strange?) these men that pretend to come to comfort me, will yet administer none to mee in this pitifull state, but utterly defeat my hopes from one to another; for am not I forced to endure their endlesse

lying provocations, and false accusations, wherewith they continue to vex me to my face, notwithstanding all that I have said to the contrary?

3. But seeing I can have no better* from them, I humbly turne to thee, O Lord, praying thee to deposit a pawne, and give me some assurance, that without being judged by thy perfect righteousness, and dealt withall after thy transcendent greatness; I may argue my uprightness with thee, and then let who will undertake for thee, and enter the lists in thy behalfe against mee.

4. For thou hast blinded them that* they have no understanding to speake right things to mee, either concerning my selfe or thee; and therefore shall they lose the reward they should have received from thee, had they righteously behaved themselves toward me, and in stead thereof receive condigne punishment.

5. They preach a strange and ignorant* kinde of doctrine, that because thou afflicttest mee, therefore I must needs be, and certainly am an hypocrite: and that prosperity is a signe of a righteous man, which is a dangerous untruth to be broached, knowing the curse that belongs to them that with flattering deceit shall dare to bolster men up through erroneous principles in a false opinion of themselves, and their mistaken happinesse; how that their children shall be so served, to wit, deceived and seduced in like manner, and shall perish for want of discerning.

6. And I am not onely miscensured* by these men, but (because of thine unwonted dealings with me) it is also upon this same foolish principle, every man else his report and opinion, that I am an hypocrite, though heretofore in the time of my prosperity, report gave a pleasant sound of mee to all mens eares.

7. So that thou hast every way consumed* mee, my good name is quite blasted, and my body also is wasted; for mine eyes have almost quite lost their sight by reason of mine excessive sorrowing, and all my members are so meagerd, that they are become a very skeleton, and have so lost their substance, that they are, as it were, the shadow of themselves.

8. When all things are thus against* me, and that I have nothing but mine uprightness for mee, mine example shall make others admire the vertue and powerfull support of a good conscience: So that I shall make thee upright, to be in love with his uprightness, for the extraordinary supporting strength and courage which it enables a man withall, and hee that is truly innocent shall learne of me, not to be baffled out of his sincerity, but to maintaine and take comfort in his integrity of heart, against all his false accusers.

9. Yea, the upright-hearted righteous* man shall learne with an undaunted confidence, to put himselfe into the presence of God, and not to be disheartened from it, nay, the more he that is pure of heart receives opposition, the more hee shall gather strength to oppose his adversaries and comfort and confirme himselfe, by me and mine example.

10. So that you see you lose your* labour by going about to stagger mee in mine uprightnesse, even all of you, for any thing you have, or can say, therefore I would wish you all to spare the paines and travell you take in a wrong way, and to change your minds, and close with me; for in the opinion you hold so stiffely and unanimously (that God would not afflict mee thus, were I not an hypocrite, and that be|cause of mine afflictions I am forsaken and hated of him) you are utterly in an errour, and shew your selves ignorant of the waies of God.

11. I have not much more to speak* to you, therefore be warned; for you see how my daies draw to an end, be|sides that what I would say to you, my pain interrupts me that I cannot speak it, the thoughts of my heart being through my distempers, full of distra|ctions and disorder,

12. Filling me with confusion, be|ing* never at rest, but alwaies working, and ever in motion upon and about my miseries, as well night as day, so that I can have no quiet, and day as night, so that I can have no comfort; no time for them.

13. And touching the restauration* you promise me; for my part, I be|lieve no such thing, I make accompt of no other receptacle, than the grave, nor ever to find rest but by death.

14. Nor ever to enjoy any other* friend or kindred, then what they yeeld mee, that is, corruption and wormes.

15. And if you aske me then where* my hope is? (because you say an hy|pocrite is hopelesse) why, I confesse it is in nothing this life yeelds; for I veri|ly believe that neither I, nor any living man shall ever see mee have good day againe in this world.

16. But they that will see wherein* my hope consists, must passe through the gates of death to behold it, and lie downe in the grave with mee, and then it shall appeare.

CHAP. XVIII.

1. *JOB* having the second time given* *Eliphaz* his answer, *Bildad* the Shuhite also taketh his turne to give his second onset upon *Job*, and therefore when *Job* had made an end, he beginneth thus:

2. How long will it be before thou* yeeld to the truth, and cease thy vaine contradicting? Give good heed now, that wee may no more speake in vaine to thee, as it seemes through thy heed|lesnesse and want of due consideration we have done hitherto.

3. Why dost thou set so light by us,* as if wee had no understanding, nor our counsell were nothing worth, or why is our talke so distastefull, seeing wee tell thee the truth?

4. It is not wee, but thy selfe, who* is thine owne tormentor, through thy proud impatiencie; wouldest thou have us belie Gods administration to thee? or wouldest

thou have him to alter it for thee? thou maist sooner expect him to overturn the whole world for thy sake, and put every thing out of that order hee hath decreed and made it in, than cease to be just in punishing the wicked.

5. So that though thou frettest never* so much at it, yet for certaine, this is, must be, and ever was, an infallible Principle. That the wicked mans glory shall (by Gods just judgement for his sinnes) be quite extinguished, shine he never so bright, and with the waters of affliction God will quench his ambitious preparations and designses that he shall not be eminent.

6. But contrariwise, the honour of* his house shall be brought low, yea, the glory hee hath raised shall expire even in and with himselfe.

7. Goe he never so confidently on* hee shall be withstood, and his wisdom wherein hee repositeth so much trust, shall ruine him at last.

8. For his owne waies which hee* chooseth to walke, and taketh to be freest from danger, shall most certainly bring him to ruine, and every step hee taketh in those paths of wickednesse and worldly wisdom, shall one day assuredly prove a further intraping to him, though for a while hee perceives nor feares it not.

9. Till that at the last hee see and* feelee himselfe unavoidably caught, which also shall then befall him when hee least heeded or suspected it, and when he is most confident in his owne strength, safety and riches; God will set some body a worke that maugre all his power shall disable and impoverish him.

10. God in his secret purpose, means* to intrap him at last, yea, even in the very way which hee puts most confidence in, and chooseth to walke in for his security.

11. God shall so distresse and fill* his mind with feares, as that hee shall not have the least chinke of hope left to see any comfort through; but give all for lost, and be driven utterly to abandon his former confidence as vaine.

12. Be hee never so strong in his* owne opinion, God will weaken it, and so burden him that hee shall be glad to seeke strength to beare his owne burthen, when he thought himselfe strong enough to burthen others: he shall see a strange alteration, even destruction and ruine which hee put farre from him in his owne opinion, notwithstanding suddenly to surprize him.

13. It shall seise upon him as well* in body as estate, perishing his very bones which support his skinne; yea, even all the extremest miseries and deadliest torments that are, shall violently seise upon him to pull down his pride, and ruine all his strong holds.

14. He shall see the fruitlesnesse of* carnall confidence, how that all his outward hopes shall be turned upside downe, and nothing shall be left for him to lay hold upon. Yea, destruction shall pursue him to utter ruine, not onely of all that is his, but also of

him|selfe too; for it shall never leave him til it have brought him through a mul|titude of horrors to that which is worst of all, even to death it selfe.

15. Destruction shall put him quite* out of all, and shall take possession of all which he hath so unjustly come by; nothing of all he hath shall escape the consuming fire of the Lords indigna|tion.

16. God will make a cleane rid|dance* of him, and all his whole house; hee will quite cut him off, root and branch, father and sonne, even he and all his posterity, from off the face of the earth.

17. And let him have beene of ne|ver* so great note, yet as he, so his me|mory and reputation shall perish with him, and hee shall be quite forgotten, and had in no esteeme, even in that ve|ry place where hee once lived in so much glory.

18. Hee shall first have all things* clouded upon him, his glory and pro|sperity shall become ignominy and adversity, and they shall make him weary of his life, never ceasing to vex him, and to increase upon him, till they have hunted him to death.

19. There shall none of his off|spring* remaine to uphold his house or name, and the place of his abode shall become quite desolate.

20. God shall make him notorious* to all; for the very report of what fearefull things befell him, when God executed his severe judgements upon him in the day of his visitation, shall beget amazement in men of after ages when they heare of it, though they ne|ver saw it, even as it did in them who were eye-witnesses of the vengeance which was inflicted on him.

21. Be not thou so wilfull to op|pose* a knowne and undeniable truth; for as sure as God is just, so sure it is, That these things do befall the wicked man, and onely him in his family and habitation. And such as this which I have said hath ever been knowne and observed to be the lot and portion on|ly of him that is an hypocrite and feares not God aright in the place where he liveth.

CHAP. XIX.

1. TO this speech of *Bildads Job** made answer, and said:

2. How long will you per|severe* thus impiously and uncharita|bly to endeavour my vexation, and to torment me as upon a racke, with mul|tipling unjust and uncomfortable language against me?

3. You have I know not how of|ten* unjustly upbraided me, and which is strange, you that are mine old ac|quaintance, and which make shew to be my friends, never blush to consi|der in what an unfriendly and strange manner you behave your selves to|ward mee, as if you neither bare any love to mee, nor had any knowledge of mee.

4. But be it granted that I and my* waies have beene too-blame, yet you have not at all convinced mee of any errour, that I might know what to amend, in all this time and talke, and till you can doe that (which I know you can never doe) all that you say is but mere surmises, and serves me to no use, but that still I am the same I was, never better.
5. But if your flourishing estate do* make you value your selves above me, and that you will needs insultingly re|proach me with mine afflictions:
6. Then know and consider, that it* is God that hath thus cast mee downe, and if I be caught, it is he that hath en|snared mee with that you call his net, who can for all your high conceits (as justly when hee pleaseth) doe as much for you.
7. O that the Lord would hearken* to mine out-cry, which I am forced to make, by reason of the unjust calum|nies that these men lay on me, but he is pleased not to grant me audience, yea, though mine injuries compell mee to make earnest and vehement praier, yet can I find no reliefe, nor have any right done me on these my false accusers.
8. He hath every way hedged mee* out of happinesse and content, so that though I seeke it never so, I cannot finde it, yea, hee hath so eclipsed mee, that I cannot see which way to take to administer the least comfort to my selfe.
9. The good report and esteeme* wherewith once I was dignified, hee hath quite stript me of, in the hearts of all men, and turned it into disgrace.
10. He hath indeed, every way, and* in every thing, destroyed mine hope and happinesse, and I am quite out at all; yea, there is no more hope of me for hereafter, than of a tree that is plucked up by the roots.
11. Hee hath mightily opposed* himselfe against me, and seemes to account no better of me, than an ut|ter enemy that hee meanes to pursue to death.
12. He hath mustered his forces to|gether* against me, even a whole army of plagues, which have blocked mee up, and shut mee out of all hope, and have besieged me so straightly, that I can no way in all the world find reliefe.
13. He hath not left me a friend to* helpe or comsort me, but those which were as neere and deare to me as bre|thren, and which should have been so to me, he hath quite turned their hearts from mee; my very bosome-friends and acquaintance will not now owne me for any friend of theirs, but behave themselves as strangers toward mee.
14. Those of mine owne blood and* kindred (from whom I expected o|ther) have refused to doe the offices of of love and kindnesse to me in this my misery, and those that daily frequen|ted me, and were intimately acquain|ted with me, make now as if they ne|ver knew me.

15. Those that should owe me spe|cial* respect, who have lived under me in mine owne house, yea, and my maids which by their sexe should be of a more tender and pitifull dispositi|on, and more dutifull carriage not|withstanding all decorums and obli|gations to the contrary, shew mee no respect, but now by reason of this con|dition which they see me in, they cast me off, as if they never had had any relation to mee.

16. I called my servant as I was* wont to doe, and in a regardlesse man|ner he turned his backe upon mee, yea, I intreated him with this same mouth, that was wont to command him, but all would not doe.

17. My very wife thinkes much to* come neere mee, that was wont to lie in my bosome, yea, although I prayed and importuned her, with the stron|gest and endearingest perswasions I could use, and that which I thought likeliest to prevaile, even for the con|jugall bond sake that was between us, and the motherly respect shee bare to the children, that in it she hath had by me, yet I could not prevaile.

18. Yea, to make up my misery,* that which I little expected, even yong children that should be better nourtu|red, and which usually are more piti|fully and respectfully disposed, have yet despisingly behaved themselves toward me, and if I doe but shew my selfe, so sooneas ever they see mee in what case I am, they speake against me, and passe their opinion upon mee, as they have heard others doe.

19. There is not any one for mee;* all my most inwardest and bosome|friends have mee in detestation, be|cause of my affliction, and their ill opi|nion of mee for it, and they whom I most entirely loved, requite me with injury and opposition.

20. I am so pined away, that my* bones and skin are met and grow to|gether, as once did my flesh and they, having now no flesh left to part them; But indeed, to speake properly, I have nothing that I can call skin about mee (being all over of a scab) saving my gums, which only have escaped this contagion.

21. O consider my misery, and be not* so hard-hearted toward me, but be in|treated of mee to shew me some com|passion, you that I have ever taken for my friends, which is your duty to doe, and the thing which God expecteth from you, now that he afflicts me.

22. Why doe you take upon you to* afflict mee because God doth so (have you the like authority) or so master|fully to censure and judge me for an hypocrite, which is proper onely to God (who searcheth the heart) both to know and punish; is it not enough for you to see my body thus tormented, but you will heape more extremity upon mee, labouring to oppresse my spirit also?

23. O that what I am about to* speake were eternized to all posterity in the usuall way of writing and prin|ting!

24. Or rather in some more legible* and permanent way, as by graving them with capitall letters in some du|rable stone, for the vindicating of my sincerity to after ages, and for the lear|ning and encouraging of all upright hearted men against afflictions and op|positions.

25. For this with a good consci|ence* I dare, and can affirme, which no hypocrite can say after me; That up|on good proofes and infallible eviden|ces I assuredly know, That (howsoe|ver I seeme, and am judged by you here a cast-away and reprobate man) I truely and faithfully rest upon the promise; and that my soule is safe (by the mercy of God) in him whom hee hath appointed to redeeme it, who shall one day live and triumph over all his sufferings, and so shall I over mine, by and with him; I meane no phantasticall Saviour, such as vaine men through selfe-love take up and make to themselves, but him whom I know full well, is, and must be, as well a Judge as a Saviour, and there|fore it booteth me little to dissemble, who (it rejoyceth my heart to thinke) shall one day judge the world in righ|teousnesse, and then shall mine inno|cency appeare.

26. And though not only my skin,* but this whole body be utterly consu|med & eaten to death of wormes, both skin, flesh, and bones; yet for my Sa|viours sake who shall rise from death, and live in despite of it, my flesh (so consumed) shall be framed a new into such a body, and raised againe to such a life as wherein I shall see God com|pletely, face to face.

27. I meane, I shall not see him as* the wicked shall at the last day, to be anothers God, and none of theirs, but that I shall so see him, as that I shall en|joy him for my God, Father and Savi|our, I say, mine owne eyes shall see him and rejoyce in him, for mine own God, and not anothers, though now hee be pleased thus extremely to afflict mee, both within and without.

28. One would thinke this faithfull* confession & profession of my faith in the purenesse of my conscience, should make you better bethinke your selves, then thus to persecute mee with false and injurious occasions, seeing that however you may condemne me for a sinner, which I confesse to God and all the world, yet there is apparantly in mee that which may and doth interest me in Gods saving and speciall favour, notwithstanding both my sins and his afflictions, to wit, a faithfull upright|nesse which you ought to cherish, and not to oppose and suppress.

29. And looke well to it; be yee* afraid to goe on in this way, lest God unsheath his sword against you for it; for if you persevere in your persecu|ting injustice and uncharitablenesse til his wrath be kindled against you, pu|nishment will befall you, that so you may learne to feare to doe wrong, and know there is a just revenger thereof, and that judgement belongs thereto.

CHAP. XX.

1. *ZOphar* the Naamathite, long|ing* till his time came to re|ply upon *Job*, being full of aggravated displeasure, thus at last al|so venteth himselfe upon him:
2. Saith he, I am even in travell till* I answer thee, I must needs breake in upon thee, however thou maist take it, and that for this reason:
3. Because thou hast reproachfully* taunted that truth, which I and my companions (thy friends) have sugge|sted to thee for thy good: In so much as being well assured of that I have said, to be no other than a certaine and knowne truth, to wit, that God will pu|nish the wicked, and that it shall goe ill with them, and not with the righte|ous; thy disdainfull contradicting it hath so whetted my spirit, that I can no longer containe my selfe, but must needs out of a right under-standing and certaine knowledge of it, urge this truth yet more home upon thee.
4. How can it be, that thou shoul|dest* be ignorant of this, or how darest thou deny it, which God hath made apparant in all ages since the begin|ning of the world, and which hath beene ever received and taught for an infallible truth.
5. Even this, that God suffers not a* wicked man long to enjoy his earthly happinesse and worldly triumph, but makes it of short continuance: and that the joy which an hypocrite taketh in his prosperity shall not long last, but shall speedily end in endlesse sorrow.
6. Though hee over-top all men,* and be never so high in the repute of the world.
7. Yet hee shall have such a fall, as* he shall never rise againe, yea, the time shall come, that God will make him as loathsome and detestable to himselfe and others, as his owne excrements were wont to be; yea, even those very men that have seene and admired his condition shall ere long, as much won|der at his downfall.
8. A man you know is no sooner a|waken,* but his delightfull dreame is forgotten; just so, on a sudden, when God awakes in judgement, upon him shall all his former honour and happi|nesse be quite lost and taken from him, not any of it remaining: yea, like as when a man awaketh, all the imagina|ry visions of his fancy vanish, so shall all his temporall felicity by the sight and feeling of the anger and displea|sure of God against him.
9. Those which are able to say,* they can remember the time they saw him thus and so, shall never live to see the like againe, neither shall the place where he lived so splendidously ever enjoy him so any more.
10. His children to stop the clamo|rous* mouths of the oppressed poore shal be forced to stoope to observe and intreat them with good words, and fair promises; whom once their father, and they insulted over with proud oppression, and had them for their observers and suppliants; yea, the hea|vie wrath of God upon him shall make

him with his owne hands restore to the poore, what by oppression he had unjustly taken from them, and glad he may.

11. Hee shall be made to feelee the* weight of his former sinnes, by the tor|menting plagues that God shall heape upon him, which shall pursue him to the death.

12. Though his sins have been ne|ver* so pleasing to him in their acting, and though that still his mind stands that way, being loth to forgoe them.

13. Although he be exceeding loth* to leave them, and hardly brought to repent of them, but with close hypo|criticall dissembling would faine ex|cuse them, that so hee may retaine them still.

14. Yet as well as hee loves them,* and as sweet as they have beene in acting, in the end they will prove of a quite contrary effect, bringing deadly plagues upon him, and filling, him with inward bitternesse.

15. Hee hath by ravenous oppres|sion* gotten abundance, but what though? hee shall never be able to keepe them, but shall be compelled to part with them againe, God shall so torment and fill him with anguish and trouble of minde that hee shall be sicke of them, and wish with all his heart to be rid of them to purchase his ease and quiet.

16. He shall be for all his seeming* happinesse in his ill gotten goods, but as a man that by mistake hath sucked the most deadly poison in stead of ho|ney; in the just wrath of God he shall be tormented to death, as if hee were stung with Vipers.

17. Though hee hath promised* himselfe large contentment and feli|city by his lawlesse and sinfull courses, yet hee shall find himselfe quite mista|ken, and his expectation utterly fru|strated; neither enjoying lesse nor more of all that happinesse hee hoped for.

18. Hee shall be quite stript of all* that which with carefull thought ta|king hee hath gained, and shall part with it to others, himselfe shall have no good by it, how happy soever hee promised himselfe to be: yea, to the utmost farthing shall he be disseized of all that ever hee has, for in retalia|ting justice, God shall begger him, take it from him and distribute it to other men: hee shall take but little joy, and finde but small benefit in that he hath gathered together, for hee shall lose it every jot.

20. Because he hath come naughti|ly* by it, oppressing the poore, and to enrich himselfe by bribery and sub|ornation, hath refused to doe him right, and also by injustice and vio|lence, unlawfully possessed himselfe of other mens estates, which he had no manner of right unto.

20. Hee shall be incessantly pursu|ed* with vexations, and shall enjoy no hearts-ease; hee shall keepe nothing of that which hee hath got; but shall part with all that whereon he had set his heart, and built his felicity.

21. God shall never cease taking* from him, and giving it to others, whilst hee hath any thing left, and till folke see that hee hath not wherewith to sustaine himselfe, they shall not give over to rob and spoile, and to take from him what he has.

22. Then, when he takes himselfe* to be in his prime and hight of happi|nesse, shall hee be brought to the grea|test indigency and want, God shall let loose every wicked unconscionable man to molest and impoverish him, like as aforetime hee himselfe hath done to others.

23. When he hath satisfied his de|sires* to the full, and hath gotten every thing that his heart could wish, to make him happy, so soone as ever hee beginneth to joy himselfe in them, God, whom he least lookes for, it shall blast his hopes, and disturb his securi|ty, by executing a furious and wrath|full judgement upon him in great a|bundance, very then, when he bids his heart make merry, and assures him|selfe unchangeable happinesse.

24. The Lord shall wrathfully fight* against him as a man of warre, with sharp and strong weapons, such as hee shall desire and endeavour to avoid and flie from, but shall by no meanes escape, nor be able to withstand or to stand under, but what one failes to do, another shall certainly bring to passe, so that one way or other hee shall be sure to receive his deaths wound by a fierce discharge of Gods wrathfull plagues upon him.

25. God will be sure to shoot home,* so that his arrow shall pierce through and through, he shall make it appeare that it was shot in anger, and that it is his powerfull hand that doth it, yea, hee shall make his most formidable plagues to appeare upon him, they shall pierce his very intralls, so that with bitternesse of spirit hee shall be forced to lament himselfe, his inward terrours shall so affright and perplex him.

26. All manner of dismall feares,* surmising thoughts, and misgiving de|spaire shall enter and take possession of his soule, and no comfortable hope shall appeare in him. Hee and all his substance shall by the wrath of God hastily consume to nothing as the stubble by the fire, yea, so incensed is God against him, as that for his op|pression and hypocrisie sake, such a curse shall cleave to him, and to all that comes of him, yea, to the very place of his abode, as that whosoever remaines in it shall partake it.

27. God by punishments from hea|ven,* shall lay him open sufficiently to all the world to be a grievous sinner, and a notorious hypocrite, whatsoe|ver he saith to the contrary; yea, hee shall make the very creatures to ab|horre him for it, and utterly to deny their comfort and service to him, to signifie what he is.

28. All his posterity shall be de|stroyed,* and so shall his prosperity too; even all at once with a sudden ebbe, in the day that God visits him with his wrath and righteous judgements.

29. This that I have told thee is the* portion that a wicked hypocriticall oppressour must looke for, and shall certainly receive from God, and none but such; God in his

just purpose hath set it a part, and assigned it for him, and will when his sins are ripe, and the time fit, most certainly execute it upon him, as his works have ever declared.

CHAP. XXI.

1. BUt *Job* being no whit more* convinced or confuted by *Zo|phans* foregoing discourse, thus againe replies upon him:
2. Doe mee that favour, as to give* mee also leave to speake, and to lend me your eares, which, seeing you have no other comforts for me, shall be in stead of comfort to me.
3. Have but patience to heare me,* and when I have done, say you your pleasure.
4. I see it is in vaine to make my* mone to man, if I looke for help there, the Lord knowes I am in a piteous case; for I find no comfort from him.
5. I beseech you consider what I* say, that you may reforme your error, and together with mee, may with a|mazement admire the waies of God, which are wonderful; and give over thus presumptuously to give bounda|ries to him in his administration to|wards men.
6. And well may I bid you wonder,* and be astonished hereat; for, for mine owne part, when I call to minde, and consider Gods wonderfull procee|dings toward my selfe, what I was, and what I am, they astonish me with most formidable amazement, nor am I able to plum their depth.
7. And I pray you, if it be as you* say, That God only layeth his heavie hand upon the wicked, and that they escape not wrath & punishment, how then comes it to passe (which you can|not deny but are eye-witnesses of) that the wicked live in health and hearts|ease, till they be as old as the oldest, and equall, if not exceed, whomsoever in power?
8. Their posterity doe as well as* heart can wish, and they live to see them thrive like themselves, and to joy in their present prosperity and un|doubted hopes of future happinesse.
9. There is no such feare befalls* them as you speake of, but they live secure and free both from the feare and feeling of punishment, God af|licts them not one jot.
10. But contrarily, all things hit, and* nothing misseth to make them happy, and rich, they have profit and pleasure at will; for their bull gendereth and faileth lesse than other mens, and their Cowes calve, and miscarry seldome or never.
11. None are more happy in the* multitude of children than they, nor no mens children lead merrier lives than theirs, dancing and joviallizing.
12. At the sound of all the choisest* instruments of musique, which wit can invent, or money can buy, wherewith they take their fill of pleasure and sport.

13. And they live all their life long* in this manner, never tasting sorrow, and moreover, when their time comes to die, they have as easie deaths as one would wish, without any sore or lin|gring paines and diseases, they depart in a trice.

14. Thus they live, and thus they* die, yea, not with standing that they are so far from being lesse wicked for this their prosperous condition, as that it makes them the more sinfull and pre|sumptuous against God, even in effect to dare to say (for their lives shew as much) we care not for thee, nor have no need of thee, thy waies are not our waies, and therefore keepe them to thy selfe; for wee will yeeld neither subjection nor obedience to thee nor them.

15. We are able to stand upon our* owne legs, and wee are free for to doe our owne wills, why should wee then abridge our selves, and become slaves to one whose power wee respect not, nor can it doe us any hurt, be it never so great, and to whom wee scorne to be beholden for any thing, who need nothing?

16. Lo, now, how unagreeable this* is to what you say, that God ever de|spiles them of all they have, and leaves them naked; and yet how ever this my necessitous estate differs from that of theirs, so commended by you, yet say you what you will, I am not for all that in love with their prosperous condition; much good do it them, far be it from me to wish their happinesse in their way, and upon their termes, for I have never trod their paths.

17. You cannot deny but that ex|perience* proves this true which I have said, that many wicked men doe thus passe unpunished, and prosper; nor againe, on the other hand doe I deny, but that too the glory of the wicked is oft eclipsed, and destruction oft over|takes them, yea, I acknowledge it to be true, that God doth distribute and send afflicting plagues and punish|ments in his just displeasure upon them many times.

18. God I know does bring them* and theirs to ruine and destruction, and disperseth their ill gotten goods up and downe into a thousand mens hands.

19. And maketh their children di|vers* times feelee the smart of their fa|thers sins; yea, hee makes the wicked man live to see and know the reward of his owne evill waies.

20. He himselfe is made the specta|tor* of his owne ruine, and to drinke deepe of the cup of the Lords an|ger.

21. So that the pleasure hee tooke* in the hope hee conceived of making his house famous and honourable af|ter him, shall quite vanish by sudden destruction or death, happening in his prime.

22. Will you dare then thus to teach* God what he should doe? will you set bounds to his actions, and measure his judgements by your rule, seeing they are so farre beyond us, and his waies past our finding out; and seeing he is Judge of the Angells, who are

so farre above us in all manner of excellen|cies, the wisdome of whose waies even they notwithstanding are ignorant of.

23. Must you not needs confesse an* unsearchablenesse in Gods waies, such as is without the compasse of any mans reach, when as he pleaseth to doe such wonderfull contradictory things in mans reason, and to shew himselfe so free an agent in the things aforesaid, as also in these that follow; sparing whom hee pleaseth, and likewise afflicting whom, and for what time, and in what measure himselfe liketh, as we continually see and behold; for instance, Doth he not summon one a way by death, even then, when hee is most likely to live, and when he least looks for it, or desires it?

24. When there is not the least decay* in him to cause it, but that nature is every way perfect and complete.

25. And doth not another man (we* know no reason why) lie and die under wofull pressures of minde and body, never enjoying good houre in all his life?

26. Thus does God doe his pleasure* upon men, and variously dispence his providence to them here, and yet however hee seeme to favour or disfavour them (which is also strange) death concludes them, and the grave receives them all alike, and there they fare alike, the wormes devouring one as well as another.

27. Alas, I easily perceive you imply* and meane mee to be the wicked man that God hath done & executed all these things upon for my supposed wickednesse, (wherein (I speake it knowingly) you are utterly mistaken; for I am no such man, and you doe me exceeding much wrong to thinke so of me, whilst ignorantly you judge me by the event and Gods afflicting hand upon mee.

28. The whilst you say in derision,* where is this mans princely pompe, that but even now was so splendidous? What is become of all the glory, that hee in the pride of his heart had thought to have gained and laid up for himselfe and his? and of all the great renew and goodly houses that he and they by wicked meanes had compassed and built to wicked ends and purposes?

29. Is it not notorious what he was,* and cannot every man point him out now for wicked and naught, that seeth these markes and judgements upon him? will any man say, that ever any had the like but such an one?

30. Doe not all men know that the* time will come, that God will certainly reckon with a wicked man for his wickednesse, and at last, without faile, bring ruine upon his head, and will make him an example of his justice to all the world, in the day that he chooseth to execute his wrath upon him?

31. Although no man dare reprove him, and tell him he doth wrong, nor* right himselfe upon him, or attempt to punish him, because of his imperiousnesse and oppressing might.

32. Yet shall God bring him low,* his judgements shall bring him to his grave, even to an everlasting farewell to his former estate.

33. God shall so afflict him that he* shall desire death as the only way that remaines to give him ease, and this say you, shall be, and ever hath beene the case of every wicked man, as well as his.

34. Now, how vainly may any one* judge, doe you goe about to comfort me, which yet you would be thought to doe; when as you apply nothing rightly to mee, nor affirme nothing rightly of mee; and seeing all your discourses are composed of nothing but mistakes and errors touching God and mee, affirming that hee afflicts none but wicked men, and that I am and must needs be wicked, because I am afflicted, both which are false.

CHAP. XXII.

1. *Eliphaz* the Temanite, being* now to speake according to course, falleth the third time upon *Job*, and saith,

2. Granting that thou art righteous* as thou saiest, yet thou takest a wonderfull fond course thus to glory in it, and plead it unto God, thereby to bind him to thee, seeing a mans being so, addes nothing to him, it profits him nothing, though it doe the owner, who in godly wisdom hath obtained to be so.

3. Not a jot of benefit God reaps* by it, nay, hee is so farre from being a gainer by thy pleading the perfection of thy waies, as that thou makest him thereby suffer in his justice, and by pleading thy righteousness, makest him unrighteous.

4. If hee punish thee not for sinne,* what then doth he plague thee for? Is it for feare that in time thou mayest grow so over good, that he cannot reward thee, or so over great, that hee cannot command thee? thinkest thou he hath need to take such course with thee for any such cause?

5. Man, never speake more of it;* God is just, and so are his waies, and therefore, as thy punishments are great and extraordinary, so certainly are thy sinnes.

6. For it must needs be, that how|ever* thou hast carried things cunning|ly, and wee cannot so easily detect thy faults, yet doubtlesse thou hast beene extremely too blame, and thy waies very wicked; wouldst thou but consi|der and confesse them. For no doubt, what ever thou saiest to the contrary, but thou hast been a great oppressour of the poore, and a greedy griper, thou hast questionlesse uncharitably taken, and unjustly detained thy poore bro|thers pledge to his great damage, and by thy cruell usage, hast extremely im|poverished them.

7. And as thou hast beene an evill|doer* in the waies of injury and vio|lence, so also doubtlesse thou hast been backward to doe any good or chari|table worke, thou hast not relieved the needy.
8. But all thy aime and care was,* to make thy selfe mighty, rich, and honourable here on earth, and there|fore all thy labour was to ingrosse it to thy selfe from others.
9. Thou hast disappointed the* poore widowes hope, and hast not righted her upon her wrong-doers, and thou hast suffered the fatherlesse to be crushed, and hast not afforded them succour when they relied upon, and trusted to thee for it.
10. Therefore it is, and for no o|ther* cause, that thou art thus plagued on all hands, these workes and waies of thine, are they that have brought thee into this condition, thus to be captivated, and all at once suddenly surprized with such fearefull miseries.
11. Yea, into worse than the plagues* themselves, even into blindnesse and confusion of minde; so as that thou canst neither see what brought thee into them, nor how to finde the way out, but art as a man under water a|mazed in these thy afflictions, not knowing which way to take, nor what to doe to helpe thy selfe.
12. Is not God infinitely higher and* more full of light to see and discern, than any of his creatures? consider how high the starres are, and how far distant from thee, and yet they shine downe to thee.
13. Much more does God see thee,* and know thy waies and workes; yet such is thy hypocrisie and security, that because we who are but men, cannot easily detect thee; therefore, thou thinkest, and thy behaviour speakes as much, that God can see no evill nei|ther by thee; and because thou canst not see him through the clouds that are over thy head, therefore thou thinkest hee cannot see nor take notice of thee through them.
14. And that his sight is not cleare* enough to see through such a medi|um, but that thou art safe enough from his eyes who hath so many thicke and darke clouds betweene thee and him, and who dwells at such a distance from thee, as is heaven from earth, where it seemes thou thinkest he only manages matters, and beares rule, and not here.
15. Hast thou observed the waies* of the wicked, and the course that God hath of old wont to take with them?
16. Dost thou confesse, how they* have been cut short of their aimes and hopes by an untimely end, and how the foundations which they have laid of riches and honour, have beene at last wasted away with sudden de|struction and ruine, as of old by the floud?
17. Even such, as thou sayest, say* to God, keepe thy Lawes to thy selfe, for we'll not obey them, and what care we for what he can doe to us, that ex|pect no good from him, nor feare no hurt?

18. And thou knowest its true too,* that once hee filled their houses with good things, and plenty of them; and now, how canst thou so confidently and securely exempt thy selfe from their condition, and thy waies from theirs, seeing thou sharest in their plagues?

19. For the righteous are free from* such things, what ever thou sayest to the contrary; they live to see the ju|stice of God executed upon the wic|ked, and rejoyce therein, laughing at their folly for taking such waies, which they knew long before would have such an end and issue.

20. Whereas wee that have beene* content with a little, got in an honest godly way, enjoy it still in peace; but as for proud oppressours, and greedy gripers, rise they never so high, wrath shall quite ruine them at last.

21. But now therefore, thou for thy* part, though thou hast been a stranger to the waies of God, yet stand not out still in rebellion, but come in and make thy peace by confessing thy guil|tiness, and acknowledging him just, cav•lling no longer at his dealings; and so shalt thou receive good for evil, and find mercy to relieve thee in thy distresse.

22. I pray thee as a friend, goe not* on presumptuously, but humble thy selfe for thy former sinnes, and pro|mise amendment; covenant to keepe his Commandements which thou hast broken, and to frame both thy heart and life thereby for hereafter.

23. If thus thou repent and turne to* the Lord, feare not but that hee both can, and will repaire thee, and so shalt thou put away sin, and the plagues and punishment that sin hath brought up|on thee, farre from thee and thine.

24. Then shalt thou have thy de|sire;* for thou shalt be rich with con|tent, which is worth a million.

25. Yea, the All-mighty himselfe* in his love and favour, shall be thy riches and treasure, so that thou shalt thinke thy selfe happier and richer than gold or silver can make thee.

26. For thou shalt then have that* which is worth, and better worth than all, to wit, peace toward God, and the comfortable enjoyment of his grace and favour toward thee, which shall make thee with an holy boldnesse to looke God in the face without feare.

27. Thou shalt then be able cheer|fully* to addresse thy selfe to him in prayer, and shalt receive his gracious answers to thine infinite solace; so that thou shalt have continuall cause and exercise of thanksgiving.

28. Yea, thou shalt but say the* word, and it shall be done; such power shalt thou have with God, who shall in favour to thee, approve of all thy waies, and they shall prosper.

29. When other men are cast* downe as thou art now, then shalt thou be able to speake to them, and to God for them, and both to warrant and procure the delivery of the peni|tent person out of his afflictions.

30. Nay the humble and upright* man who does righteously, and lives holily, shall not onely prevaile for one, but for a many, yea, the whole land or place where hee lives shall fare the better for him. Thy good life and pure prayers when thou art such an one, shall for thy sake doe much with God for all the rest, in working their deliverance from many an evill, which would else befall them.

CHAP. XXIII.

1. WHen *Eliphaz* had ended,**Job* thus beginneth:

2. All this long time of* suffering I have found no ease, but from the beginning to this very day is cause of complaint still multiplied and encreased upon mee by injuries from men, and calamities from God; so that the sorrow and misery which I in|dure, doe farre exceed my lamentati|on, and are heavier than my groanings can expresse.

3. O that I knew where I might* meet with God, and how to come to speake with him, that I might be no longer kept at distance from him, but might obtain accesse unto him, though it were even to his seate in heaven!

4. That so I might (as I long to do)* even plead my cause, and maintaine mine innocency before him, for all his afflicting me.

5. I would affirme as much to God* himselfe as I doe to you, and would not feare what hee could, or would say against it.

6. Assuring my selfe before-hand,* that he will not contest against mee in any transcendent maner, nor stand up|on his rigour and power with me, but that hee will graciously enable mee to speake the truth unto him touching my sincerity, and to maintaine it be|fore him.

7. I know, however he pleaseth to* deal with the righteous here, yet there they may speake for themselves, and be heard without repulse; a happy man therefore should I think my selfe, had I this liberty granted me; for so I should be freed both from the slan|ders and condemnations of my unjust censurers, and also from the judge|ment of the Lords transcendent righ|teousnesse, and execution of soveraign authority, which it is his will that here I must undergoe, and should in mercy receive there the reward of mine in|nocency.

8. But alas, hee will not allow mee* this happinesse to finde him out, that I may have speech with him; for he will not in any way, nor by any meanes I can use manifest himselfe so to mee, as to give mee the hearing, I cannot ob|taine it, though I seeke it every way I can devise; for I put my selfe before him with a confident boldnesse of

pur|pose to try if that way I can provoke him to it, but he keepes off from me; also I humble my selfe at my distance, to see if that way I can draw him to it, but all is one, I am never the neerer, he is every whit as farre off.

9. I prayed him for the afflictions* sake which he layeth upon mee, but I cannot speed, for hee quite contrary is the further off, by how much I desire to draw neere to him.

10. But for all he keepes at this di|stance,* and seemes so strange to mee, and will not grant me this favour to ad|mit me to plead my cause before him; yet I am sure for all this he knowes me and my waies to be such as I have said, and when hee has held mee a while in the fire of affliction, my uprightnesse shall be made manifest, and shall shine as gold in the eyes of those, that now through prejudice can see nothing but drosse in me.

11. For I know, and dare main|taine* it, that I have beene no such man as you suspect me for, but that I have constantly walked in the waies of the Lord without deviation or turning a|side from them for any respect what|soever.

12. Neither have I ever turned my* backe, or refused to yeeld obedience to any command of God, but contra|rily, I have esteemed them better, and minded them more than my very meat and drinke.

13. But that is all one; for what the* Lord in his infinite wisdom and good pleasure hath determined with him|selfe to doe, he will not alter what ever any man allegeth to the contrary, and what ever pleaseth him, however it may displease us, yet that he doth.

14. And this is my very case now,* for hee doth in this my affliction, but onely shew his just prerogative upon me, to try me, not to punish mee, and many such extraordinary things hee pleaseth to decree and execute in his great power and unsearchable wise|dome, whereof wee can know, nor give no reason.

15. Therefore though I am trou|bled,* yet it is this his greatnesse which I am to grapple withall, and doe now susteine, and not my conscientious|nesse that troubles mee, when I consi|der his immensity, that is the thing that makes me afraid of him.

16. For in this respect, God melteth* and weakeneth my heart and spirit with feare and astonishment, as the wax before the fire; and I confesse the thoughts of his Almightinesse is no little trouble to me.

17. For because I see he useth it al|together* against me, and not for mee, for by an Almighty power it is that he hath brought mee into this extremity, and therewith still continues me under it, and hath not rather prevented these intolerable evils by it through death.

CHAP. XXIV.

1. IF God be bound by his justice to* punish evill-doers in this life; why then is it, that he who knows the length of their life, and the time of their departure hence, yet suffers them to die unpunished? and why then doe not the godly, and they that serve him, alwaies see it so, but oft-times the con|trary?
2. Yea, to instance in all sorts of* wicked men; some goe point-blanke against Gods Commandement, and privately doe injury to their neigh|bour for their owne advantage, rob|bing him of his right by removing his land-marke, and others with strong hand, take away other mens goods and cattell, and securely feed thereon.
3. They cruelly oppresse the fa|therlesse,* and mercilessly exact upon the widow.
4. They put poore folke to extreme* shifts, so as they know not how to live, and drive them to so narrow a scant|ling by inlarging their territories, that they are faine to croud together like Bees in a hive, and for cruelty and op|pression dare not shew their faces.
5. See, if they rather like beasts,* than men, doe not rove and ramble up and downe the earth for booty for them and theirs, and care for no body else, nor how they come by that they have.
6. There is nothing scapes them,* but other mens, both corne and wine, by oppression they wickedly usurp, and swallow all.
7. They are utterly mercillesse, ha|ving* no charity nor pity, but destitute the poore of their very bed-clothes, inhumanely exposing them to the ex|tremity of cold without clothing.
8. Driving them to endure most* miserable hardship, even to lie out of doores in vehement stormes, and tem|pestuous weather, and to take up with the holes of the rockes for houses to dwell in.
9. They cruelly extort even the ve|ry* necessary food that should main|taine and keepe alive the widow and the childe, and contrary to all law of God and nature, unmercifully take and detaine the poore bodies pledge to his utter undoing.
10. Not sticking to strip him starke* naked of all, both clothing and food, that should either cover his naked|nesse, or satisfie his hunger.
11. These oppressors make the poore* labouring man to toile hard, and to scruze out for them their oile and their wine in the places where they them|selves dwell safe and at ease; and yet compell him to suffer thirst the while, being by their cruelty abridged of his wages and livelyhood dearely earned, and not suffered so much as to taste of his owne labours.
12. In so much that the miserable* grones and outcries of the oppressed, that can have no justice done them are vehemently breathed forth to heaven, even as a man that lieth mortally wounded at the point of death; which one would thinke were an apt occasi|on, and a fit season for God to shew himself in, to right the poore innocent,

and to punish the wicked oppressour, and yet for all this, we see he keeps si|lence and doth not plague them.

13. Yea, is not this true, even of* such men, whose lives are so notori|ous, that they hate the very light, which reproves and discovers their evill doings? does not (I say) God spare even them, whose owne consci|ences condemne themselves, driving them to act their deeds of darknesse by night, and not by day, secretly and not openly.

14. As for instance; the murthe|rous* and cruell-minded man, he ear|ly executes his mischievous designs with all speed and diligence upon the poore and needy soule, that can make no resistance, and then obscures him|selfe in the night as a thiefe.

15. And so againe, the adulterous* Whoremonger, he contrives and longs to fulfill his sinne which hee also ef|fects in the darke by close and cun|ning carriage.

16. The thiefe in the like manner* <◇> the night-bird, making use of the day to plot, and of the night to ex|••re his villany, not loving the light as inconvenient for his purpose and vexatious to his mind.

17. For when the morning comes,* hee is stricke with feare, like a man ready to die, he is in miserable dread, lest hee should be knowne or found of any.

18. He staies not long in a place, he* flieth all company, his conscientious|nesse makes him lead a most misera|bly solitary, and base life, not daring to come nere any high way or place of concourse.

19. And so they spend their daies,* and will never leave sinning till death, but like as the snow remaines unwa|sted till the Summer sunne comes and melts it into the ground, so doe the wicked subsist and goe on, some in one way of wickednesse, some in another, till the period of death finish their course.

20. Then indeed he shall be extinct,* and be as if he had never been, retur|ned shall he be to the dust againe, and his memory shall perish, and his flou|rishing in wickednesse shall then have an end, as a tree that is broken or blowne downe with the wind.

21. But yet in the meane time, God* may let him live long to doe much mischief, and to act many injuries un|punished, both evill intreating the so|litary barren woman who hath none to pity her or take her part as others have, and to offer violence in stead of yeelding succour to the friend|lesse widdow.

22. Yea, not onely oppressing the* poore thus, but also bringing the rich to poverty by his overtopping might, dominering and tyrannizing over all sorts of men, and making them live in perpetuall feare of him and bondage to him.

23. But though he live never so long* in safety and prosperity, exercising these courses, and rest never so confi|dently on it; yet I know he shall cer|tainly be plagued at last (though not here) for the eyes of God marke him, and hee will be sure to reward him with just punishment.

24. Though God do (which no man* can deny) exalt them here for a while, yet I acknowledge that in justice hee must, and will give an end to their waies, and by death cut them off; but yet oft-times no otherwaies than other men, not by any notorious judgement, but by a common and naturall death, without making difference, like corne in harvest.

25. And if this be not true that* God doth many things above, and contrary to mans reason, and that hee lets wicked men spend their daies in wickednesse, and reserves their judge|ment till death, let any disprove mee that can.

CHAP. XXV.

1. *Bildad* the Shuhite, being moved* at *Jobs* boldnesse toward God, and confidence in himselfe, thus briefly makes answer to what he had spoken in the 23. Chapter.

2. God rules with Majesty in hea|ven,* and gives lawes to his Angells there, which they must obey, in which very place that there is peace, it is of his goodnesse and gracious decree, ra|ther than of their merit.

3. Hath hee not whole armies of* Angells and other creatures in an infi|nite number, which are ready to exe|cute his wrath upon whomsoever dare to contest against him? and doth not the Sun behold all men in all corners of the earth, so that God must needs much more see them what they are?

4. God then being of such perfect* holinesse, so terrible also, and so all|seeing, how dares any man living, or how is it possible for him to stand it out with God (as thou boastest) in his owne justification, or for him that is naturally corrupt, begotten and borne of sinfull parents, to appeare pure in the eyes of such a God?

5. Consider, that by reason of the* fall of man, the very creatures that in themselves are sinlesse, yea, the very Moone and Stars (that are so far from earth and so neer to heaven) have con|tracted defilement, and are blemished; so that with God for mans sake, and by mans sin, even they are not accoun|ted free from pollution in his sight.

6. How much lesse man himselfe* (whence they have taken infection) and all that come of him, who both father and sonne, are all alike earthly creatures made subject to corruption by sinne?

CHAP. XXVI.

1. *JOB* being angry at *Bildads* imper|tinencies,* thus answers him:

2. What am I the better for* this thou hast said, how hast thou here|in discharged thine office to me, either as a friend or comforter? what helpe hereby hast thou administred to my helplesse state, or how hast thou here|with yeelded me any aid or support in this my weake condition?
3. What friendly advice or usefull* counsell hast thou ministred to me by it, which yet thou takest mee to stand in need of, and what adoe hast thou kept to tell me what I know?
4. Who dost thou utter these over|plus* needlesse speeches to, that is ever the better for them? For my part, I am not, and whose spirit is any whit refreshed, or ever the better for what thou hast said? not mine one jot.
5. Thinkest thou I know not all* this? yea, I can tell thee as much, and more than thou hast said, to set forth God withall, whereby thou mayest see that I am not to learne of thee touching him: I can tell thee that hee is not onely admirable above in the heavens, but beneath also, in so much, as nothing is bred or brought forth, whether animate or inanimate, fish or other things in all the vast and deepe Ocean, but it is by his decree and power.
6. The hiddenest and lowest parts* of all the earth, the Grave and Hell, are open before his all-seeing eyes, so that hee sees what becomes of man, and every part of himafter that death hath dissolved him, and the grave con|sumed him.
7. His eyes of providence, and* arme of power, extends to the most remote and uninhabited places of all the earth, hee over-spreads those as these with the heavens, and disposeth things there as here, and hee wonder|fully upholds this heavie fabricke and huge ball of the earth pendant in the midst of the heavens without any o|ther support than his mighty power.
8. He bottells up the abundance of* raine which falls upon the ground, in clouds made for that purpose, great and thick, which notwithstanding the weight of those waters, he hath made able to keepe and containe them, so that they let fall none but when hee pleaseth.
9. Hee, when hee pleaseth, with|holdeth* the Sunne from us, that glori|ous light and beauty of the face of heaven, and causeth it at pleasure to suspend its power and vertue of light and heat, by overclouding the hea|vens, and masking it as with a vaile.
10. Hee hath confined the raging* and unruly seas with bounds and li|mits, which (doe they what they can) they shall never passe till the end of the world, when all things shall be let loose to devastation.
11. His terrour is formidable even* to the mighty and high mountaines (whereon the heavens seeme to rest as on so many pillars) which tremble and shake with his thunder-claps and earth-quakes.

12. The sea, as outrageous as it is,* subjects it selfe to his command, and against nature divides it selfe so, that dry land appeares in the midst of it, and hee knowes how to tame it when the waves thereof are at proudest, and rise highest.

13. In a word, by his powerfull* spirit, wherewith he worketh, he hath both beautified and set forth the hea|vens in such a glorious manner as wee see; yea, the same powerfull hand it is (which indeed onely maketh all things) that hath also formed the most deformed and dreadfull creature in the earth.

14. Hereby you may imagine what* I know thinke, and believe of God by these descriptions I have made of him, which yet I know are but parts of his admirable excellencies, and farre short of him; for when you and I have said all wee can to set him forth, how little notwithstanding, will it be in compa|rison of him and his greatnesse? as may appeare by one instance more, which sets him forth most of all, and that is the power and Majesty that hee utters in his thunder, which who can suffici|ently admire?

CHAP. XXVII.

1. *JOB* having thus taken up *Bil|dad*,* his three friends seeing they could doe no good on him, held their peace, whereupon he takes occa|sion to speake his mind fully, and thus goes on:

2. As the Lord liveth, who hath* not cleared mee to be what I am, but hath laid it upon mee to be thus mis|judged; and unjustly censured and condemned for a wicked man, because of mine afflictions, yea, I protest by the Almighty, who I know, hath caused all these grievous vexations to be|fall mee;

3. That whilst I breath, and God* lends me life,

4. No respect in the world shall make me eate my words, or goe against*my knowledge; for no mans pleasure or importunity will I do wickedly and betray the truth by saying otherwaies of my selfe than I have said, although never so many should judge against mee.

5. No, God forbid that I should* bolster you up in that sinfull ••ispri|sion and uncharitablenesse of yours, by yeelding it for a truth, which you say, that God does punish me for mine hypocrisie and wickednesse, no, I will never doe it whilst I live; I will not belie my selfe, nor relinquish mine in|tegrity, thinke how you will, and say of me what you will for it.

6. I am resolved to maintaine mine* uprightnesse, and not to part with it upon your perswasions or suspitions, my heart shall never be brought by any thing you can doe to accuse mee falsely of hypocrisie.

7. For my part, I am sure, I am no* such man as you conceit me to be, nor doe I account my selfe ever the lesse righteous, or the lesse favoured of God for these my sufferings, but it is mine enemy, and hee that hath done mee wrong, that is, both the unrighteous and the unhappy man; it is the wic|ked, and not the afflicted, that is out of favour with God.

8. As may appeare by the hope|lesse* and comfortlesse state which the wicked oppressour is in, though he be never so prosperous, and hath gained never so much, when God once sum|mons him by death.

9. For how in vaine doth God let* him cry for comfort, not giving him any, when the conscience of his sins torment him, and the feare of death approaching, seiseth on him.

10. And what little joy he hath to* thinke of God, and how unable hee is to sustaine or comfort himselfe with faithfull and constant seeking and praying to the Lord.

11. I will shew you by mine owne* observation of Gods usuall procee|dings toward wicked men, what hee hath in store (if that he pleaseth to ex|ecute it) for such wicked wretches as have done me this wrong, thus unjust|ly to oppresse and rob mee, being in|nocent: (for what I know to be a truth touching the Almighty, I will neither deny nor conceale it, though I there|by oppose your false conclusions and collections touching your prescribing God, and wronging me.)

12. Nor is it any other than what* your selves have confessed and affir|med to have noted as well as I, onely by the way, tell me then how you can be so inconsiderate in what you say, as to affirme outward prosperity and wealth to be the signe of Gods favour, and the contrary a signe of his dis|favour.

13. Seeing, as I say, you know; that* this is the portion that God hath allot|ted to wicked men, and that which is due to them from the Almighty, and which they often actually receive.

14. That is, that they shall be ac|cursed,* both they and theirs, and shall be unhappy in their happinesse; for though their children multiply never so, it shall be but the more to serve and satisfie Gods revengefull displeasure against them, who will wrathfully de|your and cut them off with the sword of his Justice, and though they multi|ply and lay up never so much for their children, yet God will bring them to want and penury.

15. Both themselves and all that* come of them shall be hated, so that no man shall speak well of them when they are dead, but their name shall be buried and shall rot with them, yea, they shall die undesired and unlamen|ted of their owne very wives which they leave behinde them, and of those funerall-women which are wont to bewaile the deaths of the well-deser|ving, and to weepe over their graves.

16. How ever they abound in all* kinde of worldly wealth;

17. Which I confesse for present* God may permit them to doe, but they nor theirs shall be never the better for it, it shall come againe to the just and innocent from whom they had it.
18. They may lay up and build, but* to little purpose, for all shall b• lost and puld downe againe in a very little time, even as the moth is brushed out of the garment where shee had made her nest; or as the shepheard re|moves his Cabin.
19. The rich oppressour for all his* riches shall one day die, as other men doe, but he shall not be brought to his grave as others are with sorrow for his death; upon his death-bed hee shall looke about for comfort and recove|ry, but in stead thereof shall see him|selfe departing from all his former happinesse, and death at hand.
20. And then shall an infinit weight* of terrors oppresse him, and the wrath of the Lord shall take him away when he expected it least.
21. The fierce anger of the Lord* shall force him hence, full sore against his will, never to returne againe, which shall with irresistable strength thrust him out of his Paradise.
22. For God shall heape afflictions* on him as thicke as hailestones, with|out shewing him any mercy at all, and in vaine shall he seeke to escape him.
23. Nor shall any man be sorry for* his death, but hee shall depart hence with the reproach and obloquie of all men.

CHAP. XXVIII.

1. The secrets of nature, though* they be hid and very obscure, yet they are found out, and knowne, both where they are placed by nature, and how they are to be used by Art, through the naturall wisdom that God hath given to man, as we see in the most hiddenest mysteries of na|ture, such as is the silver veine, which though deepe in the earth, and farre out of sight, yet is found out and knowne, as also is the Art of fining it, and gold, from their drosse, to make them usefull.
2. So also it is knowne how Iron* and Brasse comes out of the earth, though it be a notable secret in na|ture, and the art of melting it out of the stone is found out and practised.
3. By the skill that God hath given* to man, he is able to bring to light, and gaine the knowledge of the most re|mote & unknowne things, and by sear|ching to finde out all the perfection of nature, the pretiourest stones and things that are ingendred and bred in the darkesome and deadly vaults of the earth.
4. He knowes how to divert great* rivers out of their channell, and for his use to turne their course from those that dwelt upon them, so that he leaves them dry-foot, and they wonder what is become of them.

5. He knowes how to put the earth* to all uses, for the superficies of it, that yeelds him bread, and lower downe, out of the inwards of it he digges the materials of fire; as coles, &c. or finds out bright shining metalls, and spark|ling stones created of a sulphurous matter.

6. Hee knowes where the riches* thereof are; as pretious stones and gold, how to come by them, and where to finde them, the one among the quarries, the other among the dust and mold of the earth.

7. Hee by his skill and industry,* goes as low under ground for these things, as the fowles flie high; hee makes and findes out such waies in the earth, as the most piercing sighted, or most prey-seeking bird in all the aire,* never found nor saw.

8. Neither did the most ranging or fierce prey-seeking beast ever tread.

9. He attempts and effects the har|dest* matters, and doth difficult things, for the very rocks escape not his hand, neither can the mountaines withstand him, but by art and industry hee mi|neth them, and works his will on both, to find the things he seekes for.

10. By his labour and skill he cuts* out passages & soughs in the hard and stony rocks, to cōvey away the subter|ranean torrents that would hinder his mining; No rich commodity that na|ture yeelds will hee let be lost for fin|ding out, but brings all to light through labour and skill, be it never so low hid in the bowells of the earth.

11. He deviseth waies to keepe out* the floods which are caused by excesse of raine, and naturally seekes out the lowest descent to run into; from fal|ling into his pit, or interrupting his worke, and whatsoever nature hath hid from him in her lowest depths and concaves, he knowes how to compasse and get it, notwithstanding all manner of difficulties.

12. Thus man is able to invent and* find out waies by nature, art, and in|dustry to discover and compasse all things though never so strange and difficult, if they be within the bounds of nature. But now for supernaturall and divine wisdom (which is the knowledge of God, and his waies that are unsearchable and past finding out) who is he that can by his art and skill shew how to compasse that, and finde out the way and meanes to get this un|derstanding?

13. Herein man is a foole, though* otherwaies never so wise, hee neither hath what to bid for it, nor knowes how to come by it; for it is of higher value, and harder to be compassed than the precioussest things of the world, being no where within the bounds of nature, nor within the work of creation to be had; for it is no earth|ly, but a heavenly thing, hid in God.

14. If you dig to the very center of* the earth to finde it out, you shall lose your labour, or if you dive to the bot|tome of the sea, you are never the neere; for neither sea nor land con|taine it.

15. Neither can it be bought at any* rate, God will not merchandize it to man for gold nor silver.
16. Nothing that can be named* comes neere the worth of it, the fi|nest gold nor richest stones.
17. There is no degree of compa|rison* betweene it, and whatsoever you can imagine besides, Gold nor Chry|stall, nor ought else can equall it, and therefore God, from whom onely we must have it, will not give it for any thing wee can give for it, not for the finest gold, were there never so much offered him.
18. It's in vaine to tender the rarest* or richest things in all the world for it, Corall, or Pearle; for it is infinitely be|yond Rubies or the rarest and most unvaluable things of all the earth.
19. Be they never so farre fetched,* or never so much worth, as the Ethi|opian Topaz, and the gold of Ophir.
20. So that I say then, How, or* where is it possible for man to com|passe this transcendent wisdom and understanding, which yet you would seeme to have?
21. Seeing it is not as other things* are, within the compasse of naturall reason, nor by any naturall meanes of art and industry to be attained. Nature is an utter stranger to it, it is hid from the knowledge of all crea|tures, high or low, one or other.
22. The most hidden and secret* things, the grave and hell, though this wisdom be in them, and they be or|dered by it, yet as deepe as they are, it is deeper than they, so that they give not bounds unto it, nor can teach us the way to know it.*
23. God onely knowes the way of his owne supernaturall wisdom, hee hath reserved it to himselfe, and with him onely it remaines.
24. For it is hee, who alone by his* own wisdom ordereth and disposeth all things at his pleasure, every where throughout the whole Universe.
25. Weighing forth that proportion* of winds according to his purpose, to blow where and when he pleaseth; and likewise sending forth what quantity of raine him liketh here and there.
26. Before any thing had being,* this wisdom was with him; for out of it hee decreed the manner and way of the raine, so also of the thunder and lightening.
27. Even then was hee acquainted* with it in himselfe, not in the creature, as wee are, which hee declared by the creature; not learned from the crea|ture, as we doe, hee decreed all things by it, and brought them forth in their order and manner as they now ap|peare through it.
28. Hee hath reserved to himselfe* the wisdom of government, and hath taught man another lesson, than to les|son and prescribe him, to wit, to be obedient to him, to feare his Name, and keepe his holy Commandements, that is his duty, and therein is his wise|dome and understanding.

CHAP. XXIX.

1. *JOB* after that hee had reprov'd *Bildad*, justified himselfe, and convinced his friends of the un|searchable waies of Gods wisdom, in the three foregoing Chapters; finding them all mute, and no reply made up|on him, thus further proceeds to speak in his owne behalfe, by wishes, bewai|lings, and selfe-justifyings in these three Chapters following.
2. Oh (saies hee) that it were with* mee now as it was heretofore, when God smiled upon me, and upheld me in prosperity and happinesse.
3. When I was apparantly blessed* of him, so that every one saw, and could say, that hee exceedingly favou|red me, when no cloud overshadowed me, but by the mercy of the Lord be|ing free from sorrow and affliction whereto this life is so subject, I for my part had all happinesse and good suc|cesse attending me in stead thereof.
4. In my former daies thus it was:* The speciall and peculiar love of God to mee was then acknowledged by all, and seene in evident tokens of good will by his blessing and prospering me and all that belonged unto me; O that it were so now, as it was then!
5. Before this evill befell me, when* as God Almighty was extraordinarily with me in the ample manifestation of his love unto me, and unremoved from mee as now hee is, when my children were all alive, and were great com|forts unto mee.
6. When I had all manner of plen|ty,* abounding in every good thing, and when as there was nothing but by the will of God, it was blessed and made serviceable to me, and conduced to en|rich mee.
7. When I went honourably atten|ded* to the place of judicature, having many spectatours; and had the seat of justice set up, and made ready for mee in the place of concourse.
8. When men of all ages and de|grees* revered mee; for the young men knowing my wisdom, and see|ing my grave deportment, would in a respectfull distance, absent themselves from my presence, as awed with it, and fearing the censure of my wise|dome and gravity, the aged also had mee in such esteeme, that they would performe that respect to me which was due to them.
9. My wisdom and my person was* had in such account, as that the very chiefe and prime of all the Princes of the people would refraine to speake before me in reverence of me.
10. The Noble men were so awed* with my wisdom, that they were a|fraid to speake in my presence.
11. When ever I spake, it was known* to be with such wisdom and integri|ty, that they that heard mee, would blesse me, and blesse God for mee, and all men when

they saw mee, would give mee the praise thereof, and ac|knowledged me for my wise and up|right carriage of things amongst them to be a blessing to them.

12. For, because I righted the poore* that complained of wrong, and be|friended the fatherlesse in like sort, and was ever a helper to the helplesse person.

13. The affectionate prayer of ma|ny* a poore soule hath beene bestowed upon mee, who being hopelesse, and not knowing which way to turne him, I have stucke to in his extremity, and kept him from undoing: And the poore distressed widow, when she was wronged, I tooke her part, and righted her upon her adversary, to the chea|ring and rejoycing of her sad heart in her friendlesse and exposed condition.

14. It was my study and care in all* my waies to be righteous, unblame|able, and just both before God and man, for which God greatly blessed mee, and men highly honoured me.

15. I gave advice and counsell to* the simple, and support to the weake and impotent.

16. I was a pitifull to the poore as* a father to his childe, and as carefull of them; so that they wanted not what I could bestead them in; and the cause which to the poore mans disad|vantage was coloured over with de|ceitfull pleadings, I tooke paines in it to finde out the truth, that the poore might receive no wrong.

17. And I disappointed the wicked* mans covetous and cruell purposes, nor ever could I suffer his power to pre|vaile against the innocent, though it was never so great, but evermore re|scued the oppressed out of his malice and rapine.

18. In those daies of my foresaid* prosperity, which God had so abun|dantly heaped upon me (to see there|fore his wonderfull waies) I little thought I should have come to this estate, having such abundance of all things, with Gods favour and mine owne integrity to secure me; I little thought, I say, I should ever have come to this, but hoped that I should have died in peace and quiet, rich and ho|nourable, after a long life.

19. For I grew up, and increased* wondrously in all manner of felicity, and the blessing of God continually attended on me, and was with and up|on every thing I did and all I had.

20. He increased mine honour dai|ly,* still supplying mee with extraordi|nary and seasonable wisdom upon every occasion, yea, and he increased my power also to execute my coun|sells.

21. Men longed to heare me deli|ver* my minde in any matter, waiting for Wisdom and Justice to come from me, and with silence diligently listened to mine advice and counsell.

22. Which when they had heard,* they received it as an Oracle, without reply; my speech was precious, and like dew drops, brought refreshing to their longing and expecting mindes when it fell from mee.

23. The former, nay, the later raine,* after the Summers heat, is not more thirsted for, and gaped after of the chawnd earth, than my judgement and advice was till I gave it.

24. If I by my smiles gave any in|timation* of my suspition of any re|port or businesse, it was presently di|strusted and dissented from of all the rest; and on the othe hand, my least countenance or shew of approbation to any cause, was observed of others as a rule to goe by.

25. In those daies I was the onely* man in all matters, chosen by consent of all to be the Prolocutor, and advan|ced to the first place in all assem|blies and places of Judicature, and had my house resorted to like a Kings Court in an army for advice, and dis|patch of businesse; yea, I was flocked unto from farre and neere, as a man of a thousand, that is knowne to be able to administer words of consolation to mournfull and drooping spirits, is wont to be.

CHAP. XXX.

1. THus it was with mee here|tofore:* whilst I prospered, I was had in honour, and e|steeme of all men, but now that God hath turned the scales, and cast me in|to affliction, all men (to see how vari|able their judgments are without rea|son) have me in contempt, yea, even those that are younger than I, who by all lawes of God and nature, owe mee respect for mine age sake, and which heretofore stood in awe of mee, doe now scorne mee, whose fathers were beggarly shackrags and base conditi|oned rascalls, whom I scorned to im|ploy in the meanest office I had; for I had none bad enough for such base companions, who were of such condi|tions that for my part, I valued my very shepheards curs beyond them.

2. Men, that neither I, nor any man* else, could make use of; for they were never good for any thing, but had wasted out their whole time unprofi|tably in idlenesse and lewd living.

3. Such as through their base pranks,* and vile conditions, durst not appeare in open view, but were driven to such straits, that they have not knowne which way to turne them, nor what course to take to get a bellie full of meat; for heretofore, when it was otherwaies with mee than now it is, they were glad for feare of me, to take their heeles, and flie farre enough off, into remote and unfrequented places, and there to lurke where I could not light on them.

4. Who, to avoid me, have beene* faine to live in a most penurious beg|garly manner, feeding on nothing but Mallowes and Juniper roots, and such like things in the time of their banish|ment.

5. Men of such vile conditions, that* not I only, but no man else could abide them, they were never thought wor|thy to live in any civill society, but were out-lawed of all men, and hated as if they had beene the arrantest thieves in the world.
6. So as that they were forced for* feare and shame, to dwell in remote obscure places, and durst not shew their heads:
7. But lived like wilde Asses, having* no company but themselves, and their hiding place was among bushes and nettles, where they hoped no body could finde them, or would come to seeke them.
8. They were children of most wic|ked* and despicable men, such as were not thought worthy to goe upon the ground.
9. And now these very fellows stick* not to come out of their holes, and to shew their faces in affront of mee, and to triumph over mee with scornfull Balads and by-words.
10. They abhorre, and disdainfully* keepe a loofe of mee, as scorning to come neere; they beard and affront mee in the vilest manner that can be imagined.
11. Because the Lord hath brought* me low, & bereaved me of that power and honour which I formerly injoyed, and wherewith I held them straitly under; therefore they now take the liberty and opportunity to despise me, and in an unbridled manner without feare, shame, or manners, offer mee abuse, and let loose the reines of all disrespect and contempt upon me.
12. A rowt of lawlesse youngsters* that could never abide mee; for be|cause I was ever most severe against them, have rebelliously assaulted me, and by strong hand robbed mee of all my worldly substance and support at once, utterly disabling me of all power to right or helpe my selfe, and have fully compassed my ruine, which they have long wished and intended to me, and have blocked up every doore of hope and possibility of better.
13. They hated my courses, and* could not away with my waies, and therefore their desire was to over|throw both mee and them, and to this end they forwarded my destruction all that ever they could possible: They needed none to animate or put them on to so mischievous a businesse.
14. For they were forward enough* to it of themselves, rushing in upon me with all their violence at once, and slacking no time, but fell pell mell up|on all that ever I had, adding one mis|chiefe to another, so fast as ever they could act it, when they saw opportuni|ty and the breach once made.
15. All manner of formidable evils* have light upon mee, they have sud|denly and vehemently surprised mee, to the great affrighting and amazing of my soule, when as all my welfare is thus vanished in a moment.
16. In so much as my soule and* spirit is quite wasted and spent with sorrow, my afflictions have so sore op|pressed mee.

17. Besides the losse of my estate,* my bodily paine is so great also, that my very bones and sinewes which should strengthen me, can themselves gather no strength through paine and restlesnesse in my very bed.

18. By the extremity of my disease,* and by the matter that it forceth out|ward in boiles and sores, the issuings whereof my clothes soake in, it com|meth to passe they are utterly stained and spoiled, and so stiffened with that congealed matter, as that they which once sate loose and easie to my body, are all over now as hard and strait up|on me as my collar.

19. God hath, as it were, trampled* me to dirt, and made me like an heape of dust and ashes.

20. And furthermore, in all this* extremity I cry to God, and can get no answer nor reliefe; I present my selfe before him in prayer, and offer my selfe to his view, to see if such a pitifull spectacle and suppliant, can move any thing with him, but it availes me nothing.

21. Thou hast not dealt so well with* mee heretofore, but now thou dealest as ill; thy infinite goodnesse seemes to be turned into infinite severity and hard-hearted cruelty; for one would thinke that with all the maine force of thy mighty power thou opposest thy selfe gainst me, so as that thou couldst not use me worse than thou dost.

22. As the whirlepust lifts up the* dust, and carries it farre away; so hast thou as with a sudden blast, translated mee out of all health and happinesse, that the earth and this life can afford, and hast separated me as such an infinit distance from them, that I am sure we can never meet againe; for my flesh is already falling asunder peacemeale, and turning to dust, as if it were in the grave.

23. And this thou dost, because I* know thou art purposed utterly to make an end of me, and by afflictions to bring me to the grave, whither all men living must come sooner or later, one way or other, as it pleaseth thee.

24. Howbeit I am sure of this, That* the Lord will not trouble mee here, but that there I shall have rest, both I and others that are innocent like my selfe, whom yet here hee is pleased to exercise under affliction, and to make grone under heavie pressures.

25. I did not carry my selfe towards* other men, as other men carry them|selves toward me, and therefore I ho|ped for better. I am sure I wept for them that were in trouble, and my soule had a fellow-feeling of the poore mans misery that at any time be|fell him.

26. And now that I ought to have* beene so dealt withall by others, it's nothing so, but whereas I expected and hoped to have found some pity, I finde none; and in stead of that com|fort I hoped to have received from my friends and companions, I can find no|thing but discomfort.

27. With most compassionate sym|pathie* did my bowells earne over the afflicted, so that I could have no quiet in my selfe, for grieving and taking thought for them, I was seldome or never without sorrow for some one or others affliction.

28. Such was my fellow-feeling,* and my heart tooke on so sore for them, that nothing could comfort me, me thought the Sun shone not warme upon me the whilest: yea, so sensible was I of their pressures, that I could not containe my selfe, but made their cases knowne in an open and pitifull manner to other men, to raise them more friends, and to move others also as well as my selfe to pity and pray for them.

29. But on the contrary, I am un|pitied* and forsaken of all men, a so|litary and forlorne man in these my miseries.

30. These things make me in a la|mentable* state, so that my skin with sorrow and anguish, is quite changed from white to blacke, and my bones are, as it were, consumed with inward torment of soule.

31. Every thing increaseth sorrow,* nothing in the world affords mee any comfort, so that all my musicall in|struments have quite changed their tune, and now there is nothing but wo and lamentation heard from me.

CHAP. XXXI.

1. BUt however it hath pleased* God to deale with me, or what ever the world thinkes of me, I am sure that I have walked strictly with God, and have given mine heart to him in all points, with full purpose to order all my waies with selfe-deni|all according to his will; as to instance first in the most flesh-pleasing lust of carnall concupiscence. I made a co|venant with mine eyes touching it, ne|ver to looke upon a maid unlawfully to lust after her, and set a strict watch over them accordingly, to prevent their sudden surprisall and inconsiderate glances; and like as I watched mine eyes without; so upon the same reason, because I would not offend God, did I also watch my thoughts within, that they entertained no Iust|full speculations, thus taking care, and using all diligence to approve my selfe every way upright to God, both with|in and without.

2. For I knew, and well considered* the reward of a sinfull man and an hy|pocrite that either lived loosely, or caried it cunningly, how that to such a man, God, who from above seeth all things here below would afford no grace nor favour;

3. But contrarily hath in his just* decree appointed destruction for such, and his fearefull indignation severely to light upon them.

4. I evermore set the Lord before* mine eyes as seeing all my waies, and observing my paths, who I know, knowes them well enough.

5. And therefore I appeale to him,* whether I have walked in any vaine way or sinfull course, or if I have de|lighted or desired to doe wrong to any.

6. I desire with all my heart that* God would take my judgement into his owne hands, where I am sure I should have right done mee; for I know his eyes cannot be so blinded with mine afflictions (though mens are) but that for all them hee will be able impartially to see and know mee to be upright.

7. For my part I desire no favour,* if he find mee not so, if hee find that I have (as is said of mee) stept aside to <1 page duplicate> <1 page duplicate> doe wickedly, or that I have willingly with consent of heart, suffered mine eyes to breake their bounds in lust or courting, or that my hands have beene guilty of receiving any bribe to the dishonour of my function, and blemish of mine integrity:

8. Then let God lay what punish|ment* he will upon mee, let nothing be blessed that I put my hands unto, but let mee plow and sow and take much paines for increase to no purpose, let others reape the profit from me; yea, let him root mee from off the earth, so that no one of all mine off-spring re|maine thereon to uphold my name.

9. If I have suffered mine heart to* be seduced from mine owne wife by any other woman, or if I have ever wronged any one in that kinde:

10. Then let me be so dealt withall,* as is but just and equall; let my wife breake her bond of duty to mee, and subject her selfe to another, and let her be adulterously prostituted to o|ther men in like manner.

11. For this is a sinne most notori|ously* vile, and extremely odious to God, which shall not escape unpunish|ed of him, who hath appointed it to be punished even by the civill Ma|gistrate.

12. If I be guilty of this, I know* very well what will come of it, That it shall certainly kindle the wrath of God against me, to mine utter ruine and destruction.

13. Or if ever through pride or* passion I was wont by strong hand to beare downe, or sleight the righteous cause and just pleadings of those that were my servants, man or maid, when in any businesse they desired mee to heare them cleare themselves.

14. For I had this humbling con|sideration* ever in my thoughts, which made mee carry my selfe fittingly to|ward them: If I reject and scorne mine inferiours, and stop mine eares against their humble intreaties, and just defences, how thinke I, shall I an|swer it to God, when he questions me upon it? or how shall I speed with him, who is so infinitely beyond me, when he takes up a controversie against me? how then shall I have my prayers heard, or my answers and humble pleadings in mine owne behalfe finde acceptance, and take place with him?

15. And thus I further considered,* Did not the same God make him that made mee, and caused us to be borne alike, and so to be equall in nature, though in civill respects he hath pre|ferred me before him.

16. If I have detained the poore* mans pledge against his will, or have any way wronged him, eyther by de|laying to doe him right, or by keeping him from his right, or have given cause to the widow to weepe and com|plaine of mee, either for doing her wrong my selfe, or not righting her on others that wronged her.

17. Or if I have either basely or co|vetously,* unhospitably, or uncharita|bly been wont to devour my substance my selfe alone, without imparting it with a free and bountifull mind to the fatherlesse, and such as had need.

18. (For I have been ever a harbou|rer* and succourer of the distressed, and have alwaies had a fatherly care to provide for all such as I saw were help|lesse and in need, fatherlesse, or wid|dow.)

19. If I have seene any poore soule* suffer through nakednesse and want of clothing, or any poore man destitute of necessities to keepe him warme:

20. And have not in pity and cha|rity* supplied him, and accommodated him with clothing and all needfull conveniences out of the store that God hath given me:

21. If I have taken advantage by* my power and authority to wrong or oppresse any fatherlesse or helplesse one in judgement, though if I would I could have beene sure to have had it gone on my side against them:

22. If these or any of these can just|ly* be laid to my charge, then let the Lord marke mee for such an one by some notorious judgement, beyond any that hee hath laid upon mee yet; Let mine arme rot off, or to make it more remarkable, let it fall suddenly from my shoulder, and be broken from the bone that doth uphold it, to my utter disabling, as a punishment of my sin, and token of my hypocrifie.

23. I am sure none of these can be* justly fathered upon me; for I alwaies had the feare of God before mine eyes; I knew how he hated and would punish such things, and therefore durst never be guilty of any of them; his greatnesse and majesty awed me that I durst do no such matters.

24. If I have beene guilty of spiri|tuall* Idolatry, making gold my God, by reposing any hope in it to be hap|py by it, or have built my faith and confidence of future subsistency and welfare in my abundance of the choi|sest and chiefest riches:

25. If in a carnall security I have* immoderately rejoyced in mine abun|dance of wealth, or as if because by mine owne wit and industry I had heaped up much:

26. If ever I beheld the Sunne in* his glory, or the Moone in her beau|ty, as doe the Idolatrous heathen a|bout me:

27. And have either secretly in my* heart and affections beene enticed to worship those excellent creatures in stead of the Creator, and ascribe to them the honour and thanks of his providence, as they doe; or openly by such outward expressions as they use.

28. This also, could it be laid to my* charge, were worthy punishment from God; for it were no lesse than blasphem|y and Atheisme, and so of due to be punished even by the Magistrate.

29. If I revengefully rejoyced at* the destruction of mine enemy and him that hated me, or proudly tram|pled upon him in his misery, which I have not.

30. (Neither have I given way to* my passion so much as to let my mouth breake out sinfully to curse him, or to wish him evill)

31. Yea, though I have been strong|ly* pressed by others to revenge my selfe, who were neere unto me, and had power with mee in other things, and who themselves, out of love and respect to mee, being impatient of mine injury, would faine have wrought my revenge, and offered it, if I would have suffered them.

32. It's well knowne, the stranger* did not lodge harbourlesse if I knew of it, but that I bid the way-faring weary traveller welcome to my house.

33. If I at any time have concealed* my sin from God, as did *Adam*, and as all men naturally are apt to doe, by excuse or extenuation, and have not humbly with selfe-judging confessed it to him, but kept it unuttered in my bosome, as loth to leave it, or to be humbled for it.

34. No, I did none of these, nor did* I ever, either for the feare of a violent and combined multitude, or of the losse of friends and acquaintance, and their falling off from mee, (though they were of never so considerable quality and number) at any time keep within doores, and hide my head, or hold my peace, but openly reprov'd sinne, and shewed my selfe alwaies in the behalfe of the innocent with impartiality and justice.

35. O that any one heard mee that* could object any thing against me, nay, if I lie, I desire the Almighty would tel me so, and that any, whomsoever he is, (for I except none) that can object any thing against what I have said, would make his allegations against mee, and set downe his accusations in writing; that I might reade and know them, and so might compleatly cleare my selfe by my reply.

36. Surely I would not take it ill* at any mans hands whomsoever, but would thinke he did mee a very great favour in it, and would set choicely by it, nor should it daunt mee, but incou|rage me, for I should not doubt, but upon my reply, it would turne to my exceeding honour; for mine innocen|cy assureth me the triumph and victo|ry over any adversary, or accusations in the world.

37. I would deale truly with him;* for I would tell him all that ever I know by my selfe, and would relate unto him the whole course of my life, nor would I shrink back, or flinch him one jot, but would boldly encounter him, and make good my matter a|gainst him whoever hee were.

38. If my land blame mee for un|just* and cruell dealings toward them that plowed and husbanded it.
39. If I have reaped the benefit of* it through other mens labours with|out wages justly paid them, or have racked my rents to the occupiers un|doing.
40. Then let all my labour and seed* be evermore lost; Let thistles grow in stead of Wheat, and cockle in stead of Barley; let me have weeds for corne. The words of *Job* in expostulation with his three friends are here ended.

CHAP. XXXII.

1. FOr these three foresaid men* seeing they could not prevaile with *Job* to be otherwaies opi|nionated of himselfe then as an up|right & innocent man, gave over now at last to presse any more upon him.
2. *Elihu* the sonne of *Barachel*, who* came of *Buz*, the sonne of *Nahor*, who was the brother of *Abraham*, having heard all that had past betweene *Job* and his three friends was moved with indignation against both him and them. Now the reason why hee was angry with *Job*, was not because hee maintained his owne integrity against his friends, but because he over-eyed his owne righteousness to the lessen|ing of Gods, pleading it too farre (not onely against his friends, but) even to God him selfe in the way of expostu|lation, and therewith questioning his righteousness in so dealing with him, in stead of acknowledging it, and ad|miring his waies.
3. And the reason why he was also* angry with *Iobs* three friends, was, be|cause they could not directly taxe *Job*, nor convincingly prove against him, that which all this while upon a bare surmise they had accused him of, namely, of being an hypocrite and and wicked man.
4. Now *Elihu* (though with childe* to speake) yet had modestly bridled his desire till *Job* had fully ended his last and long reply, nor had hee ever offered to interrupt the discourse of *Iobs* three friends in all this time, or put himselfe in amongst them; for be|ing all his Elders, he gave them prece|dency of speech.
5. But when he had heard out *Job*,* and saw that those three men were gravelled, and that for all that they had said against him, they were now at last (for want of cleare conviction) faine to leave him as they found him, to wit, a righteous man, and innocent of the hypocrisie and crimes they laid to his charge. He hereupon was pro|voked to utter his minde.
6. And thus at last, *Elihu* the sonne* of the a foresaid *Barachel* the *Buzite* put forth himselfe to speake as followeth: I am conscious to my selfe of my youth, together with the weaknesses accom|panying it, and of your precedencie of age, and the

advantages which usually attend it, which did awe me from speaking all this while, so that I durst not shew mine opinion in so weighty a businessse, nor before such grave persons, till that I had heard all that you could say.

7. For though my youthfull desire* prompted me to speake, yet I checked it, and refrained my selfe, giving leave (as was fitting) for those who were my ancients to speake first, who I thought in all probability knew therefore best how wisely to instruct the erring.

8. But though age hath oddes of* youth, yet one man as well as another hath a spirit of understanding, (reason and judgement) in him, whereby through supply of speciall inspiration from God that can doe all things, hee may be able to know that which want of yeeres denies him.

9. Wisdome is the gift of God, and* therefore those men alwaies have it not that we thinke are the likeliest; for we see great men, who have advantage of meanes and education, are not alwaies the wisest men, neither the aged that have advantage of time and experience, have alwaies proportionable understanding and judgement, but may, and doe both of them come short (at least in some things) of their inferiours.

10. My spirit therefore being inspired* of God, and also stirred up by him to speake, and having noted your errors, notwithstanding your ages, I am bold to take leave to challenge your attentions, till I also give my judgement, and take my turne in this cause.

11. Know you all, that I have not* slept the while I have beene silent, but diligently waited for, and attended to all you said; I seriously considered the reasons and arguments which fell from you, which I perceived all this while to be the best you could invent to evince your adversary.

12. Yea, I purposely hearkened to* you to have had some convincing reasons from you of that you accused *Job*, but the truth is, (for so farre I must take his part) there is not any one of you, that hath convincingly proved that you alleged against him, nor answered that which hee hath said for himselfe.

13. God hath given him the victory,* that you might see the weaknesse of your argument, and not continue confident in your erroneous maxime, as if it were an unerring truth. That *Job* must needs be a wicked hypocrite, because God, who is just and all-seeing, and cannot doe wrong, nor mistake as man may, does afflict him.

14. Now, as hitherto I have given* *Job* no cause by siding with you to say any thing against me, so neither will I now doe it; for I utterly dislike your course, and therefore will neither take up your Theme against him to condemn him for an hypocrite, nor use your argument to prove it, because of Gods afflicting him; for I hold it a meere Sophisme.

15. They that should have spoken* to *Jobs* reply, fell to wondring at him in stead of convincing him with fur|ther and better arguments; for indeed, having no more to say, they were for|ced to give over their feeble reaso|ning.
16. So that when I had waited for* their answer as at other times, but heard none from them (for they were all silent and made no reply.)
17. I was resolved hereupon to take* the matter in hand, to answer *Job* my selfe, and to give mine opinion in the businesse.
18. For I have much to say, and* many reasons to urge against him in Gods behalfe, and my mind standeth vehemently to utter them.
19. Yea, I cannot hold, I even swell* with desire to speake my mind, that *Iob* may be humbled, and God glo|rified.
20. I must needs therefore speake* to ease my spirit, yea, I both must, and will make answer for God.
21. In whose businesse, let it not* be expected from mee to spare any mans fault out of respect to his person or condition, nor to sooth you up in your errorrs and mistakes, with faire words, and flattering encomiums.
22. For I am not skilled in the way* of flattery, nor durst I use it, if I were, for in so doing, I know I should pro|voke the omniscient God that made mee, and who hateth such things, to be avenged on mee with speedy de|struction.

CHAP. XXXIII.

1. WHerefore, *Iob*, I pray thee,* give good heed to what I shall say, and let it not be tedious to thee, but conceive of it as comming from one that wishes thee well, and have the patience to heare mee out.
2. Thou seest I have not beene for|ward* to speake, but have waited till now that all have done, which I take to be a fit time for me to begin, having heard all that hath beene said on both sides, and seriously weighed them, which makes mee both the abler and bolder now to speake my mind.
3. And beforehand, I assure thee* this, which also I would have thee credit, that I will speake nothing out of passion or partiality, as thou con|ceivest others to have done, but what I say shall come from an honest heart, nor will I obtrude mine owne con|jectures and surmises for doctrinall truths upon thee, as my fore-runners have, but I will utter demonstrative things.
4. Thou hast wished for one like* thy selfe in Gods stead, to dispute the matter with thee, why, know, that I am he. I am a creature as thou art, nei|ther better nor worse, but in all points the same with thy selfe, made by the finger of God as thou art, and have my life from him as thou hast.

5. Therefore now make good thy* challenge, and if thou canst, spare not to answer to that which I shall say; for thou maist boldly speake thy minde, there is no cause of feare.
6. For, as I say, I am in Gods stead* according to thy desire to dispute the matter with thee, who am just such an one as thou art, neither higher nor lower, but a pot by the hand of the Potter, molded out of the same clay.
7. So that (as thou conditionedst)* thou seest there is no cause of feare to deale with me, nor can I doe thee any hurt or oppresse thee, so as to hinder thee from speaking thy mind fully and freely.
8. I will lay nothing to thy charge,* nor object any thing against thee, but what I have heard come from thee, yea, out of thine owne mouth will I condemne thee, for thus thou hast presumptuously spoken.
9. (Justifying thine owne righte|ousnesse,* and questioning Gods) I have not sinned against God, but am inno|cent from giving him any offence, neither can hee lay any iniquity to my charge, or shew cause why hee thus afflicts mee.
10. So that he is over rigorous, pur|posely* picking quarrells against mee, and of his meere pleasure maketh cru|ell warre upon me without just cause.
11. Using all manner of hardship* toward me, keeping mee continually fast locked in afflictions, watching me, lest I should make an escape, and find some ease, which he will by no means permit mee to have.
12. Thus, or to this purpose, hast* thou charged God, thou canst not de|ny it, and however thou art other|waies upright or righteous, I will not take upon me to judge, onely in this I am sure, and dare say thou art not justi|fiable, but worthy to be condemned of sinfull and presumptuous arrogance and pride of heart (for which God may and does justly afflict thee) and thus I prove it, from the wonderfull dispari|ty betweene God and man, betwixt whom there is no comparison, God in|finitely transcending him, and his ca|pacity to judge.
13. And consequently, how inso|lent* a thing is it for thee to cample and reason it thus unreverently with God as thou hast done, whose will in all things is a law most righteous, nor is he bound to give any other reason but his will for any of his actions.
14. In all which, yet there is reason* and a gracious meaning too, if thou knewest it; for God many times, and divers waies solicits and admonisheth man (as now hee doth thee) if man would, and could understand him, which partly through the pride and security, and partly through the dul|nesse of his heart he does not.
15. Out of which spirituall slum|ber,* God trieth all waies to awaken men; for he teacheth them by nightly molestations, in dreams and visions, to the disturbance of their sleep and rest, as thou complainest.

16. And this way he taketh to in|struct* men, and remarkeably to set his home doctrine upon them.

17. Which is, to withdraw man* from cherishing and maintaining him|selfe in his owne selfe-valuing con|ceits, derogatory to God, and to bring him to stoope to an humble and selfe|denying subjection to him, expunging pride, (which God corrects in thee.)

18. That so he may in mercy keep* him from perishing for it, both in soule and body, temporally and eternally.

19. And further also, to worke this* cure, and purge this pride, hee brings high-minded man into a wofull con|dition, easelessly punishing him with tormenting paines, as hee does thee, yea, making every bone in his body (as many as they are) to ake with ve|hement torture.

20. So that hee may be forced* through extremity of anguish, neither to care to eate necessary nor pleasant meat, but neglect all manner of suste|nance.

21. Yea, he may be brought to that* passe and such a change wrought in him, as that his flesh which was wont to be plump and smooth, may be ut|terly wasted to nothing (as thou com|plainest thine is) and his bones, which before were comelily covered, may most deformedly and gastly stick out.

22. Yea, hee may be at the very* point of death, ready to breath out his soule, and his life in continuall jeo|pardy by his deadly plagues.

23. Now, when God hath brought* him to this passe, and he still continues blind, and none of all this will make him perceive his errour and Gods in|tention, if then besides this, God so or|der the matter, as that in his gracious providence he further provide for his instruction, and send as a speciall mes|senger (as hee does mee to thee) a man faithfull and able (which is a singular gift of God and very rare) to bring him to a sight of his sinne, and to set him upright in the sight of God by re|pentance.

24. This soone altereth the case;* for hereupon God is presently appea|sed toward him, and graciously ac|cepts him, comfortably cheering his heart with an assured freedome from death and hell, his sinne upon his re|pentance being done away in the sight of God by the blood of his Son which he sees accepted in his behalfe.

25. And then, as before, through* anguish of his spirit his body was con|sumed; so now, through the abundant consolation thereof he grows revived, and becomes as fat and faire-liking as ever he was in his life.

26. And whereas before all his* complainings and out-cries stood him in no stead, now he shall humbly put up his suit to God for favour, and shall finde it: and whereas, if hee did but thinke of God, he was troubled; now being justified from his sinne, he shall have abundance of joy and peace in his soule toward God.

27. For God longs to be gracious* to mee, and waites that hee may be so, looking when a man will see his sinne and confesse it, how that he hath gone out of the way, and justly suffers by it.

28. Such a man shall soone have his* pardon sealed, his feare banished, and his soule comforted; so that for after|wards he shall lead a happy life.

29. Lo, I have told thee what varie|ties* of waies, and diversity of meanes God is oftentimes faine to use toward such a man as he meanes well to.

30. Aiming onely at his good, that* his sin unrepented of be not his death and destruction, but that in the sight and feeling of Gods grace and favour towards him, hee may lead a comfor|table and happy life.

31. *Iob*, I pray thee consider well* what I say, as that which neerely con|cernes thy good, let mee yet further have thine attention without interrup|tion, for I have more to speake.

32. Not that I desire to stop thy* mouth, if thou questionest any thing that I have said, and hast any just ex|ception against it in thine owne de|fence, if thou hast, speake freely, for I desire not to condemne thee in any thing wherein thou art justifiable; on|ly thy pride I tax, which is apparant.

33. But if so be thou canst take no* just exception, then doe not needlesse|ly interrupt me, but let me goe on, and I make no question but before I have done, I shall make thee understand thine errour, and Gods just dealing, and shall shew thee the way to finde mercy.

CHAP. XXXIV.

1. WHereupon *Elihu* goes on* further to question *Iob* of, and to give answer to the words he spake against God, and ap|pealing to his friends touching them, hee said:

2. I pray you listen well to what I* say, and according to your wisdomes judge of it; give eare to what I speake, and let your understandings censure if it be not right.

3. For a judicious and considerate* eare can as aptly judge of things that are spoken, as the palate of a man can naturally distinguish and relish meats that are eaten.

4. Let us not plead against *Iob* by* ungrounded conjectures, but let us state the controversie against him, so as it is, that it may hold water; let us goe knowingly to worke according to apparant truth, which is the likely way to prevaile with him.

5. For *Jobs* miscarriage of himselfe* is evident, and how presumptuously he hath justified himselfe and accused God, is knowne to us all, saying, I am righteous, and God doth not doe me right accordingly, but dealeth too ri|gorously with mee.

6. I should lie and wrong my selfe* if I should not justifie my righteous|nesse, and maintaine it, that this my so grievous affliction is without just cause.

7. Did we ever heare the like? or* was there ever any man that durst in this manner as he hath done so migh|tily upbraid and reproach God, as if hee thirsted to despite him in the way of revenge?

8. Who hath so farre forgot him|selfe,* as that his carriage under his af|flictions is equall, and makes him like to those that never had knowledge of God, but have ever lived in sinne and prophanenesse, yea, hee walks just in their steps, and doth as the wicked do when God afflicts them.

9. Uttering impatient & presump|tuous* speeches; for upon the matter he hath said: That a man is never the better for loving God, and walking with him, the whilest hee justifies his owne righteousness, and taxeth God of cruelty.

10. Therefore hearken to what I* plead against him, and in your wise|doms, judge if he be not to be blamed for it; for, is it not a monstrous thing to fasten injustice upon God, and to dare to lay iniquity to the charge of the Almighty, which is so utterly con|trary to his nature, and can by no meanes belong to him, but to us:

11. For it is both his covenant and* custome, to render to men according to their works, and to judge them ac|cording to their waies.

12. Which he is well able to make* appeare, whatsoever we thinke to the contrary; for there is nothing more certaine and sure, than that God will not doe wickedly, neither will the Al|mighty, who is Judge of all the earth, deale unjustly.

13. Who hath put him in office, or* charged him with the supervisourship of the earth? that he should be questi|oned by him, and account to him, or who but himselfe (thinke we) is fit to dispose of the world, and all things in it in wisdom and justice?

14.. If God set his heart against* man, and resolve ether in his absolute sovereignty, or for punishment of his sinne to unmake him againe, by taking from him that which at first hee gave him to live and subsist by, that is, his soule and spirit.

15. Then of necessity, man-kinde* must all at once perish, and be annihi|lated or turned into the matter hee made him of, that is, to dust, and this may he most justly doe.

16. Now then *Job*, if thou hast un|derstanding* (as I know thou hast) con|sider with thy selfe, how justly he may doe thus by thee, who art but one, seeing that of his good pleasure onely it is, that all subsist. And now yet fur|ther, hearken to what I shall say for thy confuting.

17. Shall he, whom thou wouldest* make to delight in doing wrong, be fit to governe and punish wrong-doers, and wilt thou dare to condemne and taxe him thus of injustice, that is even righteousness it selfe, and the foun|taine whence all floweth?

18. Thou knowest both how un|decent* and dangerous it is, to taxe an earthly King, and to say to him, Thou art unrighteous, though hee be so, or to say to Princes, that yet are but mor|tall men, yee are unjust, though it be true.

19. How much more both dange|rous* and undecent must it needs be, wrongfully to accuse God hereof, who abhorres injustice and partiality, him|selfe not accepting of any whomso|ever for personall respects, not the Prince above the Peasant, nor the rich more than the poore; for it is his power that made them equall in na|ture, and his providence that made them differ in condition.

20. God brings his plagues oft|times,* and in many places suddenly, and never expostulates the matter, but in a trice executes judgement upon all, and makes no difference, but sweepes away the ignorant common people, at a time when they are most secure, and least feare it, and the great ones also that was fearelesse of any hu|mane strength, by a way they never dreamed of.

21. For he is both able and excee|ding* carefull to doe justice, to that end diligently beholding every mans waies, so that he cannot be mistaken in the execution of judgement, who overseeth and knoweth all their cour|ses better than themselves.

22. Yea, hee sees them all, and that* most clearely; for there is nothing can hide the most secretst sinnes of a wicked man from the sight of God.

23. So that however it may seeme* to us, God hath justice on his side; for he will punish no men wrongfully, nor by any unjust dealing will he give him just cause to complaine.

24. He punisheth all sorts of men,* not sparing those of the highest ranke, who yet are his Vicegerents on earth, but proceeds against them, and that without any legall processe and exa|mination of witnesses, but of his owne accord, displaceth them, and placeth others in their steads.

25. Wherefore we may be sure he* hath just cause for what he does, and that it is for their deservings that on a sudden unlooked for hee comes so fiercely upon them without warning or discussion of the cause, and quite destroyes them.

26. Though, as I say, they be his* Vicegerents, and next to himselfe, yet he spares them not, but being wicked, they fare alike with others that are so, his justice impartially plaguing them in an exemplary manner.

27. And the cause, no doubt, is this,* for that in the pride of their hearts, which great men are subject to, they refused obedience, and would not learne his waies to walke in them.

28. So that by their insolencies they* have caused the poore mans cry to come up to God, and he shewes it up|on them that he hath heard the cry of the oppressed against them.

29. God is he that blesseth and af|flicteth* as he sees good, which no man is able by any reason or allegation, to prevent or alter, and therefore should not dare to quarrell or question him; for when he in grace giveth happines, who is there that can make unhap|py? And on the contrary, if he in his just displeasure withhold his favour, who

then can change his minde and countenance when hee frownes, whe|ther it be against more or lesse, a single man, or a whole commonwealth?

30. Thus does hee with great and* absolute power, and in much justice over-rule and order things, that so he may controll the insolent wicked man, and hinder his tyrannifying, and pre|vent the peoples oppressing, which themselves cannot.

31. Surely then, if God be so just and* so powerfull; it is a thing meet when we are under his afflicting hand, not proudly to expostulate the matter with him upon our owne innocency, but to acknowledge him just, however absolute hee seemes in laying his cha|stisement upon us and our selves to have deserved it, so as humbly to beg for pardon, and promise amendment.

32. And if we know not our fault,* yet assuredly to believe we are in fault, and therefore to intreat the Lord to open our eyes, that wee may see and know that by our selves, which hath offended him, and which hee would have amended, with humble and hear|ty promise of it.

33. Thinkst thou it fit that the great* God of heaven should be counsel|led by thee, in what measure he should correct, or in what way hee should a|mend sinne, no, hee'll goe his owne way, and doe as hee sees good, say thou what thou canst, or however it please or displease thee; and for mine owne part, I dare not entertaine a thought of prescribing any manner of course to him in his proceedings, nor censure any of his doings: therefore, if thou canst acquit thy selfe of this crime and accusation which I have laid to thy charge, as thou didst of theirs, why, speake for thy selfe what thou canst say.

34. Nay, I appeale to any man of* understanding if I speake not truth, and justly taxe thee, yea, let any man that heares me without prejudice, and is able to judge, taxe mee if I say amisse.

35. When as I blame thee for thy* pride, which is undeniable in thy be|haviour and carriage towards God, which hath beene very foolish and provoking, as thy speeches can wit|nesse.

36. My desire of God is, that *Job** may be thoroughly convinced of his fault, and at last be brought upon his knees, and made to eate his words, and to glorifie the justice of God by humbly confessing his sinne, that so the mouths of wicked men may be stopped, to whom he hath given great advantage to blaspheme by his accu|sing God of hard and unrighteous dea|ling.

37. For in stead of humbling him|selfe,* and confessing his sin, for which he suffers, and asking pardon for it, he hath added rebellion thereunto, not sticking, as it were, to cry *victoria* a|gainst God himselfe in his owne justi|fication, even to all our faces, and with strange pertinacie to quarrell and upbraid God.

CHAP. XXXV.

1. *Elihu* yet prosecuted his re|proof^e of *Job*, to procure his conviction, thus:
2. Hast thou any plea for thy selfe,* or thinkest thou that thou art not blame-worthy, in uttering as afore|said, such a blasphemous speech as in effect thou hast spoken, to wit, That thou art more righteous than God?
3. For thou hast said, that thou art* righteous, and that thou sufferest un|deservedly, being thy selfe uublame|able and innocent of any offence a|gainst God that might justly cause his displeasure, and that it availeth thee no more to be righteous, than if thou wert the greatest sinner in the world.
4. I tremble to heare such audacious|nesse:* but I will answer thee, and all such men as dare in the pride of their hearts venture to stout it thus, and ar|gue the matter so with God in stead of humbling themselves, and seeking to him in their afflictions.
5. Looke thou up unto the heavens,* view their height, and the clouds which are so farre above thee, and thinke with thy selfe, whether thou canst adde or diminish, make them better or worse.
6. And if not, then consider fur|ther* of what little advantage or dis|advantage, thou must needs be unto God? who is so farre above them, that thou shouldest thus capitulate the mat|ter with him, in stead of praying to him; as for example: Thy sins, what is he the worse for them, more than a cloud over thy head, if thou shouldest shoot an arrow at it, remaines not hee the same in all points notwithstan|ding? yea, if thy transgressions were never so many, how doe, or can they any way harme him, who is selfe|sufficient and independant.
7. And as it is with thy sins, so like|wise* is it with thy righteousness which thou bearest thy selfe so much up|on; what benefit is that to God, or what addes it to him that thou art righteous, how dost thou make him beholden to thee by it, who needs no|thing that is thine?
8. It is nothing but thy pride that* maketh thee thus forget thy selfe, o|therwaies thou must needs know, That God is nothing bound to thee for any thing that is thine, but that as he is not the worse for thy being wicked, but thy selfe, and such as thou art; so on the other hand, neither is he the better for thy being righteous; but if thou, and others like thy selfe doe their du|ty, it's they that fare the better for it, and not he: small reason therefore hast thou to beare thy selfe thus high towards God? prayer would better become thee, and more profit thee.
9. But multitude of pressures doe* usually transport all manner of men, and make the oppressed cry and keepe adoe when they suffer, against them they suffer under.
10. But few or none are so wise in* such a case, as soberly to recollect themselves, and in humility to draw nigh to God in prayer, putting him in minde of his owne gracious nature to|wards the worke of his hands to have mercy upon it, and in faith to seeke to

him for redresse and consolation, as to the onely he that can relieve and glad the heart in extremity and grieve.

11, Hath not God given us where|withall* to know how to carry our selves better in time of affliction, than the beasts of the earth, and to be wiser than the fowles of the aire, which can cry and complaine, when ought aileth them by instinct of nature, but rea|son and religion should teach us a bet|ter lesson that know who hurts us, and who can onely heale us, to wit, hum|bly, and in faith to seeke to him for release.

12. For want of which, men in* pressures lie and cry like brute crea|tures, without either helpe or hope (and so they may doe long enough without answer from God, except they humbly seeke to him in faith) though they endure never so much violence and oppression.

13. For it's certaine that God will* not shew mercy, nor grant release for the naturall and vaine cries, and out|rages of men in extremity; however we poore men through self-love, and humane pity, thinke of them, and are moved by them; yet the Almighty re|gards them not, but lookes for other fruit of affliction, as that they should seeke to him with humble and faith|full prayer before hee'll heare to any purpose.

14. Wherefore although thou de|sperately* givest thy selfe for lost, ne|ver expecting to see God gracious to thee againe, (thus complaining, but not praying under thy burthen) yet I know it, and dare assure thee of it, that if thou wouldest but take that course whereunto I advise thee, that is, to humble thy selfe before him in prayer, thou shouldest find that hee is graci|ously righteous to heare and answer thee, therefore trust thou in him, and in faith and hope make thine ad|dresses to him.

15. But now because thou goest not* this way to worke, nor carriest thy selfe toward him as thou oughtest, hee is forced thus to intreat thee, and to increase his plagues upon thee, to ma|nifest his anger against thee for thy pride, which yet thou perceivest not (so blind art thou) no not in the midst of all this thy great extremity.

16. For which cause, and till which* time that thou humble thy selfe under the mighty hand of God, and seeke unto him, thou lovest all thy labour, and breathest forth thy complaints in vaine, uttering a great many proud and passionate speeches ignorantly to no purpose, saving to provoke God further against thee, whereas thou mightest bestow them more to thine availe.

CHAP. XXXVI.

1. *ELihu* goeth on still to vindicate* God, and to convince *Job* of his miscarriage towards him.

2. Suffer me (saies he to *Job*) a while* longer, and thou shalt see that I have yet more to say in justification of God against thy calumnies.

3. That which I say, shall not be* what first comes to hand, not what hu|mane reason suggests, or what my weake judgement opinionates to be true, but what by speciall inspiration and enlightening from above I know to be so; whereby I will yet further disprove thy presumptuous taxation, and make it good upon thee, that it cannot otherwaies be, but that the maker of thee and mee, and all man|kind must needs be righteous, and not liable to the censure of any creature in whatsoever he does.
4. For I assure thee thus much,* That what I urge either for God or against thee, shall not be of mine owne coining, that so thou shouldest taxe it of errour or mistake, but such as God who cannot erre in truth and judge|ment (by whose spirit and in whose stead I speake unto thee) hath inspi|red mee with, for thy instruction and direction.
5. Consider therefore, how that* God is mighty, able to know and doe all things aright, and need not through weaknesse or want of power be driven to use any unrighteous and indirect meanes to compasse his ends; for hee hath power enough to effect them in a justifiable way, and on the other hand, as mighty as hee is, he affects not ty|ranny, nor sets he so light by any man as to afflict him causelessly of meere pleasure, no, but he is of power to or|der all things with justice and wise|dome.
6. And this he does, as we frequent|ly* and experimentally see by his carri|age towards both sorts of men, bad and good: For first, if men be wicked, and deserve punishment; God, for want of power and understanding, lets them not goe without it, but they feelee and find him both wise, able, and just to give them their demerits, and to right the poore mans wrong.
7. And so in the next place, if men* be righteous, God is just, not to forget such, nor is hee deficient in power to reward them, but preferreth them to the highest top of honour, yea, and upholds them in happinesse that no|thing can hinder, and in despite of all malignant opposers, they are exalted by him.
8. And if it be otherwaies with them,* if they be afflicted, and that pressures be upon them, yet it is not for want of power, wisdom and justice in God.
9. But he shewes them cause for it,* some one sinne or more wherein they have broken their bounds, and beene too blame, for which he justly afflicts them.
10. And as by his rod he teacheth* them to know their sin, and his justice, so also by it he warneth them of, and learneth them their duty, which is not to cample, but humbly to yeeld obe|dience to his command of turning from the iniquity for which they suffer.
11. And then, if they take out this* lesson, and become obedient to him, the fruit of it will be, That they through the mercy of God, shall be eased of their punishment, and shall spend the remainder of their life, as their hearts can wish, in prosperity and pleasure.

12. But on the contrary, if they* stubbornly refuse obedience, then Gods anger shall slay them, and they shall miserably perish, through their owne folly and ignorant presumption.

13. So that those that are thus dis|posed,* and will not convert, but goe on to act the Hypocrites part, and af|fect pride and perversnesse, their por|tion is thereby to adde wrath to wrath, for because in humble penitency they sue not to him when hee afflicts them:

14. Therefore they come to an* hasty and untimely end, whereas else they might prolong their daies; their life perisheth in his anger, and they make without any difference a like end, as doth the most foule and filthy Sodomite, God esteeming no better of them, than equall with the worst of sinners.

15. But on the other hand, the* poore in spirit that cries to him in af|fliction, them he delivers out of it, and shewes them the cause of their oppres|sion, that they may remedy it, and be restored.

16. Even thus would he have done* by thee, hadst thou done thus to him, ere this thou hadst beene let out of the stocks thou complainest so of, and en|joyed thy liberty to thy hearts desire, and as much, if not more, prosperity and wealth than ever heretofore.

17. But thou hast neglected to doe* wisely, and gone a foolish way to worke, as wicked men are wont to doe, repining, and not humbling thy selfe, and now see what comes of it, thou hast multiplied thy sorrowes, and heaped Gods just indignation upon thee by it.

18. Now therefore, because God* is a wrathfull God, feare to persist, lest in his just anger hee take thee quite away, and then it will be too late to doe what now thou maist doe; for no|thing can redeeme thee out of that condition, or make thee alive againe when thou art dead.

19. If thou couldest bid never so|much* for it, it would be in vaine, no riches could purchase or procure it, nor could any power or strength en|force it.

20. Doe not thou peevishly desire* death, lest it come too soone, and it doe by thee, as it does by many an one whom it cuts off in judgement.

21. Take heed betime, affect not to* goe on in sinfull impatiencie, wherein thou hast hitherto beene too blame, choosing rather to persevere in that sinne, then to submit to the will of God in bearing thy affliction hum|bly.

22. But consider well with thy selfe,* who must restore thee, if ever thou beest restored; Is it not God onely, that by his power can doe it, and who can teach thee this better than him|selfe hath done by keeping thee all this while (that thou hast continued impatient) in an helpelesse condition for want of humbling thy selfe to him, hadst thou eyes to see it.

23. Thinke but how unwise thou* art in thy reasonings against him: For who hath, or can prescribe God his way, that he should be questionable for erring out of it, or what is he that can say (if he speake understandingly) that any thing the Lord does is sinfull and unjust.

24. O remember that another part* would better become thee to act then this! and that is, to have him in reve|rence and feare for his workes sake, that glorious structure of the heavens, which all men every where behold and see.

25. For it is hid from no mans eyes,* but all may behold it, and should doe well to consider the height and vast distance of it from us.

26. O consider that God is infinite* in greatnesse, and that wee cannot fa|thome him, nor the wisdom and power that is in his works, neither can we mortalls that measure time by daies and yeeres, conceive the dimensions of eternity which belongeth onely to him.

27. We, I say, cannot comprehend* his power and wisdom; for he makes (we know not how) the drops of wa|ter which fall from above to be such as they are, round and small, and cau|seth the heavens to send downe raine in that manner, according to the pro|portion of exhaled vapours.

28. Which the clouds sucke in, and* resolving them into water, they send it forth in drops, distilling them use|fully in that manner (and not hurtful|ly by eruption) upon the earth in a sufficient plentifull measure for mans sake.

29. Againe, as thus, we cannot con|ceive* the workmanship, that is in in|gending raine in the cloud, and the emission thereof in drops, so neither can any under the skill that he shewes in spreading forth the clouds to that large extent, and disposing them so universally throughout the whole heavens, as wee see they are, which he does by the winds, which hee causeth to blow above among them, whereof also we have but little skill to judge.

30. Consider how hee spreads his* light upon the face of the whole hea|vens, and also how in like manner he spreads the waters in the vast and deep Ocean, so that no bottome can be seen or felt.

31. I say, consider thou these, and* feare, for by these he judgeth the hea|then folke, that have no other know|ledge of him, but by the workes of his hands, and condemneth them for not improving these to his glory, and much more will hee doe so by thee: He furthermore gives us all the good creatures which we enjoy for our food and delight, in that wonderfull plen|ty as wee see.

32. By assembling the clouds when* he pleaseth, he darkneth the skie, and obscures the sunne, keeping away the bright shining thereof from us, by his interpofing some one or more gloo|mie clouds betweene us and it.

33. As often experience manifests,* and more especially, is then to be expected, when as a raine-aboding wind gives fore-knowledge of it, or when as the cattell doe give their naturall pre|sages of an approaching raine, which they know by instinct, being first ex|haled in a vapour from the earth, their proper Element.

CHAP. XXXVII.

1. BESides these foresaid works of* God which wee come short of in our understanding and ca|pacitie; there is yet one speciall one that sets him forth extraordinarily, which I never heare, nor can so much as thinke of but my heart trembleth, and is put out of it's bias at the consi|deration of the wonderousnesse and terrour of it.

2. Namely, the thunder, which I* would have thee considerately to weigh and hearken to, which is, as it were, the very voice and speech of God, speaking his power and Majesty to man, and commanding feare and reverence from him.

3. How wonderfull is the noise* thereof, which by his powerfull dis|pensation, is heard both farre and neere; and in like manner doth he send forth his terrible lightnings farre be|yond our discerning, even, as it were, from one end of the earth to the other.

4. And wee see, how that so soone* as ever the lightening is over, present|ly the thunderclap ensueth, and then immediately upon the cracke he pow|reth forth the aforesaid drops of raine, in a most vehement and impetuous manner, not gently distilling them, as at other times; all which together, wonderfully set forth God to our a|mazement.

5. I cannot enough make mention* of this terrible voyce of God, which he so marvellously uttereth in the thun|der, besides which, other great and wonderfull things he doth, which wee are no more able to judge of and un|derstand than this:

6. For it is onely his power that* causeth the snow to fall upon the earth in that quantity which it doth, and onely by his appointment is it that it lies there till the time come that it melt away: likewise by the same power and appointment it is, that we have sometimes the small distilling A|prill-showers, and other sometimes the tempestuous stormes of raine, throwne out of a mighty hand, so dif|ferently befall us.

7. By the snow lying upon the earth,* and by the rainie weather, he hinders all men from going abroad about their occasions as at other times, and makes them keepe house, that so he may give every man occasion to see and consi|der his all-disposing hand and provi|dence in things, who forceth them from their imploiments, and on whom they are compelled to wait, till they be set at liberty, to goe about their businesses.

8. Thereby also hee compells the* wilde beasts to lie dormant in their dens, till hee let them loose, and give them a fit season to hunt their prey.
9. Out of the South-parts of the* world he hath ordained the strongest winds to blow, and out of the North the coldest.
10. By which winds sent of God,* to that end, it is that the frost befalls us, whereby the broad waters are con|tracted and condensated into a lesser roome.
11. Also by squeezing the raine out* of the cloud upon the earth, he utter|ly drawes it dry, and consumes it quite away to nothing, be it, or seeme it never so thicke and large; and with the wind he blowes the bright empty lightsome cloud to pieces, which hee brought together, and scattereth it by piece-male hither and thither in the aire.
12. And all that motion of the* clouds which we see passe and repasse over our heads, is ordered his wis|dome, so that they are thereby dire|cted to the end and use whereunto he hath ordained them, yea, whereso|ever they are disposed throughout the whole heavens, it is in relation to the earth beneath.
13. Hee sends them on his errand* whithersoever they goe, and whereso|ever they settle, for either they are sent for correction and punishment to car|ry unseasonable and superfluous raine, or else they are sent to fat and fruiten the land which hee meanes well unto, or else in time of drought they are sent in mercy to relieve them that cry un|to him.
14. Marke well these things, O *Job*,* let them not passe carelessly out of thy minde, but weight and consider all and every the wonderous workes of God.
15. And for thy humbling, call to* minde thy inequality and distance, with so great a God: Dost thou know the time which was from eternity, or wast thou called to counsell when hee thus decreed and disposed all things, and made the transparant clouds? which doe not darken the light as others doe, but serve to reflect it up|on us the brighter.
16. Dost thou know how the great* and ponderous clouds come to hang in the aire? Canst thou fathome the depth of that power and wisdom that is in these wonderous workes of God? who is onely wise, yea, perfect in wisdom.
17. Canst thou comprehend the* power which he shewes in heating the aire, so that thou canst not endure thy clothes on thy backe, when the season is, that he refresheth the earth with the summers sunne and the warme Sou|therne winds, in stead of the cold nip|ping Northerne blasts?
18. Wast thou with him, or hadst* thou any hand in spreading out the heaven over our heads? which is round of forme, and consequently of a most strong and perfect frame, and for it's matter cleare and transparent, like a polished brasen looking-glasse.

19. Now thou hast heard this of* him, I appeale to thee; if any man know how to dispute or fault the acti|ons of such a God; for we cannot tell what to allege against him, because we cannot see the depth of his reach and wisdom in things.

20. Methinks a man as I am, should* feare to have it come to the eares of such a God, that hee hath beene so foole-hardy, as to open his mouth in such a way; for, if hee should be dis|posed to answer him (whatsoever hee is that speakes) he would certainly be confounded, and be made to sit downe with sinne and shame.

21. And now, the very true reason* of mens over-daring in this kinde, is, because they take no notice of these wonderfull workes of God, as of the shining and transparant substance whereof he hath framed some clouds, and made them helpfull to the light; nor of his skill in causing this, which is by ordaining the winds to refine them from their black and watry mix|ture, and causing them to blow for that purpose.

22. And how hee sends dry and* frostie weather by the winds which blow out of the North, which scatter the clouds, and purge the aire: Did they, they would then understand that God is of awfull and terrible Ma|jesty, not to be dealt withall in such a manner.

23. And indeed, he that is Almigh|ty* (which God is) we must need thinke is too deepe for us to fathome, and too high for us to reach; for hee is every way transcendent, excelling in power and in wisdom, and abounding in justice in all that ever hee does: Hee will not causelessly afflict nor unjust|ly punish any man.

24. Therefore he lookes that men* should feare his rod, and be humbled under it, and not dispute his blowes, this is not the way to come off well with him, who will never shew favour to any man, that through the over|weening pride of his owne wisdom affects a way of reasoning the matter with God, as thou dost, Take heed therefore.

CHAP. XXXVIII.

1. *ELihu* being fallen upon the* right subject, but wanting Ma|jesty to set it forth, so as to take impression upon *Job*: Hereupon God taketh the word out of his mouth, and himselfe takes *Job* to taske; for the appaling of whose high spirit, and the better making way for his follow|ing discourse to take place, hee makes his first onset in a whirlwind, and thus bespeaks him with a terrifying voice:

2. Who is this whom I have over|heard* to miscarry himselfe in this manner? Is it *Job*? I had not thought it; that hee had beene so unwise, or durst have beene so bold as to cast aspersions upon my wise and secret proceedings, with his weake reason|ings, which faith onely can make him understand.

3. Thou that bravest it so erewhile,* and gavest me choise of weapon, now come on, let's see thy manhood, betake thy selfe to thy ward; for I meane to answer thy

challenge, and to enter the list, against thee; onely I will take the liberty thou hast given mee, I will op|pose, and thou shalt answer, and judge when wee have done, if man be fit to cope with God, or to scan his actions.

4. Where *Elihu* left, there I'll be|gin:* Where wast thou, when I at first by my power and wisdom alone, without the help of thee, or any, made the great vast body of the earth to hang upon it's centre? If thou canst answer this, doe; say man, hadst thou any hand in it, or being at it?

5. Tell mee, Who hath measured* it out in that circumference and dia|meter which it holds? Didst thou? or, knowest thou any besides my selfe that did it; or, who else hath disposed it in that forme, and stretched it forth to those severall quantities and proporti|ons of sea and land which it beares?

6. Or tell me if thou canst, the way* and manner how it is done: Thou knowest how a house is built of fit ma|terialls, by laying the foundations thereof with choice stones, choicely placed in the earth, and artificially ag|glutinated one to another. Now, let us see if thy skill serve thee in like manner to tell how this great piece of Architecture is framed, wherein, or whereon are the foundations of it laid, which hangs like a ball in the aire, or what skilfull work-man was there to begin this worke, or what materialls was there to erect it, which at first was framed by the meere will and wisdom of God out of nothing?

7. Before man had any being, not* being yet created, when as at the be|ginning, Those glorious and excelling creatures, the first and best of all the workes of mine hands, did so unani|mously rejoyce; and that all those sonnes and heires of heaven, the holy Angells, were so exceedingly ravished to see me about to put forth my power, and manifest my wisdom in such a manner, and in such workes for my glories sake.

8. Or tell me, What man, or whose* power and skill was it, that brought the sea within compasse, and placed it within it's bounds, when as it (not ha|ving the restraint which now it has) so universally at the first creation of it, with an unlimited violence, over|spread and whelmed the whole earth with such a totall inundation and cir|cumvolution; which is the naturall and proper course and motion of it; and from which it was then as impos|sible to be restrained or circumscribed by any humane power, as it is for a woman against nature to withstand her throwes, and containe the fruit of her womb, when the time of her de|livery is at hand.

9. I meane, at the very first of all,* when it received it's being; and I had set it no other bounds as yet, but only darknesse, which (before light was made) like a cloud was upon, and co|vered all the face of the deepe, and when onely thicke darknesse (there being then no manner of light) sur|rounded it, as it surrounded the earth.

10. And then, when I, from whom* it had it's being, did also give it the re|striction which now it has, gathering it together by a perpetuall and power|full decree into that

place and pit which now contains the Ocean, placing the sand and banks for bounds and limits.

11. And laid my commands upon* it to abide there, and not to passe it's station, which restraint, though it seem impatiently to bear by it's flowing, yet it cannot prevaile or exceed it's boundary, but ebbeth backe againe, nor can it with all it's swelling and mountainous waves, though they tosse themselves and roare, goe one foot further then I have set it, but they vanish so soone as ever they come to their appointed period.

12. If thou answerest me that these* things were all before thy time; then I aske thee, Hast thou either lengthened, or hastned the rising of the Sun at any time since thou wast borne? and hast thou ever caused the morning light in any one of those daies thou hast seene, to spread it selfe to it's uttermost bounds which I have appointed it?

13. That so it may shine forth farre* and neere, to give light to the inhabitants of the earth, that by that meanes those evil-doers and night-birds (who hate the day light) might be affrighted and driven from the face thereof by it's rising, into their dens of darkness.

14. By whose light and rise, the earth* receives it's proper shape and impression in the sight of all men which it lost in the darke, and all the severall fruits, flowers, and various workmanship of God in her produced creatures that grow thereupon appeare as the beautifull clothing thereof.

15. But the guilty consciences of* the wicked shall drive them into darke corners, like banished men; so that they shall not enjoy the comfortable use and sight of those things which the light affordeth; for this shall be the reward of them that rebelliously work wickednesse against God, their lives shall be miserable, and they shall be deprived of the good that others doe enjoy.

16. Hast thou ever seene, or beene* at the bottome of the sea; or hast thou with all thy skill and labour found out how deepe it is?

17. Hast thou ever descended into,* or seene the deepe Abyссе of the earth, where it is darke and uncomfortable as hell, and where the dead onely inhabite?

18. Hast thou ever placed the* breadth of the earth, tell mee now thou that promisedst to reply, if thou canst give an exact account thereof?

19. Hast thou travelled to the places* of the sunnes rising and setting, so as to know the place of residence for the light, and to tell where darkness dwells.

20. That when thou seest them* spread so wide in the aire, and wander so farre from home, thou maist carry them backe, and direct them into their way.

21. Knowest thou the places of* light and darknesse, either by vertue of thy then being, when they were first created by me, or hast thou gained this knowledge by long experience and much study?
22. Wast thou ever in my store|houses* of snow and haile, to see them where they are?
23. Which I create and keepe up* above in my treasures, till the time come that I thinke good to send them downe to execute my will in the pu|nishment of men, and for to stand my friends in stead against their enemies and mine in the day of battell.
24. Knowest thou how it comes to* passe that the lightning should so for|cibly break out of the cloud in a thun|der storme, as even to break and inter|rupt the course of the strongest wind, and suddenly turne and scatter it all abroad into the severall corners of the world.
25. Who is it, thou or I, that divides* and sends the waterclouds (those great bottells of heaven) hither & thither, to poure out their raine, and to cause in|undations in this or that place, or that directs the lightning which breakes forth of the thunder-cloud with such swift violence, to goe that way it takes, and doe the thing it effects?
26. Causing it by such meanes to* raine, not onely in places inhabited, for the use of men, but even on the remotest parts of the world, where no man ever came, and in the vast wil|dernesse, where no man inhabits; (surely then it is not thee.)
27. Therby to satisfie the desolate and* wast places which no man makes use of, and to cause the grasse and herb to grow even there, as I at first decreed it for the use of the wildbeasts also that inhabite there in stead of men.
28. These things are beyond thy* sphere, they are not ordinarily propa|gated according to thy understanding; for what father hath the raine, or who begets the drops of dew?
29. Or what woman can the ice* call mother; and the hoary frost that comes downe from heaven upon the earth, by what man and woman is it begotten and conceived?
30. The waters (thou seest) are co|vered* with ice as if they were paved over with stone, and the deepest rivers become passable, being frozen over.
31. Canst thou alter the seasons of* the yeere, by appointing either the Spring-time to come later, by hinder|ing the comming of the seven starres, which are proper to that season, and the distilling of their sweet influences: or canst thou dissolve the Winter frosts, accompanying the constellati|ons of that season, and so expedite and shorten that cold and comfort|lesse quarter.
32. Canst thou command those re|mote* and hidden starres of the South to shew themselves in their sommer|season, or direct the Northerne con|stellations to know their course, and to appeare in Autume?

33. Knowest thou the regiment* which is held and exercised up above in the heavenly orbes, what order and lawes God hath constituted for the motions and influences thereof; canst thou who livest here below order and dispose them to execute their severall uses and operations on earth whereto I have appointed them?
34. Canst thou command the* clouds to doe thee service, and to send downe raine enough to serve thy turne when thou hast need?
35. Canst thou send the swift fly|ing* lightnings, and cause them goe from one end of the heavens to ano|ther in an instant, upon thy errand? canst thou bring them to offer them|selves to be at thy command, as they are at mine?
36. Who is it that hath made man* a reasonable creature, and given him understanding? hast thou made thy selfe so?
37. Who with all his wisdome can* give a perfect accompt of those num|berlesse clouds in the heavens, but I? Who both made them, and disposeth of them all, as many as they are, to their end and uses; or who but I can re|straine the raine, which is heavie of it selfe, and intends downward, from falling out of the clouds?
38. When the ground hath had it's* fill; so that the light dust is turned in|to lumps of earth, and that which was tost with every wind, is clodded and agglutinated by water into an heavie substance.
39. Or, if thou canst not skill of* these things, because they are above thee; then wilt thou undertake to provide food upon earth, where thou hast thine abode, for the beasts & birds that live thereupon; yea, for the most ravenous of them (which I doe) as the Lyon and his hungry whelps.
40. Hast thou given them the Art* they use in catching their prey, with couchant and covert cunning to steale upon, and suddenly surprize it?
41. Or, is it by thy or my provi|dence,* that the Ravens are provided for, and that the yong ones being early forsaken of the old, and wanting skill to shift for themselves, wandring here and there, yet have their cries heard, which nature hath taught them, to put up to God in their necessity, and answered with supply of food?

CHAP. XXXIX.

1. DOth thine eye of providence* over-looke and take care for the maintenance of each creature in it's kinde and species, rea|cheth it even to wild Goats which are out of any mans dominion, dwelling in inaccessible rockes, so that is it thou that makest them conceive and bring forth in their season; or doe the Hindes either, doe the like by thine or|dination and vigilancy?
2. Hast thou appointed them the* time they shall goe with young before they bring them forth, and when the time is fulfilled, is it by, or of thee they doe it?

3. Is it thou that hast given them* the instinct to know the instant of pro|duction, and as wilde as they are, con|sideratly to goe about it in such a man|ner as may be most easefull to them|selves, and least hurtfull to their off|spring, by bowing their bodies the better to straine themselves, and dilate the passage, so they doe, and thereby deliver themselves of their young by this their naturall midwifery, and cast out that in a moment which hath been so long time burthensome to them.
4. And when their young ones are* brought forth, they appeare in good plight, by natures nourishing and ca|ring for them in the mothers belly, and after that, they thrive and come on as well as if they were fed with corne: They leave their dams betime, and yet by natures instinct, shift well enough for themselves.
5. Who is it that hath ordained* creatures as well wilde as tame, who but I have naturally set the wilde Asse at liberty, and made him untameable to any mans yoake?
6. Appointing him the vast and de|sart* wildernesses to inhabit in, where he rangeth without subjection or con|troll of any, and by my constitution chooseth of his owne instinct to abide and feed most upon the very worst soile, whereas other creatures desire the best.
7. He knowes no obedience to any,* but setteth light by all men, scorning to be subjected by how many or whom|soever, neither will hee be ruled as other beasts, to goe and come at the command and voice of the driver.
8. He is not inclosed within hedges* and pales like other cattell, but ran|geth at large upon the high and great mountaines, where he feeds, and takes his liberty without restraint, to eate what ever likes him.
9. Canst thou get the Unicorne's* good will to come under thy yoake, and doe thy worke? or canst thou tame him like an Oxe, to be a dome|sticke beast, and at thy finding?
10. Canst thou tether or geere him* like a horse, or will hee be brought to drive or lead at Plough or Har|row?
11. Because hee hath strength e|nough* to doe thee service (yea, more than those which doe) wilt thou therefore conclude he must and shall?
12. Wilt thou trust to his gentle|nes* to bring home thy corne, and to in thy harvest in stead of thy Oxe and Horse? if thou dost, thou wilt be de|ceived?
13. Gavest thou the Peacock that* glorious shew which hee makes when his taile is spread abroad like the wings of a bird in the aire, or didst thou bestow those beautifull feathers upon the Ostrich?
14. Which differs from all other* birds, for when shee layes, shee unna|turally abandoneth her egges and ex|poseth them above ground, onely covering them with a little sand or dust to cause them keepe their natur|all heate, in stead of hatching and hurkling them, and so leaves them to receive production from the Sunne.

15. Not heeding what may come* of them, by exposing them in that manner to the casual mishap either of man, or beast.

16. And when they are brought* forth shee is unnaturally strange to them, as though they belonged not to her to provide for: and so through her own carelesnes runnes hazard (but for mee) to lose all the labour which by natures providence shee had taken in ingendring, and laying them.

17. And why doth shee thus more* then others? but because God who hath given instinct of love and provi|dence to other creatures hath deny|ed, and not imparted it to her, as to them?

18. When shee stretcheth up her* selfe, and betakes her to her wings and feete (for she flies running, or runnes flying, not being able through bulke of body to soare aloft) shee cares not for her pursuer, scorning the swiftest horse-man should overtake her.

19. Hast thou put strength into the* horse, hast thou armed him with force and power to beare downe all before him, and encounter his enemy with such a shock as if thunder had struck him?

20. Canst thou make him flinch* thee as a Grashopper? noe, hee is a|nothergates creature. The disdainfull snortings which hee sends out of his nostrils in his pride, and courage are terrifying.

21. He paweth up the earth in the* place of battell through the impatien|cy of his spirit, and glorieth in his strength as unconquerable, fearelesly marching upon the dreadfull enemy.

22. Hee scornes to feare, nothing* can daunt him, the daring sword can|not make him turne taile.

23. The rattling of the Arrows, the* bright steel-headed Speare, or shi|ning Shield appeale not his spirit a whit.

24. In the imagination of his fan|cy* he overturnes all before him, yea the very ground, he stands on, through his fierce desire, to be fighting he tea|reth it with his teeth, or gallops it a|maine to bee at the enemy. Neither doth hee respect or conceive any ter|ror at the sound of their trumpet, which threatens the deadly onset, but in the height of his courage counts it as a whistle.

25. Deafing their noise, and proud|ly* answering them in way of scorne and challenge with his loud and daring neighings, his courage makes him quick sented, so that hee smells the battell, and snorts with a hasty desire to be at it, before it be, being provo|ked by the braving flourishes and tumultuous noise of the approaching Army, which he impatiently sees and heares.

26 Hast thou by thy wisdom taught* the Hawke her dexterity in flight, and learned her by instinct to choose the warme Southern parts of the World to take to for the place of her prey, when cold weather comes.

27. Is it by thy or my power and ordinance,* that the Eagle is so strong as to mount plum up (which no bird else can doe) to an infinit height, and that shee build her nest on high in un|accessible places.

28. She lives & breeds upon the rock,* upon the Crag of the Rock, which is so steepe and dangerous that noe man nor beast dare climbe it, and so strong that the Sea though with all its force it beate against it, cannot move it.

29. From whence shee goes farre* to fetch her prey, and though her sharpe sightednesse can see it thence at a mighty distance.

30. Shee traines up her young ones* to her owne trade feeding them with flesh, and acquainting them with the sweet of blood, and where the grea|test slaughter is made, and most blood shed, there is the place of her delight, thither by a strange sagacity of nature shee resorteth, and carrieth her young ones with her.

CHAP. XL.

1. HAVING said all this, now God* sets it home upon *Job* with this sharpe reprehension.

2. Hearest thou this, and by it perceivest* thou not thy ignorance and weaknesse together with my power and wisdom, and thinkest thou now that it is fit for any man whatsoever to contend with one so almighty, and to instruct one so wise; hee that dares to question and quarrell God in any his wayes, and workes, as thou hast not stuck to doe, let him make answer to this that I have opposed, that so there may appeare to be some equality, and this doe thou, if thou canst?

3. *Jobs* spirit being appaled by* Gods immediate parlee, & unexpected apparition in the whirlwind, and his understanding being non-plust with such high questions, and withall seeing the Lord provoked, humbly addresseth himselfe to make answer to him in this manner.

4. I now confesse to thee, and all the* world, my sinne and folly in misbe|having my selfe in such a manner towards such a God, by questioning and not submitting to thee, but in stead of going on to doe so, I revoke my chal|... and humble my sel|e at thy feet, acknowledging my selfe (compared with thee) every way vile and base, and utterly unable to answer any of thy demands, therefore I beg leave of thee that I may be silent, granting all thou hast said of thy greatnesse, and my weaknesse to be true, and bewail|ing my over-daring rashnesse.

5. Once indeed I was so foolish, as* to desire a dispute betweene us, but I repent it, and now my turne comes to reply, I will make no answer, but con|fesse mine errour, yea, though then in passion I was eager upon it, yet now the case is altered with mee, I have enough of it, and my mouth is stopped for ever doing the like againe.

6. But God tooke the matter so ill* at *Jobs* hands, that he should so forget himselfe, and by his carriage in some respect, though not altogether, as it were, disprove him, and make good Satans words; that hee would not accept of this submission, but againe quite to breake the necke of his pride, angrily breakes in upon *Job* thus:

7. What dost thou flinch? Sure* thou scornest it; Thou wilt certainly make good thy challenge; come there|fore, stand to it, and play the man as thou saidst thou wouldest doe, I'll doe as I did; I'll oppose, and thou shalt answer.

8. Wilt thou also question and suspect* my justice, as wicked men, and such as know not God are wont to do? I had not thought it by thee, or that thou wouldest have carried the matter so high through pride of spirit, as to go about to condemne mee of overmuch rigour, and justifie thy selfe.

9. Knowest thou me no better? art* thou any way my equall, or fit to contend with mee; is thy strength like mine; or canst thou equall the noise and terrour of my thunder with any speech and power of thine?

10. Canst thou make thy selfe a* God as I am? if thou canst, doe; and adorne thy selfe with such majesty and excellency, glory and beauty as mine is.

11. Canst thou execute judgement* in wrath all the world over, and canst thou perceive the proud behaviour and carriage of men every where, and abase them as I doe?

12. Behold with me every proud|hearted* man, and bring him downe, doe thou extend thy power like mee to roote out the wicked in every place wheresoever throughout the world they exalt themselves, and practise wickednesse.

13. Slay them in thy wrath, and bury* them in the grave of forgetfulnesse, even all and every one, how many, or of what condition soever they be, extinguish thou their pride by death, and make their memories perish.

14. When thou canst doe these* things, then will I confesse and say with thee, that thou art fit and able to encounter with me.

15. But yet for thy further convin|cing,* I will instance to thee two of my most remarkeable creatures which I have framed, the one by land, the other by sea, which I would have thee take speciall notice of. And first, for the land, Consider the Elephant which is thy fellow creature, both of you made by me, how farre notwithstanding hee goeth beyond thee in huge|nesse and strength and yet by my ordination hee is as harmelesse as any other beast, preying upon nothing but grasse, though he were able to devoure all afore him.

16. I have endowed him with wonderfull* strength, but how, and where? Why not in any offensive part; his head hath no hornes, nor his feet no clawes to doe mischief with, but to the end he might bee more serviceable to man in bearing of burdens and

draw|ing loads, I have placed it elsewhere, and chiefly in his lower parts, as his loines, and about his belly.

17. In so much that in the heate of his* lust hee erects his generative part like a strong cedar Tree, being corroborated from natures cundit-pipes, the si|newes of his stones, which are wrapt together like as you see the roots of a great grown Tree, in the earth.

18. The bones in his body are as* strong as if they were made of brasse, and like so many barres of iron.

19. Hee is if well considered the re|markeablest* peece of creation that the earth affoordeth to set forth Gods power, and might, and yet as strong as he is, I that made him and gave him his strength, can breake his brasse and iron bones to peeces at my pleasure, though man be too weake for him.

20. And surely for all he so farre goes* beyond all other beasts that none can stand against him or are equall to him for strength, yet hee is nourished with the same food that they are, with grasse, &c. And goes quietly with them, and feeds peaceably among them, with|out either hurting, or so much as fright|ing them, by mine appoyntment.

21. Through his naturall heate and* being bred in hot countries, his abode is in shady places, and for that cause lies much under Trees, and where there are high growne reeds, and fennes, thither he resorts.

22. He hants out the coolest places, as* under great Trees and by brook-sides where willowes grow thick and affoord most shade, there is hee most conver|sant.

23. Consider what a huge proporti|on* he drinks to quench his thirst, as if he would quite exhaust and drinke the whole river dry, and whilst hee is drinking hee feares no danger as other cattel doe, that through the frightfulnes of their disposition break their drought to stare about them: In the vast imagina|tion of his fancy he conceits he can de|voure, and drinke up whole Jordan at once, when he goes thither to quench his thirst.

24. If he seeth a snare set for him, it in|rageth* him being privy to his exceed|ing strength, in so much that with his trunck he makes his way through them with ease, and disdaine.

CHAP. XLI.

1. HAVING thus showne thee, the E|lephant* by land, now in the next place consider well the Whale (or some such extraordinary fish) by Sea. Canst thou angle for him, catch him, and draw him on shoare with a line, and hooke, as thou dost other les|ser Fishes?

2. Hast thou strength to over-master* him & ring him like a Swine or a Beare, or canst thou rule him so as to suffer himselfe to be led by the nose, as Beares, and some such beasts as thou hast ta|med doe?
- 3 Will hee lie down like a Spaniel at* thy command, and wag his taile to fawn upon thee?
4. Will hee put himselfe into thy ser|vice* for hay, and corne, as other crea|tures, and wilt thou undertake to com|mand and imploy him, like them, upon all thy affaires, and to doe thy bu|sinesses?
5. Canst thou handle him like a Spar|row,* or tame him so that thy maides may play with him without feare?
6. Shall the fishermen who joyne in* company and partnership, catch him in their nets like other fishes, and for joy of such a draught feast themselves and make merry with him; shall they mer|chandize him, shall they share and trade away the severall commodities which he yeelds of whale-bone and oile, &c.
7. Is his skinne penetrable like other* fishes, so that thou canst take him with such tooles and fishing instruments as thou takest them?
8. Draw neere and offer but the least* violence to him if thou darest, and hee'll quickly make thee repent it, so that thou wilt have little joy to fight it out with him.
9. For certaine hee is a creature that* man hath small hopes to bring under his dominion and make serviceable, who is so formidable, that noe man dare attempt it, for his very sight a farre off is able to scarre a man from venturing on him.
10. Who is he that dare provoke him,* or that hath the courage to encounter him? not one, and if so, then how dare any attempt the like towards mee and thinke to prevaile, or not miscarry, who am the Creator, and he but my creature?
11. Who hath been aid full to me in the* creation, or who hath made any of my creatures for me, that I may acknow|ledge it and be thankfull to him for it, is not every creature that thou seest or knowest in the land and sea, of what might or strength soever they be, is hee not mine, and have not I made him? what manner of apprehension then ought men to have of mee, and with what feare ought they to reverence me?
12. Yea, this great Leviathan is of* my making, which I will yet further a|natomize and set forth unto thee; for I would have thee consider him well in his extraordinary qualities, strength and lineaments, that so thou maiest learne to know thy distance with God.
13. Who can handle him like a horse,* to bring him out of the sea to view him, as a horse out of a stable? Who will undertake, or dare, to tame and halter him with all the strength and skill hee hath?

14. Who dare looke into his mouth,* as in a horses, when you buy him, which is like a paire of two leaved doores for widenesse; or force a bit betweene his teeth, which are so monstrous great and terrible on both sides his mouth?
15. His scales are like so many gli|stering* shields wherein he puts his con|fidence, and takes his pride, which are so closed and put together, like paper sealed with waxe, as that nothing can part them.
16. Yea, there is such a juncture, as* that nothing can goe betweene, no, not the thin and subtile aire, which yet pier|ceth the pores of all other things.
17. They are lapt one over another* like tiles on a house, but so close, and stick so fast together, that neither sword nor speare can pierce him.
18. His forcible snortings which he* utters in his courage, causeth, as it were, fire to breake out at his nose and eyes, which whensoever they are seen above water, appeare as the breaking out of the Sunne in the morning.
19. He breatheth out of his mouth a* strong sulphurous vapour, inkindled in him from the strength and heate of na|ture, which inflameth his breath like fire.
20. Out of the two holes of his head* whereat hee breaths out, and takes in aire in stead of nostrills, he sends thence such vapour of smoke, as if it did rise out of a great boiling caldron.
21. His breath is of that nature by* reason of his hot and fiery constitution, that it is able to kindle coales, and warme like fire.
22. He is infinitely strong and able to* beare downe whatsoever hee shall en|counter, nor feares hee an enemy, but takes pleasure to warre with any, joying thereby to put forth his strength and cherish his pride.
23. And as are his scales without, so* is his flesh within, firme, solid, and com|pact in thicke and mighty flakes.
24. Hee is not timerous like other* creatures, his heart is as incapable of feare as a stone, yea, as impenetrable by any such passion as is the nethermost milstone.
25. When as hee shewes himselfe* upon the surface of the water, hee af|frights the most couragious warriour, yea, with his fierce and violent motion in the sea, wherewith he makes his way, breaking through waves, and sending up foame, he makes the stoutest betake themselves to make peace with God, and beg pardon for their sins, conclu|ding death unavoidably to be at hand.
26. If any man be so hardy to strike* him, his sword will fly in pieces, his scales are so impenetrable, that neither sword nor speare, nor dart, nor in|deed any other instrument of warre can wound him.
27. He sets as much by iron, or any* weapon that is made thereof, as a man does by a straw; and so by brasse, as a man does by rotten sticks, which he can snap in pieces at his pleasure.

28. He cares not for a whole showre* of arrowes shot at him, nor for never so many stones, be they never so strongly slung; they fall at his feet, and are no more to him than the stuble which a man treads upon.

29. Darts, though throwne at him* never so thicke, are no more esteemed and cared for by him, than a man re|spects dried straw; he feares no threat|ning a man can use towards him, the shaking of the speare appales not him a jot.

30. He rests himselfe upon the hard* and sharpe-pointed stones of the rocke, and yet they never pierce him, but hee by his weight and strength breaks them off, and tumbles them downe into the bottome of the sea.

31. When he moves in his might, he* makes the Ocean to foame and to boile like a pot on the fire, he raiseth a thicke scum upon the face of the waters, as if the whole sea were a pot of ointment.

32. He raiseth such a white shining* foame all along as he swimmeth, and so changeth the colour of the water, that one would thinke a hoary frost covered the deep and wide sea.

33. I told thee before of *Behemoth*,* but this is farre beyond him, the whole earth hath not the like creature upon it for a dreadlesse spirit.

34. In his own conceite he so exalts* himselfe, that through the confidence of his strength and hight of his spirit hee scornfully opinionates even the mightest and greatest monsters by Sea and Land to bee inferiour to him, and beleeveth himselfe, as indeed he is, for might and power, to be the supreame of all elementary creatures how ever excellent.

CHAP. XLII.

WHen *Job* had heard out* God, hee thus makes an|swer.

2. I humbly acknowledge it, that thou* and thou only hast made all the crea|tures, and workes of wonder which thou hast spoken of, yea that thou canst doe even whatsoever pleaseth thee to doe, and that thy power is of such large extent, that not so much as a thought of any mans heart (which also is of thy making) can be hid from thee, nor can any thought or intention of thine bee withstood or hindred from being brought to passe by thee.

3. Well mightest thou taxe me as thou* didst of my foolish questioning thy wise decrees and proceedings with my weake reasonings, which by an eye of faith issuing from an humble heart are only discernable, therefore I humbly confesse my fault, That I have been too bold and saucy with so great a majesty and with thy sacred decrees and a|ctions, uttering things ignorantly of thee and them, I wist not what, which now repent me.

4. I am not the man I was, therefore* now that thou hast done, I beseech thee heare me speake, which shall bee in another manner then at first when I passe my foolish chalenge, desiring now to bee instructed and not disputed with by thee.

5. I confesse I have beene ignorant* of thee to this very day, for though I have had some manner knowledge of thee by heare-say of what hath beene taught mee of old from my forefathers who were but men like my selfe, as also even now by *Elihu*; Yet now this short lesson of thine owne immediate teaching hath learned me more, and to more purpose in a little time being an eye-witnesse of thy glory, then all that ever I knew before.

6. In so much that now I eate my* words and abhorre my selfe for my presumptuous misbehaviour, repen|ting it with as lowly a spirit as I sinned it with an high.

7. When God had finished his busines* with *Iob*, & matters were reconciled be|tween them two, having quickly brought him to see his folly and repent his pride; Then God turnes himselfe to *Iobs* three friends to convince them also of their miscarriage, and because *Eliphaz* was the ancientest and had first broached the er|roure whereof the other two were after guilty, he addresses himselfe to him by name and tells him, That he was justly angry with him, and his two compani|ons, for because you have preached false doctrine touching me, and have been too bold to limit my soveraignety, by chal|king me out wayes, and prescribing me rules of justice in the execution of my will, and dispensation of my providence, as if I alwayes must and did afflict men for, and according to the measure of their sins, & spare them for their righte|ousnes and innocency sake, which is a grosse untruth, and the contrary to which my servant *Iob* maintained, to wit, That I am free to doe my will, and incompre|hensible in my wayes, which is right.

8. Therefore to expiate your offence* take with you such a sacrifice as I shall appoint, that is, seven Bullocks and seven Rammes, and goe to my servant *Iob*, re|concile your selves to him as touch|ing the wrong you have done him as well as me, and give them him that hee may doe the office of a Priest, that is, offer up sacrifice and prayers for you all joyntly, who have all been guilty of the same sinne; and the prayers of my servant *Iob* who is an upright man, and one whom I much respect, how ever you misiudged him, shall prevaile with me (through the office and person of my sonne which herein he resembles) to par|don you: I say doe this, thus, and excuse not the matter by your ignorance or wel|meaning towards me, nor dispute my command, as loath to eate your words, or to justifie *Iob* whom you have already condemned; but dispatch, and goe about this businesse, least I give you your desert and make you feelee the effects of your foolish presumption, in that you have dared to measure me out by your meet ■ wands, and prescribe me wayes to walke in, and so have falsified the truth, which my servant *Iob* maintained against you.

9. Whereupon these three afore|said* friends of *Iob*, *Eliphaz* the *Temanite*, and *Bildad* the *Shuhite*, and *Zophar* the *Naaneathite* went streightway, having received so strickt a charge from God, and did what the Lord commanded them; for whom at their requests, *Iob* put up his petitions to God, and was so accepted in his person, sacrifice and prayer, being a figure of Christ therein, that at his intercession their offence was forgiven them.

10. And as *Iob* in his meeknesse and* charity forgave his friends their tres|passes, and prayed for them; so God forgave him his, and at that instant re|leased him of his misery which hee had beene held in so long, and turned his sorrow into joy, by testifying his love to him in his acceptance of him, and by vindicating his uprightness and inno|cency against his accusers: moreover, God recompensed the losse and suffe|rings which *Iob* sustained, with double to what he had before.

11. And brought him into favour* againe with those parties that partly for his poverty, and partly upon suspition of his hypocrisie had cast him off, so that now there flocked to him from far and neere, all his brethren and sisters and his old acquaintance, which it seemes though they were neere to him, and had beene intimate with him, yet upon this occasion had beene of late estranged, till now that they saw the face of things were changed, and then they come themselves to visit him, and to pity him for what hee had suffered, and to comfort him with gratifying his deliverance and freedome from all the afflictions that God had laid upon him; moreover, besides their visiting him, every man further congratulated his recovery (God moving their hearts) with a present of money and jewells, in testimony of their love and respect.

12. Thus the Lord humbled *Iob** very low, to be a patterne of faith and patience to his Saints in aftertimes, by remembring his later end, which God made fare to exceed his beginning in abundance of all good things, yea, double to what he had; for whereas before hee had but seven thousand sheepe, now he had foureteene thou|sand, and so likewise his former three thousand Camels were now multiplied into sixe thousand, and his five hundred yoke of Oxen were doubled into a thousand, and his five hundred she|Asses into as many.

13. And whereas all his children* you heard were taken from him, he had them restored him againe, even their full number; seven sons and three daughters.*

14. Whom he thus named: The eldest daughter he called *Iemima*, or long life: The second he called *Kezia*, or pleasant spice: the youngest he called *Keren-happuch*, or the horne of beauty; prophesying in them the long life, to|gether with the comfortable and hap|py condition which by the bounteous goodnesse of God he should yet enjoy.

15. Which three daughters, for a* further blessing unto *Iob*, were the fai|rest women in all the land where hee lived, and were had in greatest reputa|tion for their beauty, and as God gave them an extraordinary blessing to him, so he made them an extraordinary pre|sident; for out of his love to them, and in reward of their vertues

hee gave to every of them severally, as to his sons, a portion of his land in stead of money to inherit, to them and to their heires for ever; so that they shared proportion|ably with their brethren by their fa|thers Will and Testament, and were coheires with them in his estate.*

16. And thus all these sorrows which *Job* thought he should never have seene an end of, he survived, and after them lived in prosperity and plenty a hun|dred and forty years, so that he became a great Grandfather before he died.*

17. And so *Job* ended his days in a good old age, and was carried to his grave like as a shock of corn cometh in, in his season.

FINISH